

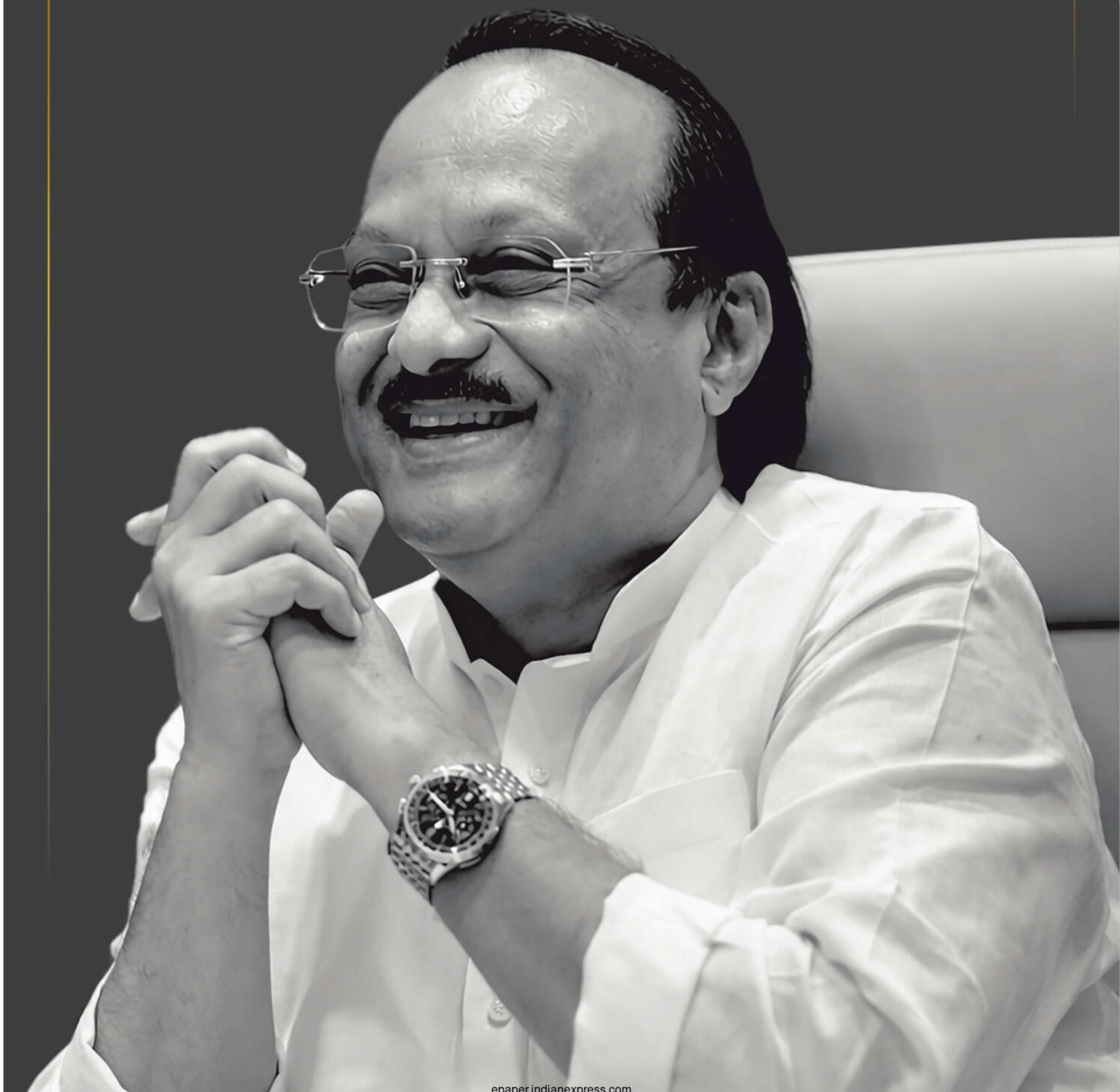


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Tehran warns Bulgaria against aiding US military ops

Reuters
Dubai, July 21

IRAN’S FOREIGN Ministry spokesman warned Bulgaria on Tuesday against allowing the US to use its territory for military operations against Iran.

The Bulgarian government has said it will seek parliamentary approval to station up to eight US tanker aircraft at an air base in the Balkan country, which is a member of NATO and the European Union.

Ministry spokesman Esmail Baghaei said any activity that facilitates US attacks on Iran would amount to complicity in what he described as “aggression and war crimes”, according to Iranian state media.

Baghaei urged Bulgaria not to become “an accomplice of aggressors and lawbreakers”, they said. The tanker aircraft are mainly used for airborne refuelling of other aircraft.

Bulgaria’s government aims to station the US aircraft at the Bezmer military facility, about 260 km (160 miles) southeast of the capital Sofia.

The US and Iran have intensified strikes since an interim ceasefire deal signed a month ago unravelled, raising the possibility of a return to all-out war.

U.S. FORCES BOMB TARGETS IN SOUTH AND WEST OF IRAN

Will be hitting Pickaxe Mountain area pretty soon, says Trump

Reuters
Washington, Dubai, July 21

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump on Tuesday said the US will be hitting the Pickaxe Mountain area, located near Iran’s heavily damaged Natanz uranium enrichment facility, “pretty soon.”

Pickaxe Mountain is a heavily fortified site that hosts two deeply buried tunnel complexes that experts assess as beyond the reach of the most powerful bunker buster bombs in the US arsenal. The site is linked to Iran’s nuclear program.

Trump also said that the US would respond if Yemen’s Iran-aligned Houthi movement follows through on its threat to impose a blockade on commercial shipping in the Red Sea, saying that if the group takes action, the United States “will just have to take care of business.”

But the Houthi announcement already appeared to be having an impact. Two tankers which had just loaded Saudi crude bound for China and India at Saudi Arabia’s Red Sea port of Yanbu made U-turns on Tuesday, heading towards the Suez Canal rather than out through the Bab el-Mandeb



US President Donald Trump with Lebanese President Joseph Aoun at the White House on Tuesday. AP

into the Indian Ocean.

US forces bombed targets in the south and west of Iran overnight, while Tehran targeted US sites in Bahrain, Kuwait and Jordan and a tanker was hit in the Strait of Hormuz at the mouth of the Gulf.

Iran said it had struck infrastructure belonging to Amazon in Bahrain, where the US tech

company operates a regional data centre.

Amazon did not immediately comment and Reuters could not verify the report. US Central Command said it had hit Iranian military command centres, maritime capabilities, missile and drone launch sites and air defence systems in its latest round of strikes, which have

carried on nightly for more than a week and a half.

Explosions were heard around the city of Shiraz in southern Iran, state media said. Konarak and Chabahar on the southern coast, the city of Khorramabad and a civilian site outside the city of Abadan, both in the west, all came under attack, media reports said.

British-Indian Narayan named Britain’s first minister for AI

Aditi Khanna
London, July 21

BRITISH PRIME Minister Andy Burnham finalised his top team within hours of taking charge at 10 Downing Street and promoted British Indian minister for artificial intelligence (AI) Kanishka Narayan to the Cabinet, and purging allies of predecessor Keir Starmer from the government.

Burnham, who was invited to form the government by King Charles on Monday, set about unveiling the team of ministers who will join him around the Cabinet table soon after.

Lisa Nandy is another Indian-origin minister who holds on to her department, with additional responsibilities as Secretary of State for Digital, Culture, Media and Sport.

Narayan said his elevation, as Minister for AI, falling jointly within the Cabinet Office and the Department for Business, Innovation, Science and Trade, is a sign of the new PM’s “deep commitment to AI’s importance.” “AI is likely the most significant technology in human history. Its impact will dwarf other things. The best case for it is compelling beyond our dreams: a reindustrialised Britain, stronger national security, public services transformed for the better,” said Narayan, who was elected as the first Indian-origin member of Parliament from Wales in the July 2024 general election.

The 36-year-old Bihar-born Labour MP for the Vale of Glamorgan, who held the AI brief as a junior minister in former prime minister Keir Starmer’s team, pledged to act with “pace and ambition” and “focus relentlessly on securing British influence in shaping AI”.

“I will also bring to this job the place I represent a consti-

• THE NEW FACES

New British Prime Minister Andy Burnham named his ministerial team on Monday. Here are some who have been given the top jobs in the new government



JOHN HEALEY,
CHANCELLOR OF
THE EXCHEQUER



WES STREETING,
DEFENCE
SECRETARY



MIATTA
FAHNBULLEH,
ENERGY SECRETARY



ED MILIBAND
FOREIGN
SECRETARY



YVETTE COOPER,
HEALTH
SECRETARY



KANISHKA
NARAYAN,
AI SECRETARY

tuency in Wales, a nation with industry and ambition at its heart, a proud history of punching above its weight on the global stage. A nation which welcomed a 12-year old and his family, gave us the best chance at opportunity, put me in Parliament as Wales’ first ethnic minority MP, and now affords me the chance to make a mark in Cabinet,” he said.

With roots in Muzaffarpur, Narayan’s family moved to the Welsh capital of Cardiff when he was a little boy. He studied at Oxford and Stanford universities before entering politics after a stint in the private sector and has been vocal about the importance of the India-UK ties.

Meanwhile, Lisa Nandy is reappointed to the ministerial role she has been in charge of

since July 2024 with the additional responsibility for digital services too.

The 44-year-old Manchester-born daughter of Calcutta-born academic Dipak Nandy and English mother Luise Byers is a close ally of Burnham as his Makerfield constituency neighbour in Wigan, within the Greater Manchester region. In the lead-up to the elevation of the region’s former mayor to prime minister, she vouched for her new boss being “faster and bolder” in the Labour Party’s reform agenda.

Among the other key Cabinet appointments, South Asian heritage Shabana Mahmood holds on to her role as Home Secretary, which she described as “the best job in the business.” PTI

Israel building earthen barrier inside Gaza, dividing the strip

Lee Keath & Julia Frankel
Cairo, July 21

THE ISRAELI military is quietly but quickly building a giant earthen barrier separating the over 50% of the Gaza Strip it controls from the rest of the territory, according to satellite imagery, further entrenching the division of the tiny Palestinian enclave.

More than 23 kilometers (14 miles) have been constructed in recent months, running through Palestinian communities demolished by the military. That is equivalent to more than half the length of the coastal strip, which is some 40 kilometers long and 11 kilometers wide, and home to over 2 million Palestinians.

When presented with the satellite images, Israel’s mili-



A satellite image from Planet Labs PBC shows a section of an earthen barrier being built in Gaza. AP

tary confirmed to The Associated Press it has built a physical barrier in the area of the so-called yellow line, the boundary to which Israeli troops withdrew under the October

ceasefire deal with Hamas.

The line was envisioned in the US-backed agreement as a temporary division of the territory pending a fuller Israeli withdrawal. AP

Trump gov't opens probe into Harvard's financial aid for international students

Associated Press
Washington, July 21

THE JUSTICE Department is investigating whether Harvard University is allowing Chinese donors to create scholarships that exclude American students, adding to the barrage of federal inquiries the Trump administration has opened in its battle against the Ivy League school.

Justice Department officials announced the new review Monday, saying Harvard’s foreign funding disclosures “raised concerns” about possible discrimination against US students. The agency did not specify which scholarship programs are being targeted and emphasized it “has not reached any conclusions.” The investi-



Harvard University campus

gation is aimed at Harvard’s “China-based financial aid programs,” the Justice Department said. The agency said Chinese donors have given money to Harvard to support financial aid programs limited to students from certain countries. That restriction could amount to illegal discrimination based on country of origin, the de-

partment said.

“Schools cannot take federal dollars and then turn around and accept money from foreign sources to give financial aid that deliberately excludes American citizens - doing so is illegal, and we will stop it wherever we find it,” said Harmeet Dhillon, who leads the department’s Civil Rights Division.

Harvard said it was reviewing the Justice Department notice. “Harvard follows the law for required reporting of donations and, consistent with our legal obligations under Title VI, does not unlawfully discriminate on the basis of race, ethnicity, or national origin in allocating financial aid,” the university said in a written statement.

• BRIEFLY

NEPAL

PM Balen Shah likely to meet Indian, Chinese envoys soon



Nepal PM Balen Shah

AFTER FOUR months in power, PM Balen Shah has finally agreed to meet the envoys of India and China, said a close aide. “PM Shah will soon be meeting the ambassadors of two immediate neighbours, India and China. He will be meeting them soon,” the aide told The Indian Express, adding that the dates are yet to be worked out. As pressure built on Shah from his ministers, party MPs and the Opposition — who warned him that undermining Parliament and bypassing diplomatic practices will be detrimental to Nepal’s as well as his own image — Shah seems to have relented. In the past ten days, the PM also held separate meetings with leaders of business and industries, as well as women entrepreneurs, promising all possible support from the government to create an investment-friendly environment. “Last week, he also decided to meet the envoys of India and China — something Foreign Affairs Minister Shisir Khanal had been suggesting,” sources said. REUTERS

VIETNAM

Bus bursts into flames after crash, 7 killed

SEVEN PEOPLE died and five were injured when a bus carrying passengers overnight burst into flames after crashing into roadside embankments near southern Vietnam’s Dong Nai City early Monday, authorities said. State media VN Express said that the accident took place at around 2:30 a.m., when the bus veered off the road and struck an embankment. It continued moving before hitting a second embankment and coming to a stop. AP

GREECE

Man stabs tourists near the Acropolis

A MAN stabbed and wounded two tourists Tuesday morning near the ancient Acropolis in Athens, Greece’s top tourist attraction, police said, in what appeared to be a random attack. The assailant, identified only as a 60-year-old Greek man, attacked a Greek American couple with a knife on a pedestrian street near an entrance to the archaeological site and near the entrance to the Acropolis Museum, which lies at the foot of the Acropolis hill. AP

• NEIGHBOURHOOD WATCH

NEPAL

Govt withdraws 3% tax on pvt education, health

NEPAL GOVERNMENT on Tuesday withdrew the three per cent equity tax imposed on private education and health sectors following widespread public criticism. In a social media post, PM Balendra Shah said the decision was taken after the proposed levy triggered concerns over additional financial burden on the public. PTI

PAKISTAN

12 people killed in rain-related incidents in KPK

AT LEAST 12 people, including five children, have been killed and 18 injured in various incidents triggered by heavy rains and flash floods across Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, authorities said on Tuesday. The casualties occurred due to collapsing roofs and walls of houses, as well as people being swept away by flash floods, according to a report PDMA. PTI

Philippines, China summon each other’s envoys over South China Sea incident

Reuters
Beijing, Manila, July 21

PHILIPPINE PRESIDENT Ferdinand Marcos Jr. will summon China’s ambassador in Manila, his office said on Tuesday, hours after Manila’s envoy in Beijing was similarly summoned following accusations by both sides of provoking tensions in the contested South China Sea.

Presidential Communications Undersecretary Claire Castro confirmed to reporters Marcos had summoned Chinese Ambassador Jing Quan at 5 pm on Tuesday.

The summoning of ambassadors comes a day after the

Philippines and China accused each other an encounter in the Second Thomas Shoal of the South China Sea. Philippine officials said one of its navy personnel was struck on the head but Beijing said Manila provoked the incident.

“The Philippine side provoked the incident first, yet has turned around and made counter-accusations, distorted the facts and engaged in malicious hype,” the Chinese foreign ministry said. The CCG said two rubber boats sent by the Philippines’ grounded vessel BRP Sierra Madre rammed into a Chinese patrol boat in the South China Sea.

• EAST ASIAN CRIME SYNDICATES ARE RUNNING BUSINESSES THAT USE MALWARE, GENERATIVE AI AND DEEPFAKES FOR SEXUAL EXTORTION AND EXPLOITATION

UN: International criminal groups using technology to expand in and beyond Asia

Associated Press
Bangkok, July 21

SOUTHEAST ASIA-BASED criminal groups are using increasingly integrated networks and technology to build a rapidly growing illicit economy with tentacles that reach far beyond Asia, with scams alone causing estimated combined losses of \$88.3 billion to \$114.1 billion in 2025, a UN report says.

The report by the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime outlines how transnational crime that used to be concentrated in Southeast Asia has expanded to other regions, while global criminal groups are increasingly engaging in drug,

human and wildlife trafficking in Asia. Criminals are using new technologies to launder money through global financial systems and using artificial intelligence to steal from victims worldwide, said the report, released Tuesday. One key finding of the report is the threat to children both from AI and from online gaming, as hundreds of scam compounds scattered across Southeast Asia provide venues for sex trafficking and selling of child sexual abuse content.

“There is a huge jump in AI-generated child sexual images... communicated through encrypted communications platforms,” said Inshik Sim, UNODC researcher and coordinator for

the report, told reporters at a briefing at the Foreign Correspondents Club of Thailand.

East Asian crime syndicates are running businesses that use malware, generative AI and deepfakes for sexual extortion and exploitation in a trend that increases risks of in-person abuse as well as livestreamed abuse and grooming of victims. Apart from outright trafficking for the sex industry, victims can be sold into domestic servitude, forced begging and forced labor, among other forms of exploitation, the report says.

Social media and online gaming and gambling also pose dangers for children, the report notes, citing surveys showing



An estimated loss of \$88.3 billion to \$114.1 bn was reported in 2025. AP

that hundreds of children and teens across Southeast Asia are engaged in online gambling, some to the extent of addiction.

The report estimates the combined annual sales of illicit drugs in Southeast Asia and nearby countries at up to \$109

billion, with seizures of illegal shipments soaring. That includes methamphetamines, heroin and ketamine.

It points to the Sulu-Celebes maritime “triangle” between Indonesia, Malaysia and the Philippines as an increasingly important corridor for shipments of cocaine from Latin America to Asia, with illicit cargoes sometimes embedded in legitimate shipments such as Chinese tea.

The area is also often used for smuggling of wildlife and small arms, the report says.

Meanwhile, Thailand and Vietnam increasingly are the source of cannabis sent to Japan, where it is illegal, and to Europe, it says. Earlier this year, author-

ities in Malaysia’s Sabah seized more than 3 tons of methamphetamine, ketamine and ecstasy in the largest such seizure for Sabah so far. The report outlines how cross-border financial and technology networks are supporting what it calls a “criminal service infrastructure” that facilitates global organized crime. The tools used include cryptocurrency, encrypted and private communications platforms and generative AI to create convincing phishing content, deploy real-time deepfake videos and voice calls. Using AI-powered translations, they can target victims across many languages at the same time, the report says.

Satellite communications also enable scam compounds to operate in places that are remote or subject to close surveillance.

To counter this growing criminal ecosystem, authorities need a coordinated, cross-border strategy that integrates enforcement across data, communications and financial systems, and online services and marketplaces, the report said.

As authorities in Thailand, China and elsewhere have raided industrial-sized scam centres mostly located in border regions of Myanmar, Laos and Cambodia, criminals have responded by shifting to other parts of the world or operating on a smaller scale. AP

WEDNESDAY, JULY 22, 2026



The Indian EXPRESS

JOURNALISM of COURAGE

NEW DELHI, LATE CITY, 22 PAGES

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POLICE, CENTRE UNDER FIRE OVER CRACKDOWN ON PROTESTERS; PAWAR, UDDHAV, KEJRIWAL GO TO JANTAR MANTAR

Opposition rallies behind protesters, LoP holds sit-in outside PM residence



Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi and SP's Akhilesh Yadav being detained outside the PM's residence, Tuesday. ABHINAV SAHA

Rahul, Priyanka, Akhilesh detained; Cong chose spectacle over debate, says Pradhan

Manoj C G & Asad Rehman
New Delhi, July 21

A DAY after police used tear gas and lathis to stop thousands of young protesters from marching towards Parliament to seek the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan over exam paper leaks, Opposition parties rallied behind them Tuesday, visiting the protest site, meeting the injured, echoing

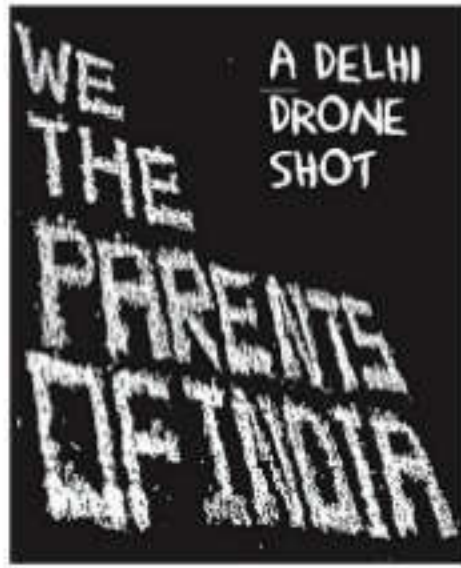
their demands and staging a sit-in outside the Prime Minister's residence in New Delhi.

Turning up the heat on the government, Opposition leaders slammed the police use of force against the protesters, many of them students, and targeted the government by calling it "insensitive" and "authoritarian".

Joining the chorus for Pradhan's resignation, the Congress staged a sit-in outside the Prime

Minister's residence at 7, Lok Kalyan Marg. Top leaders detained after a nearly three-hour protest included Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi, Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, Karnataka Chief Minister D K Shivakumar, Congress leader and MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra and Samajwadi Party president Akhilesh Yadav. They were released later.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Business as Usual
By EP UNNNY

INSIDE



AFTER HC NOD, SONAM MOVED TO PRIVATE HOSPITAL **P 3, 4, 6**

EDUCATION'S FALLING BUDGET SHARE IN 12 YRS **EXPLAINED, P 14**

Day after, injured back at Jantar Mantar protest site: 'Weak in body, not in resolve'

Tabshir Shams, Drishti Jain & Vidheesha Kuntamalla
New Delhi, July 21

A TEACHER, an unemployed graduate, a clothing shop owner, a student, shop worker, a social worker, and many more.

Several protesters who had spent Monday night in hospital after being injured in the police crackdown on the CJP-led

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Some of the injured protesters at Jantar Mantar, Tuesday. ABHINAV SAHA

20 dead after blast at under-construction tunnel in Sikkim

5 trapped; methane gas leak suspected

Sweety Kumari
Kolkata, July 21

A BLAST that officials suspect was caused by a methane gas leak inside an under-construction tunnel in Sikkim's Namchi district on Monday has led to the death of at least 20 people and left five others trapped.

The incident occurred inside a seven-km under-construction tunnel of the Teesta Stage-VI Hydroelectric Project near Samardung. Those at the site at the time of the incident included high-level personnel from the National Hydroelectric Power Corporation and project developer Patel Engineering, who were on a routine inspection.

"Out of those 25 trapped inside the tunnel, 20 are confirmed dead," Namchi

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



An ambulance at the under-construction tunnel in Sikkim's Namchi district, Tuesday. PTI

Future of youth beyond politics, says PM, calls for 'foolproof' exams

Liz Mathew, Jatin Anand & Anonna Dutt
New Delhi, July 21

IN FIRST remarks after police cracked down on Cockroach Janta Party-led protesters marching towards Parliament to press for the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan, Prime Minister Narendra Modi, while defending the steps taken by his government in the wake of the NEET-UG question paper leak, called for a "foolproof system" to prevent any future occurrence of an exam paper leak.

Speaking at a meeting of NDA parliamentary party leaders Tuesday, Modi suggested that MPs take the lead in reaching out to students across the nation on the issue, underlining that the future of the youth was top priority and all parties should treat it as a national issue rather than an opportunity for partisan politics.

He promised the "strictest possible punishment" to those



Union Health Minister J P Nadda with an injured person at Lady Hardinge Hospital, Tuesday. PTI

behind the NEET paper leak. "Ek ek ko dandit karna hoga (each one of them has to be punished)," he was quoted as having said.

Following the meeting, Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju said the Prime Minister sought a "foolproof system" to prevent future exam paper leaks.

"On the NEET examination, the Prime Minister said the

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Govt signal: Ready for debate, demand for resignation political

Ritika Chopra
Mumbai, July 21

THE DEMAND for the Education Minister's resignation is "political" and there's no "succumbing" to it; the lapses behind the NEET leak have been fixed; admissions under the three largest entrance examinations, NEET retest, CUET and JEE Main, are largely on track; and the Government is open to a debate on the issue in Parliament.

This was the "official" sense at the senior level of the Government Tuesday, a day after the Jantar Mantar protests,

which started with the NEET leak controversy, intensified leading to a police crackdown in the heart of the capital.

In conversations with *The Indian Express*, senior government functionaries said the Centre has no intention of yielding to demands for Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation, arguing that it has neither denied the lapses nor attempted to evade responsibility.

"There was a problem. We have said this on record and have taken responsibility on

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Happening today

● **UNION MINISTER S** Jaishankar to be in Philippines for a two-day visit, during which he will attend meetings under ASEAN framework and also meet his counterparts from Quad countries. **P 5**

● **THE RAM TEMPLE TRUST** will hold its second meeting amid the donation 'theft' row.

NATION

SENA (UBT) MOVES SC AGAINST 6 MPs' MERGER WITH SHINDE PARTY **P 5**

The TN effect

In 2023-24, Tamil Nadu accounted for nearly half the women directly employed (contract staff excluded) in the manufacture of computers,

EXPRESS special

Census: 6 months to go, Govt explores how to count caste

Two options are self-declaration or drop-down menu of recognised castes; RSS among those with objections

Deeptiman Tiwary
New Delhi, July 21

WITH THE population enumeration phase of the nationwide Census just six months away, the Registrar General of India (RGI) is learnt to be grappling with the methodology for caste enumeration that is meant to be a part of it. Sources said two broad options are under consideration: allowing respondents to state their caste in an open-ended format or restricting entries to a drop-down menu of recognised castes.

While the first option risks a repeat of the 2011 Socio Economic and Caste Census (SECC) experience, when more than 46 lakh distinct caste names were listed by respondents, the second is learnt to have run into resistance from the RSS. The Sangh Parivar believes a drop-down menu based on existing caste lists would effectively reinforce the caste architecture institutionalised during British rule.

E. EXPLAINED

Choices before Govt

While one option risks a repeat of the 2011 SECC, when more than 46 lakh distinct caste names were listed by respondents, the Sangh Parivar believes a drop-down menu would effectively reinforce the caste architecture institutionalised during British rule.

"It is a difficult exercise. There are multiple suggestions and objections, all of which are being considered. Various methods are being tested, including open-ended enumeration and ways to avoid a repeat of the 2011 outcome. Caste is a sensitive subject, and any error can have serious political ramifications," a government source said.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



THE BIG PICTURE
KEN, BETWA AND A LINE DRAWN ON WATER **PAGE 13**

India summons Russia envoy over killing of 4 sailors: 'Grave concern'



Russian Charge d'Affaires Vladimir Ladanov at the Ministry of External Affairs in New Delhi on Tuesday. ANI

MEA: Targeting of commercial shipping is unacceptable

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, July 21

INDIA ON Tuesday summoned the Russian Charge d'Affaires (CDA) and conveyed "unequivocal condemnation" and "grave concern" over the deaths of four Indian seafarers in a Russian missile strike on a merchant vessel off the coast of Ukraine.

"Today, the Russian Chargé d'Affaires, Mr Vladimir Ladanov, was summoned to the Ministry of External Affairs. The Ministry conveyed India's grave concerns and unequivocal condemnation of the attack on the commercial vessel *MV Golden Leo* on 19 July 2026, which resulted in the tragic loss of four Indian lives, emphasising that such attacks undermine the safety, security and stability of international maritime commerce," the MEA said in a statement.

"The Russian Chargé d'Affaires was requested to convey India's strong concerns to his

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

● COIMBATORE AND MADURAI AT TOP IN FEMALE LABOUR FORCE PARTICIPATION RATE, MINISTRY DATA SHOWS

With a page out of China book, TN maintains lead in share of women workers

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, July 21

NEW DATA underlines how Tamil Nadu remains closest in India to replicating China's women-led electronics manufacturing model, with other states far behind.

The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation's (MoSPI) recent report on the labour market in India's 46 most populous cities (with a population of more than 10 lakh as per Census

2011) shows that two Tamil Nadu cities — Coimbatore at 41.3% and Madurai at 37% — rank in the top three when it comes to the female Labour Force Participation Rate. This is well above the urban India average of 27.7%.

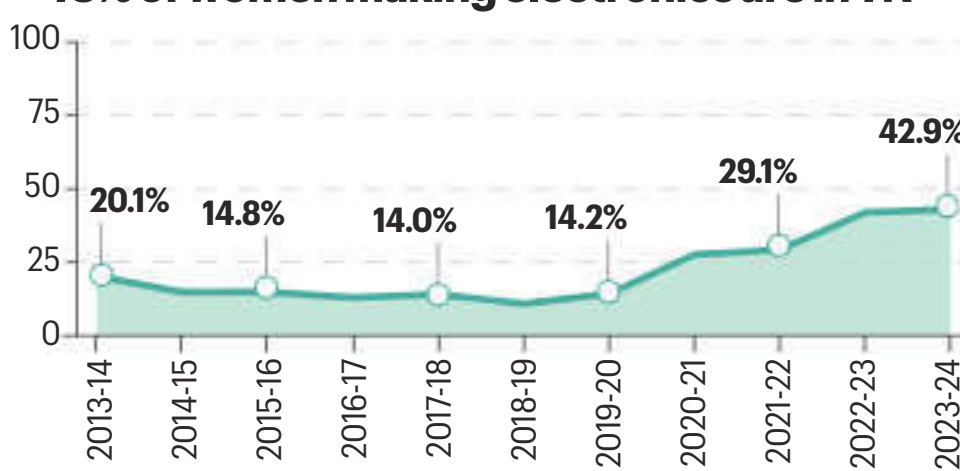
The Labour Force Participation Rate refers to the percentage of people either already employed or looking for work.

Sandwiched between the two, at 40.6%, is Surat. However, the Annual Survey of In-

dustries data shows that Gujarat's share among women employed in the manufacture of computers, electronics and optical products remained stagnant at 10% from 2013-14 to 2023-24, even as it grew from 20% to 43% for Tamil Nadu in the same period.

At the same time, Maharashtra and Karnataka saw notable declines in the share of women they employ in the manufacture of computers, electronics and optical products — 24% to 6%, and 11% to 8%, between 2013-14 and 2023-24.

● 43% of women making electronics are in TN



NOTE: DATA FOR DIRECTLY EMPLOYED WOMEN AS PERCENTAGE OF DIRECTLY EMPLOYED WORKERS, COVERS MANUFACTURE OF COMPUTER, ELECTRONIC, AND OPTICAL PRODUCTS
SOURCE: MoSPI

DAY AFTER CJP ‘SANSAD CHALO’ MARCH



Delhi Police maintain vigil at the protest site in Jantar Mantar on Tuesday. GAJENDRA YADAV

Police lodge 6 FIRs, look for ‘larger conspiracy’ in Parliament march

Alok Singh
New Delhi, July 21

A DAY after violence erupted during the Cockroach Janta Party’s (CJP) protest march from Jantar Mantar to Parliament, the Delhi Police on Tuesday registered six FIRs and launched a probe into whether the violence was part of a larger conspiracy to disrupt peace in the Capital.

The FIRs were registered against unidentified people at Parliament Street, Barakhamba and Connaught Place police stations under sections related to rioting, damage to government and private property, and assaulting public servants on duty.

Police said the number of FIRs could increase as investigators continue to assess the alleged vandalism and damage caused during the CJP march.

Sources said the investigating team is examining CCTV footage, including that from cameras equipped with facial recognition technology, to identify those involved in the violence and attacks on police personnel. “We are also reviewing social media posts and mobile phone recordings as part of the probe,” the source said.

In a statement, the Delhi Police said protesters displayed “unruly, aggressive and violent behaviour” and refused to dis-

perse and deliberately violated prohibitory orders”. “The protesters attacked police personnel with stones and other objects, attempted to breach police barricades, vandalised police and other government vehicles, damaged public property, and resorted to large-scale violence, posing a serious threat to public order, the security arrangements in place, and the safety of police personnel performing their lawful duties,” it added.

The police further said that protesters caused extensive damage to public property, vandalising 15 to 20 government vehicles and other properties.

More than 50,000 people had gathered for the march on Monday, with the police appearing to be outnumbered as protesters advanced toward the Parliament.

As the police used force, including batons and tear gas, to bring the situation under control, more than 200 people, including more than 100 police officers, were injured in the violence.

The police had said more than 118 of its personnel were injured, including senior officers ranging from special commissioners of police to assistant commissioners of police, as well as several women officers.

Clashes at 4 places, first one at Sansad Marg, say police in internal report

Mahender Singh Manral
New Delhi, July 21

THE DELHI Police used “mild force” on Monday to bring the situation under control after clashes mainly at four locations – Sansad Marg, Rail Bhawan roundabout, Jantar Mantar, and the Connaught Place Outer Circle-Janpath stretch – the New Delhi district police have said in an internal report, *The Indian Express* has learned.

At a meeting held in the office of DCP (New Delhi district) Sachin Sharma on Monday night, Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar was informed that the district police had begun preparing a factual report on the events of the day, a source said.

The Special CP (law and order) and other senior police officers attended the meeting. Queries sent to DCP Sharma and the spokesperson for Delhi Police did not elicit responses.

According to the New Delhi district police report, close to 200 police personnel, including senior officers, were injured in the clashes.

“On Sunday, police, after coordinating with multiple



Security officers at the protest site in Jantar Mantar in New Delhi on Tuesday. ABHINAV SAHA

agencies, had initially estimated that around 10,000 to 15,000 people would take part in the Parliament march on July 20, and security arrangements were made accordingly. However, the crowd began swelling through the day and, by afternoon, over 50,000 people had joined the demonstration,” a source said.

The report is learned to have said that the first confrontation took place on Sansad Marg.

“Three layers of barricades had been put up to stop the march – the first at Tolstoy Marg, the second on Sansad Marg and the third near Trans-

port Bhawan. Around 10.30 am, protesters allegedly broke through the barricade at Tolstoy Marg and moved towards the one on Sansad Marg, which too, they breached. With only the barricade near Transport Bhawan left between the crowd and the high-security zone, security personnel used force to disperse the protesters,” the source said.

After being pushed back from Sansad Marg, sections of the crowd moved through Raisina Road towards Rail Bhawan, located near Parliament House. “Between 1.30 pm and 2 pm, the protesters allegedly

turned violent and began throwing footwear and stones at police personnel. Police said force was used again to remove them from the area,” the source added.

In view of the violence, the police decided to clear Jantar Mantar, where protesters had been camping.

“Around 4-5 pm, police and security forces used mild force to remove the demonstrators from the site. After being cleared from Jantar Mantar, several protesters moved towards Kerala House, while a large number headed towards Janpath and the Connaught Place Outer Circle,” the source said.

As per the report, around 4.30-5.30 pm, police alleged that some protesters indulged in stone-pelting and vandalised police vehicles in the area, following which force was used again to disperse the crowd.

“Protesters who had gathered near Kerala House returned to Jantar Mantar around 7.30 pm. The report is expected to be submitted to senior officers at Delhi Police headquarters,” the source added.

Govt to issue Smart Property Cards in Lal Dora areas, 48 villages to be covered under SVAMITVA scheme

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 21

THE DELHI government is conducting a comprehensive survey of all Lal Dora Abadi villages to create digital records and will soon issue ‘Smart Property Cards’ to address the issues being faced by the residents.

According to officials, 48 villages will be covered under the Centre’s SVAMITVA scheme through an agreement with the Survey of India. Surveys have been completed in 30 of these villages and their final property cards have been prepared.

Lal Dora areas in Delhi are village habitation zones demarcated in revenue records with a red line. Originally designated to distinguish residential village settlements from surrounding agricultural land, these areas have a distinct land use status and are subject to specific regulations governing construction and development.

For instance, the Bed and Breakfast (B&B) in Malviya Nagar where a fatal fire broke out in June is in the Lal Dora zone, with the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) claiming that it being a Lal Dora property is exempt from municipal building norms.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta Tuesday said that for years, the absence of systematic and authenticated property records in Lal Dora areas has caused numerous difficulties for residents. “The Delhi government will soon issue Smart Property Cards to eligible beneficiaries. Our government believes that these cards will play a significant role in safeguarding the interests and securing the future of rural residents,” Gupta said.

The process of integrating digital signatures and rolling out Smart Property Cards is now in its final stage, said officials, adding that the surveys covering 12,232 properties

(polygons) have been completed so far. Of these, 8,423 properties or 69% are dispute-free. All surveyed properties in the South and North West districts are dispute-free, they said. Work is underway in other districts.

The CM said that the initiative is built entirely on a modern digital system. The process begins with the demarcation of Lal Dora boundaries, followed by an aerial drone survey. Revenue department officials then verify the maps on the ground against the actual position of the properties. “If any discrepancies are found, they are reported to the Survey of India for necessary corrections. Each property is then assigned a unique Property Identification Number (PID), following which a property card is issued to the occupier,” Gupta said. Officials said that the record will be integrated with the Delhi Online Registration Information System (DORIS).

Woman, her two minor children die in blaze at Lodhi Colony residence

Mishal Mussaddique
New Delhi, July 21

A WOMAN and her two daughters – aged 8 and 12 – died in a fire that broke out on the third floor of a residential building in South Delhi’s Lodhi Colony on Tuesday morning.

Police identified the deceased as Akanksha Sharma (40), Maheen (8) and Aradhya (12), residents of B Block at B K Dutt Colony. At the time of the incident, other family members, including Akanksha’s husband Mohit Sharma, were present in their home on the second floor, DCP (South) Anant Mittal said. Mohit is a lawyer in the Delhi High Court, police said.

The Delhi Fire Services (DFS) received a call regarding the fire at 10.21 am. Three fire tenders were rushed to douse the blaze and it was brought under control at 11.10 am.

“The exact cause of the fire is under investigation. No sign of foul play has come to notice at this stage, however, all angles are being probed,” Mittal added.

According to neighbours, besides the couple and their two daughters, Mohit’s mother Sarita also lived at the residence spread across the second and third floor of the building. “Mohit has lived here with his father, late Narender Kumar Sharma, who was also an advocate, for 12-15 years,” said Jeevan, a neighbour.

Joshiy, a resident of the colony, said his wife noticed smoke billowing from the third floor of the building around 10 am.

“The police and the fire-fighters arrived around half-an-hour later. By the time I arrived at the building, a couple of the neighbours had already started a rescue operation.”

Rahul Nawariya, a neighbour, said, “I was having breakfast when my mother started screaming. We saw smoke coming out of the third floor of



At the site of the blaze in Lodhi Colony in which three members of a family died on Tuesday. GAJENDRA YADAV

Mohit’s house. Five to seven ran up the main stairwell to the second floor.”

“We rang the bell and Mohit

and his mother opened the door. They did not know about the fire on the floor above. We went up to the third floor and

The exact cause of the fire is under probe and no sign of foul play has come to notice at this stage, said DCP (South) Anant Mittal

found their room locked. We tried to force the metal door open, but that was useless,” Rahul said.

Following this, Rahul said, he and two others forced open the wooden door of the balcony attached to the room.

“As we opened the balcony door, one of the resident’s hair caught fire. As I tried pushing the door open, I could feel something was blocking it. It was one of the girls lying motionless by the door. There was someone on the bed as well. We couldn’t make out anyone due to the fire and smoke,” he added.

Relatives and advocates came to visit the family. One of the relative, who wishes to be anonymous, said, “All of us had met in December. I can’t believe what has happened. I carried the children in my arms not so long ago.”

**NATIONAL FERTILIZERS LIMITED**
(A Govt. of India Undertaking)
A-11, Sector-24, Noida-201301
Ph.: 0120-2412294/2412445, Extn.1112, Fax: 0120-2412397

E-TENDER NOTICE
Bids are invited on GeM portal for the contract “Upkeep & Maintenance of NFL Corporate Office, NFL Registered Office, NFL House and Crèche Noida” for a period of two years. GeM Tender No. GEM/2026/B/7806190 dated 18.07.2026. Last date for submission is **28.07.2026 by 20:00 (PM)**. For details, visit website: www.nationalfertilizers.com/GeM Portal. Note: For any corrigendum /addendum kindly refer our website. **Chief Manager I/c (HR-Admin)**

**केन्द्रीय भंडारण निगम**
(एक नवरत्न सीपीएसई)
CENTRAL WAREHOUSING CORPORATION
(A NAVRATNA CPSE)

No. CWC/B&C/ED/7(1) (d)/2026-27 **Dated: 20.07.2026**
CANCELLATION OF ELECTION
It is to inform that Shri Manish Sahani of The Uttar Pradesh State Cooperative Bank Ltd., Lucknow is elected unopposed as Director on the Board of Central Warehousing Corporation representing ‘Other Scheduled Banks’ under section 7(1) (d) of the Warehousing Corporations Act, 1962 for a period of three years w.e.f. 05.08.2026 to 04.08.2029. As such the election meeting scheduled to be held on 05.08.2026 has been cancelled.
Secretary, CWC

**NATIONAL FERTILIZERS LIMITED**
(A Govt. of India Undertaking)
CIN: L74899DL1974GOI007417
Registered Office: Scope Complex, Core -III, 7, Institutional Area, Lodhi Road, New Delhi 110003 Website: www.nationalfertilizers.com, Email ID: investor@nfl.co.in, Telephone: 011-24360066, 24361252

Notice to Shareholders
FOR TRANSFER OF EQUITY SHARES OF THE COMPANY TO THE INVESTOR EDUCATION AND PROTECTION FUND (IEPF)
This Notice is published pursuant to the provisions of Section 124(6) of the Companies Act, 2013 and Investor Education and Protection Fund Authority (Accounting, Audit, Transfer and Refund) Rules, 2016 (“the Rules”), as amended from time to time.
The Rules, inter alia, contain provisions for transfer of all shares in respect of which dividend has remained unpaid or unclaimed by the shareholders for seven consecutive years or more to the Demat account of IEPF Authority.
In this regard, the Final Dividend declared for the financial year 2018-19, which remained unclaimed or unpaid for a period of seven consecutive years will be credited to the IEPF on or after October 24, 2026 but not later than November 23, 2026. The corresponding shares on which dividends were unclaimed or unpaid for seven consecutive years will also be transferred as per the procedure set out in the Rules.
In compliance with the rules, Individual notices have also been sent to all the concerned shareholders whose shares are liable to be transferred to IEPF as per the aforesaid rules, the full details of such shareholders including their names, folio nos. or DP ID/ Client ID is also made available on the Company’s Website at www.nationalfertilizers.com.
In this connection, please note the following:
1) In case you hold shares in physical form: Duplicate share certificate (s) will be issued and transferred to IEPF. The original share certificate(s) registered in your name(s) and held by you will stand automatically cancelled.
2) In case you hold shares in electronic form: Your demat account will be debited for the shares liable for transfer to the IEPF.
In the event valid claim is not received on or before October 15, 2026, the Company will proceed to transfer the liable dividend and Equity shares in favour of IEPF authority without any further notice. Please note that no claim shall lie against the Company in respect of unclaimed dividend amount and shares transferred to IEPF pursuant to the said rules. It may be noted that the concerned shareholders can claim the shares and dividend from IEPF authority by making an application in the prescribed Form IEPF-5 online and sending the physical copy of the requisite documents enumerated in the Form IEPF-5, to the Company Secretary of the Company.
For any queries on the above matter, shareholders are requested to contact the Company’s Registrar and Share Transfer Agent M/s. MAS Services Limited at investor@masserv.com.
Place: New Delhi **For National Fertilizers Limited,**
Date: 22.07.2026 **Sd/-**
(Ashok Jha)
Company Secretary

**VCSG UHF, Bharsar, Pauri Garhwal- 246123**

VACANCY
Few positions of the university are advertised in the University for recruitment. For details, please visit Website i.e. www.uuhf.ac.in
Registrar
VCSG UHF, Bharsar Pauri Garhwal

Nanaji Deshmukh Veterinary Science University, Jabalpur (M.P.)

Admission Notice for 2026-27
Applications are invited for admission in Bachelor of Veterinary Science & Animal Husbandry (B.V.Sc. & A.H.) and Bachelor of Fishery Science (B.F.Sc.) degree courses for the session 2026-27 under following quota seats:
1. Non Resident Indian (NRI) seats
2. Foreign National category seats
3. For wards of Kashmiri Migrants and Kashmiri Pandits /Kashmiri Hindu Families (Non-migrants) living in Kashmir valley
4. For students from Union Territories of Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh
For details visit University website: www.ndvsu.org The last date for submission of application form is **31st August, 2026**. Corrigendum, if any, will only be posted in above website, no press notice will be issued separately.
No. 2694/2026 Date: 21/07/2026 **Registrar**

**PUBLIC NOTICE**

APPLICATION FOR AMENDMENT OF REGISTRATION OF THE PROJECT NAMEDLY “WATERFALL SUITES” SITUATED IN SECTOR- 36A, GURUGRAM BEING DEVELOPED BY M/s KRISUMI CORPORATION PVT. LTD.
It is for the information of the general public and existing allottees of the project namely “WATERFALL SUITES” situated in Sector-36A, Gurugram that an application dated 10.07.2026 for amendment of registration of the above real estate project registered under Section 4 of the Act of 2016 is submitted in the Authority by M/s KRISUMI CORPORATION PVT. LTD.
The Promoter (M/s KRISUMI CORPORATION PVT. LTD.) in collaboration with landowners obtained the licenses from Director, Town and Country Planning Department (DTCP), Haryana, vide license no.’s 39 of 2013 dated 04.06.2013, 85 of 2014 dated 08.08.2014, 166 of 2023 dated 18.08.2023 and 71 of 2024 dated 28.06.2024 for total area admeasuring 33.3813 acres for setting up of Mix Land Use Colony in Sector-36A, Gurugram.
The promoter has obtained the revised phasing plan approval vide DRG no. DTCP 10577 dated 14.11.2024. The total license area is being developed in ten phases out of which six phases are already registered with the Authority. The Promoter obtained the approval of revised building plans of the project “WATERFALL SUITES” vide memo no. ZP-915-II/PA(DK)/2023/2405 dated 25.01.2023. Accordingly, the above project is registered with the HARERA, Gurugram vide registration certificate no. 59 of 2023 dated 08.05.2023.
Thereafter, the promoter obtained the approval of revised building plans for phase 2 (EWS Block) vide memo no. ZP-915/PA(DK)/2024/5471 dated 13.02.2024 and ZP-915A/JD(RA)/2025/2922 dated 23.01.2025 from DTCP, Haryana. Now, the promoter has approached the Authority for amendment in the registration certificate no. 59 of 2023 pursuant to the revision of building plans as mentioned above.
It is further informed that, in terms of Section 14(2)(ii) of the Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act, 2016, any alteration or addition to the sanctioned plan of a project requires the prior written consent of at least two-thirds of the allottees. The promoter has submitted written consent of 193 allottees out of total 244 unique allottees of the project which is more than two third of the total number of allottees in the project as submitted by the promoter.
The Authority is considering the application of the promoter to grant amendment of registration certificate under Section 4 of the Act 2016 for this project and hereby invite objections if any, in this regard.
The relevant application and related documents are available in the office of the Haryana Real Estate Regulatory Authority, Gurugram which can be seen by any concerned on any working day during office hours up to 30.07.2026 from 11:00 AM to 04:00 PM. The objections, if any, shall be filed in the registry of the Authority up to 30.07.2026. Also, if anyone wishes to appear, may appear before the Authority on 03.08.2026 at 11:00 AM during the hearing.
Given under the approval of the Authority and its seal. **Sd/-**
Secretary
Haryana Real Estate Regulatory Authority, Gurugram.
Dated: 17.07.2026

After HC direction on wife's petition, Wangchuk shifted to Medanta Hospital



An ambulance carrying Sonam Wangchuk arrives at Medanta. ANI

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, July 21

ACTIVIST SONAM Wangchuk, who is on his 24th day of hunger strike, was discharged from the Safdarjung Hospital on Tuesday evening and shifted to Medanta Hospital in Gurgaon for further treatment in compliance with a Delhi High Court order.

Wangchuk was brought to the Medanta Hospital in an ambulance at 7.28 pm under tight security. He has been admitted to ICU 8 and his treatment has begun under the supervision of Dr Sushila Kataria, an internal medicine specialist, said a hospital official.

The HC earlier in the day directed that Wangchuk be shifted to a hospital of his choice.

The bench of Chief Justice D K Upadhyaya and Justice Tejas Karia allowed his wife Gitanjali Angmo round-the-clock access to Wangchuk at Medanta Hospital. It also directed that Wangchuk be constantly monitored and that medicines be administered as required in the opinion of the hospital's experts, and that Wangchuk shall abide by the advice.

Wangchuk, who has been on hunger strike since June 28, demanding Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation over NEET paper leaks, was hospitalised at Safdarjung Hospital after Delhi Police swooped in at the protest site in Jantar Mantar on July 18 and moved him to the hospital, citing his health condition.

The court, directing for the shift — as was desired by Wangchuk — opined that he "ought to be shifted to a hospital of his choice" and that it "will be in fulfilment of requirements of his fundamental rights" to life, free movement and personal liberty.

The order comes after HC took note of claims of violation of his fundamental rights — including excessive police searches on him and seized electronic devices — as alleged by Wangchuk in a letter.

Angmo, in her initial petition on July 19, had said that Wangchuk's "continued confinement" at Safdarjung Hospital is "wholly without the authority of law," with no FIR, order of arrest, preventive detention order or any other judicial or executive order authorising



CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke meets protesters. ABHINAV SAHA

"his continued confinement, isolation or denial of access to his legal counsel or doctors who had been examining him for the last 20 days".

"Such deprivation of personal liberty, dehors any procedure established by law, is ex facie violative of Article 21 of the Constitution, and every passing hour of such unlawful confinement constitutes a continuing constitutional injury," she had submitted.

However, the HC — the single judge or the division bench hearing the appeal — did not deal with this contention.

While disposing of the appeal and all pending pleas by Angmo, the HC told her counsel, senior advocate Akhil Sibal, on Tuesday: "The court's concern is only with his safety and protection of fundamental rights, nothing else with what is going on."

Angmo, welcoming the HC verdict, said that Wangchuk will continue his fast in a show of "solidarity with students who were beaten yesterday".

Solicitor General (SG) Tusshar Mehta told the court that he has "no objection" to the proposal to shift, while urging HC that Wangchuk may not discharge himself from Medanta Hospital against medical advice, also known as DAMA.

DAMA and LAMA are medical terms for when a patient leaves the hospital before treatment is finished. While DAMA means 'Discharge Against Medical Advice', LAMA means 'Left (or Leave) Against Medical Advice'.

A day ago, opposing Wangchuk's transfer from Safdarjung, Mehta had argued that his right to bodily autonomy — right to choose his treatment — "cannot be absolute" since any potential harm to him can "have an impact on law and order situation".

On Tuesday, the Resident Doctors' Association at VMMC and Safdarjung Hospital as well as AIIMS sought the President's intervention in relation to Wangchuk's bodily autonomy, including LAMA or the right of a patient to leave hospital against medical advice.

The single-judge bench on July 19 had refused Angmo's request to shift Wangchuk to a hospital of his choice. She had then appealed against the order before a division bench.



Protesters at Jantar Mantar on Tuesday. ABHINAV SAHA

At CJP's resurrected Jantar Mantar stage, the scars of violence and defiant slogans

Devansh Mittal & Vidheesha Kuntamalla
New Delhi, July 21

BY AFTERNOON on Tuesday, the first row in front of the stage at the protest site at Jantar Mantar was packed once again.

Many of them — positioned an iron barricade away from the stage — were among those who got detained or sustained injuries barely 24 hours ago as the police and paramilitary forces used teargas and resorted to lathicharge to manage Cockroach Janta Party (CJP)-led protesters who took part in the 'San-sad Chalo March'.

On Tuesday, many turned up with bandages on the foreheads, wrists or ankles; and casts on their legs or hands. Sitting before a hastily rebuilt stage, they raised slogans again.

The protest site, however, bore little resemblance to what it looked like the previous after-

noon. Some were heard saying: "We are not scared of the police."

On Monday, several protesters, to shield themselves against police action, had arrived at Jantar Mantar, believing it would be a safe refuge. Within minutes, however, teargas shells were fired and lathicharge followed. In less than 10 minutes, the month-old protest site — the centrepiece of the CJP campaign — was emptied, the stage dismantled.

Even as many thought that the crackdown had brought the protest to an end, by Monday night, volunteers started returning. By Tuesday morning, they had rebuilt the stage. It stood draped in freshly tied red cloth, with mattresses and pillows strewn across the carpeted platform. The repairs were hurried, and the violence of the previous day was visible. The canopy had been torn on the backdrop. Sections of its metal frame re-



Security personnel at Jantar Mantar. ABHINAV SAHA

mained bent.

Addressing the gathering, Dipke announced that the organisation would pursue legal action against Delhi Police over Monday's crackdown. When he asked the crowd if they were prepared to spend a few more days at the site, the response came in the form of loud cheers.

Meanwhile, several opposition leaders, including NCP (SP) president Sharad Pawar,

AAP chief Arvind Kejriwal, Shiv Sena (UBT) chief Uddhav Thackeray visited the site on Tuesday and extended support to the agitation.

At one end of the stage stood portraits of Sonam Wangchuk alongside photographs of students who had died by suicide in the aftermath of the NEET re-exam controversy. Organisers also converted a smaller platform into a relief

area for the injured. Beside the stage, hundreds of shoes and slippers had been carefully arranged in a large rectangle across the road — a silent monument, volunteers said, to the police action a day earlier.

Throughout the afternoon, chants of "Delhi Police, hai hai", "Inquilab Zindabad", "Jai Bhim" and "Dharmendra Pradhan is-tifa do (resign)" rolled across the protest site. Members of outfits, including AISA, SFI, AISE, Collective, DISHA and ASAP formed circles, raising slogans, as police personnel watched from a distance. At intervals, announcements from loudspeakers urged protesters to stop raising slogans.

"The stage that we are sitting on right now was broken around 3.30 pm yesterday," said Eeshna, Delhi in-charge of ASAP, the students' wing of the AAP.

"The forces came in and pushed the students. Many

started running towards the stage and climbed over the barricades behind it. They broke the iron grill between the crowd and the stage where (CJP founder) Abhijeet Dipke and the others were sitting," she said.

She said volunteers spent the entire night rebuilding the camp. "We haven't been able to sleep at all for days."

The camp, however, was struggling to meet even its basic needs. "We have run out of water. There is absolutely no food. It would be of great help if someone comes forward and contributes," Eeshna said.

According to her, different student outfits had divided responsibilities to keep the protest functioning despite the damage. "ASAP is taking care of security, food and water. AISA was on a hunger strike until yesterday. AISE has been mobilising people, and SFI is managing the library we have set up here."

Chhatrasal Stadium turns a detention site

Sakshi Chand & Pragynesh
New Delhi, July 21

AROUND 5 pm on Tuesday, the Chhatrasal stadium in North-west Delhi's Model Town was full of athletes — both professional and novices. Only 16 hours ago, the same venue was occupied by over 50 protesters detained during the Cockroach Janta Party's (CJP) march to the Parliament, after Delhi Police transformed the sporting arena into a temporary holding facility for CJP supporters.

One of them was Ishaan Deor (29), a teacher from Nashik. The CJP protest was not on his mind when he came to the city to meet a friend.

"I had two more days left in Delhi and am also not working right now. So, it felt I was in a much better position than most to participate in the march. A march to Parliament felt more meaningful than a protest at Jantar Mantar, so I decided to join," said Ishaan, who was travelling back to Nashik by train. But his protest was short-lived.

As he reached the Central Secretariat, he found the police had already launched a lathicharge. He was picked up and loaded in a tourist bus — one of the two carrying the protesters. The buses were then driven to the Burari police station.

"We were told our names would be recorded and we would be released. They noted



Outside Chhatrasal Stadium on Tuesday. GAJENDRA YADAV

down our names, but then nothing happened for about an hour," he said.

Then came a tourist bus around 4 pm. Ishaan and the other detainees were made to board the bus and told that they were being taken to the Ramilla ground. But the bus instead arrived at the Chhatrasal Stadium. "We were kept inside the bus for around 40 minutes before being taken inside the stadium, where another group of protesters was already seated," he said.

For the next six hours, Ishaan, along with other detainees, remained seated, with the police arranging food and water for them.

Later that night, Ishaan said, the detainees were divided into smaller groups of six or seven and moved into police SUVs. They were first taken to a hospital before being shifted to different police stations like Model Town, Jahangirpuri and Mukerjee Nagar.

Ishan was taken to the Mukherjee Nagar police station. "A lawyer came and the police officers shouted at us and took our phones away," he said.

Another protester who was detained at the stadium, Harshit (20), is a NEET aspirant who sat for the exam this year before it was cancelled.

"They prepared an arrest memo against me. When I asked what is the need for an arrest memo if this is a detention, the police officers said they have been told that an arrest memo is needed," he said.

An arrest memo is an official legal document prepared by police officers at the time of arresting a person.

Kartik, Harshit's brother and a doctor, added, "I was talking to him until 1 am, when he was at the stadium. He asked me if I was still waiting for him, as the police told him that no one was waiting for him... He was first taken to the Mahendra

Park police station and then to Shalimar Bagh police station."

"I couldn't contact him after he reached the police station as they took away his phone," he added. Harshit said he was taken to Babu Jagjivan Ram Memorial Hospital to file a medico-legal case.

Aman Raj (26), another protester, is a resident of Ved Vihar and works in the finance sector.

"My friends and brothers waited outside Chhatrasal Stadium while I was inside the stadium. The police kept telling us we would be released at 7 pm, then 8 pm, then 11 pm, but we remained there until nearly 2 am," he said. Aman's phone was also confiscated.

"At the police station, they showed me a document, and asked me to sign it. I asked them what it was, they said it's a warning. Then they made me enter a lock-up," he said.

It was Aman's first visit to a police station.

Aman, Harshit and Ishan all alleged that arrest memos were prepared for them by the police.

Meanwhile, a staff member at the stadium told *The Indian Express* that the police arrived in the evening.

"They said they needed the stadium. I locked all the entry and exit gates on their instructions and left. When I returned around 10 am the next morning, no one was here," the staff member said.

Many detained return to Jantar Mantar straight from police stations

Devansh Mittal & Vidheesha Kuntamalla
New Delhi, July 21

LESS THAN 24 hours after being detained during the Cockroach Janta Party's (CJP) march to Parliament, many protesters were back at Jantar Mantar on Tuesday evening. Some among them returned straight from police stations where they spent the night.

Among them was Sameer Dorwal (21). Having come to Jantar Mantar straight from Mandir Marg police station where he was kept in the night after being detained from Tolstoy Road, the Delhi University School of Open Learning student was now more anxious about facing his parents than he had been while facing police barricades, lathis and tear gas.

"I told my parents I was staying at a friend's place," said Sameer. But he is firm on one thing: he will go back home and return to the protest site again.

He said he had furnished a bail bond of Rs 5,000 and has been asked to appear before a magistrate in August.

For Siddharth (22), a law student at IP University, the experience was frightening. "I was very scared when I was picked up. I had no idea what

was going to happen."

Siddharth, who has been staying at the Jantar Mantar for the last three days, said Monday's events had only strengthened his determination. "Education is something that will decide the nation's future, that is why it is important to keep protesting," he said.

At 7.37 pm, cheers erupted across Jantar Mantar as CJP spokesperson Ashutosh Ranka announced that all those detained during Monday's protest had been released.

Among those applauding were Seema Yadav (38) and her 16-year-old daughter Krishna, who had come from Aligarh. For the last five days, they had been staying at Gurdwara Bangla Sahib. "At least 20 police officers took me and my daughter on Monday. They separated us and dragged me for nearly a kilometre. I fainted," Seema alleged.

Krishna, a Class 12 student who wants to become a professor, was detained and taken to Parliament Street police station. "I used to think the police protected people. Yesterday, they pulled me by my hair and told me to go to jail," she said.

Yet, less than a day later, the two returned to the protest site, waiting to meet CJP leader Abhijeet Dipke.

● KIN SAY SHE HAD COME TO DELHI FOR SIGHTSEEING; SOURCES SAY SUFFERED ASPHYXIA IN A STAMPEDE-LIKE SITUATION

Student admitted in ICU after march — corridors in RML quieter, security tighter

Tabshir Shams & Drishti Jain
New Delhi, July 21

BY TUESDAY afternoon, the corridor outside the Intensive Care Unit (ICU) on the fifth floor of Ram Manohar Lohiya Hospital had fallen quiet.

The doors to the ward swung open every few minutes before closing again. Two police officers sat on the staircase outside — one scrolling through reels on his phone, the other leaning against the railing. Along the corridor, attendants of other patients sat on the stairs, pausing their conversations each time a nurse, doctor

or ward attendant emerged through the doors.

According to the hospital staff, around 230 people were brought here for treatment after Monday's police crackdown on the CJP protest. By Tuesday morning, while many had been discharged, only one protester — 21-year-old Sakshi, who is pursuing an Advanced Diploma in Computer Applications — remained in the ICU.

Several attendants said the atmosphere outside the ICU had changed since Monday.

Until a day earlier, they said, relatives could move in and out of the fifth floor with relative

ease. Since Sakshi's admission, they said, security had become noticeably tighter. Now, attendants waited outside until hospital staff called them in during designated visiting hours.

"Earlier, it was much easier to meet our loved ones," said an attendant whose mother has been in the ICU for the past eight days after suffering seizures. "Now everything has become strict. Unless the hospital staff allow it, nobody is allowed inside."

Until shortly before noon, Sakshi's family had been among those waiting in the same corridor.



Shoes left behind during Monday's march collected near the protest site, Tuesday. ABHINAV SAHA

Her brother, Manish, sat quietly on the staircase after spending the night at the hospital. Speaking in short, measured sentences, he said he had barely slept.

"She had come to Delhi for sightseeing," he said. "The next thing we heard was from the hospital."

A few minutes later, the ICU doors opened again.

Sakshi's mother stepped out. Dressed in a yellow suit with a dupatta covering her head, she walked slowly towards the lift, her eyes fixed on the floor.

One of her sons asked

Manish to gather Sakshi's belongings — a blue-striped bedsheet, a small brown pillow, two bags and a medical file — from the staircase. As the family prepared to leave, they walked silently towards the lift.

Later that afternoon, as journalists gathered outside the ICU hoping to speak with them, hospital staff escorted the family away from the corridor to a private room. The staff later said they had gone to meet the hospital director.

According to sources, Sakshi suffered asphyxia in a stampede-like situation that broke out after teargas shells were

fired and protesters began running. She also sustained injuries to her face, chest and neck, the sources said.

When Sakshi was brought to the hospital on Monday, her family said she was placed on ventilator support.

By Tuesday evening, however, the family said her condition had improved significantly. She was conscious, well-oriented and had been taken off the ventilator after doctors told them she was no longer in critical condition.

"We are hopeful she will be discharged soon," a family member said.

KISAN MAHAPANCHAYAT AGAINST INDIA-US TRADE DEAL

Punjab farmers stopped on way to Delhi as Haryana cops seal Shambhu border

Express News Service
Chandigarh, July 21

PUNJAB FARMERS on their way to Delhi for the Kisan Mahapanchayat to protest against the proposed India-US trade deal were stopped at the Shambhu border by the Haryana Police on Tuesday.

The farmers' convoys were met with barricades and cement blocks at the entry point to the neighbouring state.

Later in the day, the farmers began their march homewards after handing over a memorandum to Haryana Agriculture Minister Shyam Singh Rana and Ambala Deputy Commissioner Ajay Singh Tomer, who promised to fulfil their demands, including release of detained farmers.

The leaders said they ended their agitation around 6 pm after their detained colleagues were released. By the evening, Haryana authorities had begun removing barricades and cement blocks from the Shambhu borderpoint. They said traffic on the Ambala-Amritsar national highway will resume soon. A day-long Kisan Mahapanchayat



Protesting farmers at Shambhu toll plaza near Patiala on Tuesday. EXPRESS

was to happen at Kisan Ghat in Delhi under the banner of 'Desh Bachao Morcha' on Tuesday.

Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann slammed the Haryana government for preventing farmers from moving towards Delhi and asked the Centre to invite farmers for talks. Besides Punjab, farmers from Haryana, Himachal Pradesh, and Uttar Pradesh were claimed to have been part of the

march for the Mahapanchayat.

Earlier in the day, around a thousand farmers from Punjab, carrying flags of their outfits, arrived at the Shambhu border to proceed to Delhi on buses.

According to farmer leaders, scores of farmers were stopped by the police at the Khanauri border, Shahabad in Kurukshetra, and Karnal while they were on their way to Delhi. Thus hundreds of farmers sat on a

dharna on the expressway at around 10 am and remained there until 5.30 pm, upon the release of the detained farmer leaders.

National Highway-44, which connects Delhi with Punjab, and the Jammu-Katra National Highway were among the worst affected due to the protests, especially in Ambala and Kaitha districts. However, the main centre of the farmers' movement

in Haryana remained the Shambhu border in Ambala, where thousands of farmers from Punjab had gathered to proceed towards Delhi. Authorities in Ambala also imposed prohibitory orders across the district.

A senior Haryana Police officer told *The Indian Express* that around 15 companies of security forces, including paramilitary personnel, had been deployed at the Shambhu border. To prevent the movement of protesters, the police erected multiple barricades and placed cement blocks on the bridge over the Ghaggar River at Shambhu. Alternative traffic arrangements were also made for commuters travelling between Haryana and Punjab.

BKU (Bhagat Singh) spokesperson Tejveer Singh said that the Haryana minister assured the farmers that those detained, including farmer leader Gurnam Singh Charuni, would be released after discussions with the Chief Minister and the farmers were also assured that a meeting with Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan would be arranged within the next 8-10 days.

Jaishankar to meet Quad counterparts in Manila on sidelines of ASEAN meet

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, July 21

EXTERNAL AFFAIRS Minister S Jaishankar will visit Manila, Philippines, on July 22-23 to attend the Quad Foreign Ministers' Meeting under the ASEAN framework, including the ASEAN-India, East Asia Summit (EAS), and ASEAN Regional Forum (ARF).

The MEA said that the visit "underscores India's deepening engagement with ASEAN under the Act East Policy and reaffirms our strong commitment to further strengthening the ASEAN-India Comprehensive Strategic Partnership. It is of particular significance that 2026 has been designated as the ASEAN-India Year of Maritime Cooperation".

It said that on the margins of the ASEAN-related meetings, "the External Affairs Minister will be participating in a Quad Foreign Ministers' meeting with his counterparts from Australia, Japan and the United States. He is also expected to hold bilateral meetings with his counterparts from participating countries."

In May this year, with an eye on China, the Quad Foreign Ministers decided to launch the Indo-Pacific Maritime Surveillance Corporation, expanding maritime domain awareness and enhancing port infrastructure in Fiji. They also agreed to launch the Indo-Pacific Energy Security initiative, which will focus on regional energy resilience. And they decided to proceed with concrete cooperation under the Quad Critical Minerals Initiative framework to strengthen supply chains.

The Foreign Ministers of India, the US, Australia and Japan will meet in Manila. But with the US and China engagement on one side and the strained ties between India and the US, there appears to be uncertainty over the Quad leaders' summit this year in Delhi.

In May this year, when the Quad Foreign Ministers met in Delhi, the joint statement did



Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov (centre left) and Deputy PM of the Lao People's Democratic Republic Thongsavanh Phomvihane (centre right) on the sidelines of the ASEAN Ministerial Meetings in Manila, on Tuesday. AP

E. EXPLAINED

Bridging the gap

The Quad grouping has faced challenges in the last year or so. With the US President Donald Trump reaching out to China and the strained ties between Delhi and Washington, there is a perceived gap between India and the US. But the Quad grouping meeting at the Foreign Ministers' level signals some effort to bridge the gap.

a "nimble" grouping, and the decision to hold the leaders' summit will be taken by the Foreign ministers.

"We look forward to the convening of the Quad Leaders' Summit, the next Quad Foreign Ministers' Meeting, and continuing our engagements that advance peace, stability, and prosperity in the Indo-Pacific and beyond," the joint statement had said.

The Philippines assumed the ASEAN Chairship for 2026 under the theme "Navigating Our Future, Together", focusing on regional peace and security, economic integration, digital transformation, inclusive growth and people empowerment. It comes at a time when ASEAN seeks to strengthen resilience amid global uncertainties while advancing cooperation among member states and external partners, including India.

Govt rescinds incorrect RS election results notification

New Delhi: The Union Law and Justice Ministry on Monday rescinded a gazette notification published earlier in the day that mistakenly renotified the results of the by-elections to three West Bengal Rajya Sabha seats instead of the result of the election to a seat from Mizoram, government and Election Commission sources said on Tuesday.

They published the correct one, notifying the election of Zoram People's Movement leader Khiamte Laltuangkima to a seat from Mizoram. ENS

Sena (UBT) moves SC against MPs' merger

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 21

THE SHIV Sena (UBT) on Tuesday moved the Supreme Court challenging Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla's decision to recognise the merger of six of its MPs with the rival Shiv Sena led by Maharashtra Deputy Chief Minister Eknath Shinde.

Senior Advocate Devadatt Kamat, appearing for the petitioner, Shiv Sena (UBT) leader Arvind Ganpat Sawant, mentioned the matter before Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant, who was presiding over a three-judge bench, and sought an urgent hearing.

"Six of these MPs decide unilaterally, without the

merger of the original political party, and say we have merged with the rival. We contested against that political party," Kamat submitted.

The senior counsel urged the bench to hear the matter soon, saying, "The urgency is that my functioning as a political party in Parliament has come to an absolute standstill. These MPs are not with me because the Speaker has recognised their merger with some other political party. This is intended for Parliament session." The CJI said that he could not promise it would be listed this week.

On July 18, two days before the Monsoon Session in Parliament began, Birla recognised

the merger of six Shiv Sena (UBT) MPs—Sanjay Jadhav, Sanjay Patil, Sanjay Deshmukh, Omraje Nimbalkar, Nagesh Patil Ashtikar and Bhausaheb Wakchaure—with the Eknath Shinde-led Shiv Sena.

Sawant's writ petition challenges "the ex-facie unconstitutional, illegal, and perverse circular dated 18.07.2026... issued by the Joint Secretary, Lok Sabha Secretariat..." recognising the merger. Sampat said these MPs were given tickets by the Shiv Sena (UBT) and contested the Lok Sabha elections on the name and symbol belonging to party (flaming torch or mashaal). "The entire organisation, rank and file, and the leadership of the political party

put immense effort and resources in campaigning for and securing their "victory... from their respective constituencies", the petition said.

It further added "The Lok Sabha elections in 2024 were fought, inter alia, against the candidates sponsored by Shiv Sena led by Eknath Shinde. The campaign, inter alia, revolved around usurpation of the legacy of Balasaheb Thackeray by Eknath Shinde through illegal means and unconstitutionally orchestrated defections. The electorate of their constituencies, in electing... accepted and validated the campaign carried out by the SS (UBT) leadership and organisation," the petition stated.

**NATIONAL LAW UNIVERSITY ODISHA, CUTTACK**
(Established by Odisha Act IV of 2008)
Kathajodi Campus, Sector 13, CDA, Cuttack - 753015, Odisha (Accredited by NAAC)

Advertisement for Administrative Position
Advt No.: NLUO/NTR-01/22.07.2026
National Law University Odisha, a premier Law University in India inviting applications in the prescribed format for the post of **Corporate Relations Officer** on contract basis. The details of the post are as follows.

Sl. No.	Position	No of Posts	Reservation	Pay Level	Nature of Appointment
1	Corporate Relations Officer	01	UR	Remuneration will be commensurate with qualifications and experience	Contractual

Minimum Qualification: Master's Degree in Law, Management, Human Resource Management or allied discipline from a recognised University. The intending candidates are requested to apply using the available details on the Career section of the University website www.nluo.ac.in latest by 20 September 2026 by 5.00 P.M.

Note:

- Interested candidates may email their CV (not more than 3 pages), a covering letter and the filled in application form to jobs@nluo.ac.in, on or before the last date.
- Other details of the posts and relevant information can be accessed from the Career section of the University website www.nluo.ac.in.
- Only short-listed candidates will be called for interview.
- No TA/DA will be given for attending the interview.
- For any updates please visit University website regularly, no separate communication will be made to the candidates.

Sd/- Registrar

**यमुना एक्सप्रेसवे औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण**
प्रथम तल, कॉमर्शियल कॉम्प्लेक्स, ओमेगा-1 (पी-2), गेटर नौएडा
Toll Free No. 18001808296 वेबसाइट : www.yamunaexpresswayauthority.com

पत्रांक : वाई.ई.ए. / OSD(M) / 2026/235 ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना दिनांक : 20/07/2026

निम्नलिखित कार्य हेतु केन्द्र सरकार / राज्य सरकार / केन्द्र शासित / अर्द्धशासिक / सार्वजनिक उपक्रमों के कार्यों का कम से कम चार वर्ष का अनुभव रखने वाले ठेकेदारों / फर्मों से ई-निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती हैं। ई-प्रोक्योरमेंट सोल्यूशन द्वारा निविदाएं द्विस्तरीय पद्धति से खोली जायेंगी।

कार्यालय आदेश संख्या : वाई.ई.ए. / OSD(M) / 2026 / 234 दिनांक 20.07.2026 के अनुपालन में यमुना एक्सप्रेसवे औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण की कार्यों में संविदाकार द्वारा यदि न्यूनतम दरदाता (L1) द्वारा स्वीकृत बीओक्यू (BOQ) लागत से 10% तक कम दर कोट की जाती है, तो कोई अतिरिक्त परफॉर्मेंस सिक्योरिटी जमा नहीं करनी होगी। लेकिन यदि न्यूनतम दरदाता द्वारा स्वीकृत बीओक्यू लागत से 10% से अधिक कम दर कोट की जाती है तो 10% से अधिक जितनी भी प्रतिशत कम दर कोट की जाएगी, प्रत्येक 1% पर 1% की दर से अतिरिक्त सुरक्षा / परफॉर्मेंस सिक्योरिटी जमा करानी होगी।

उक्त अतिरिक्त परफॉर्मेंस सिक्योरिटी अनुबन्ध के निष्पादन (एग्रीमेंट करने) के समय ठेकेदार द्वारा जमा कराई जाएगी तथा परफॉर्मेंस गारन्टी एफ.डी.आर. / सी.डी.आर. / बैंक गारन्टी / एन.एस.सी. के रूप में न्यूनतम संविदाकार द्वारा अनुबन्ध गठन से पूर्व देनी होगी, जो कार्य के अंतिम बीजक होने के बाद वापिस होगी।

क्रम सं.	कार्य का नाम/वर्क सर्किल	अनुमानित लागत
1.	Supply, Installation, Testing, Commissioning, and Integration of 76 Three-Phase Smart Energy Meters, along with a Centralized Control and Monitoring System (CCMS), for the Street Lighting Network at YEIDA, (WC-E&M-02)	₹. 08.37 लाख
2.	SI/T/C of CCTV Camera Setup at Group Housing Sector-22D YEA (WC-E&M-02)	₹. 13.12 लाख
3.	Operation and Maintenance of 02nos Tubewell and O.H.T at Sector-22D RPS-02 (2026-2027) yea (WC-E&M-02)	₹. 11.42 लाख
4.	Operation and Maintenance of 02nos Tubewell at Sector-29 (2026-2027) yea (WC-E&M-02)	₹. 11.42 लाख
5.	Operation and Maintenance of 02nos Tubewell and UGR at Sector-22D RPS-04 (2026-2027) yeida (WC-E&M-02)	₹. 11.42 लाख
6.	SI/T/C of Solar Street Light at Falaida Bangar Gaushala Jewar Gaushala and Chanchali Gaushala yeida (WC-E&M-02)	₹. 19.74 लाख

चिन्हें दिनांक 24.07.2026 से 31.07.2026 को 5:00 बजे तक अपलोड किया जा सकता है। प्राप्त ई-निविदाओं की प्री-क्वालिफिकेशन दिनांक 04.08.2026 को प्रातः 11:00 बजे खोली जायेंगी।

निविदा प्रमत्त उत्तर प्रदेश इलेक्ट्रानिक्स कार्पोरेशन की वेबसाइट <http://etender.up.nic.in> पर देखे जा सकते हैं। इच्छुक ठेकेदारों से अनुरोध है कि वे नियमित रूप से उक्त वेबसाइटों को देखते रहें क्योंकि निविदाओं के सम्बन्ध में कोई बदलाव अथवा अतिरिक्त सूचना वेबसाइट पर ही उपलब्ध करायी जायेंगी।

विशेष कार्यधारिका (एम.) यमुना विकास प्राधिकरण

यमुना एक्सप्रेसवे औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण के अधिसूचित क्षेत्र में प्राधिकरण द्वारा स्वीकृत मास्टर प्लान के अतिरिक्त प्लानिंग / हाउसिंग / कॉलोनी या किसी भी प्रकार का अन्य निर्माण पूरी तरह से अवैध है। सामान्यजन इस प्रकार की खरीद-फरोख्त से पूर्णतः सचेत रहें तथा कॉलोनाइजर के घामक विज्ञापनों से बचें। अधिक जानकारी के लिए प्राधिकरण की वेबसाइट www.yamunaexpresswayauthority.com देखें।

**Moradabad Development Authority**
Sector 13, Delhi Road, New Moradabad, Moradabad, Uttar Pradesh - 244 001
Reference Number: 460/MDA/Property/026 Dated: 21-07-26

Expression of Interest (EOI) for the Operation, Maintenance, and Management of the Tarang Clubhouse in Ashiyana Colony, Moradabad
Proposals are invited in response to the above EOI. Detailed EOI document is available on the Moradabad Development Authority's website [\[http://www.mdamoradabad.up.gov.in\]](http://www.mdamoradabad.up.gov.in) from 20/07/2026. Interested Applicants are required to submit their proposals on or before 10/08/2026. Pre-bid conference is scheduled for 30/07/2026, 12:30 hrs (IST) via Google Meet link: <https://meet.google.com/facn-sxrv-pfr>. The technical bids will be opened on 11/08/2026, 12:00 hrs (IST). Applicants shall note that the response to pre-bid queries, corrigendum and addendum if any, shall be available on the Moradabad Development Authority's website [\[http://www.mdamoradabad.up.gov.in\]](http://www.mdamoradabad.up.gov.in) and shall not be separately advertised. In case of any queries, contact In Charge Property, Moradabad Development Authority, Moradabad. Email: mdamoradabad2019@gmail.com

Secretary

**WEST BENGAL STATE ELECTRICITY TRANSMISSION COMPANY LIMITED**
(A Government of West Bengal Enterprise)
Registered Office: Vidyut Bhawan, Block-DJ, Sector-II, Bidhannagar, Kolkata-700091
CIN: U40191WB2007SGC113474 • web: www.wbsetcl.in

E-TENDER FOR THE FOLLOWING WORKS ARE INVITED:-
NIT No.: CE/P/WBSETCL/ 400KV_220KV_C.T./26-27/11 Procurement of Current Transformers (400 kV & 220 kV). Bid documents can be downloaded from 22.07.2026, 03:00 P.M. Date: 22.07.2026
Bid submission starting date (online): 06.08.2026, 02:00 P.M. and bid submission closing date (online): 19.08.2026, 04:00 P.M.
NIT No.: CE/P/WBSETCL/ 12KV_VCB/26-27/12 Procurement of 12 kV VCB switchgear panel set. Bid documents can be downloaded from 23.07.2026, 03:00 P.M. Bid submission starting date (online): 07.08.2026, 02:00 P.M. and bid submission closing date (online): 19.08.2026, 04:00 P.M.
NIT No.: CE/P/WBSETCL/ 132KV_66KV_C.T./26-27/13 Procurement of Current Transformers (132 kV & 66 kV). Bid documents can be downloaded from 24.07.2026, 03:00 P.M. Date: 24.07.2026
Bid submission starting date (online): 07.08.2026, 02:00 P.M. and bid submission closing date (online): 19.08.2026, 04:00 P.M.
Visit the following websites - www.wbtenders.gov.in, www.wbsetcl.in for details.
ICA/TT12886(3)/2026

**National Highways Authority of India**
(Ministry of Road Transport & Highways, Govt. of India)
PIU Aligarh

PUBLIC NOTICE
The Public is hereby informed that as per clause 5(2) of The National Highways Fee (Determination of Rates and Collection) Rules, 2008 and subsequent to approval by the Competent Authority, the user fee for the use of section from Km 195.733 to Km. 240.897 (Bhadwas-Kalyanpur Section) of NH-34 (Old NH-91) in the State of Uttar Pradesh at revised rates shall be applicable w.e.f. 22.07.2026 (00:00 hours) for the F.Y. 2026-2027 at Aashpur Fee Plaza at Km 231.100 in District Etah at the following rates:-

Category of Vehicles	Fee for single Journey (In Rs.)	Fee for return Journey within a day (In Rs.)	Fee for monthly pass for 30 single Journeys in a month (In Rs.)	Fee for Single Journey for the Commercial Vehicles registered within the district of feePlaza (In Rs.)
Car, Jeep, Van or Light Motor Vehicle	90	135	3055	45
Light Commercial Vehicle, Light Goods Vehicle or Mini Bus	150	220	4935	75
Bus or Truck (Two Axle)	310	465	10340	155
Three Axle Commercial Vehicles	340	510	11280	170
Heavy Construction Machinery (HCM) or Earth Moving Equipment (EME) or Multi Axle Vehicles (MAV) (4 to 6 Axles)	485	730	16215	245
Oversized Vehicles (Seven or More Axles)	590	890	19740	295

2. Rates of FASTag monthly pass applicable for local non-commercial vehicle residing within the distance of 20 Km for the above User Fee Plaza for the F.Y. 2026-27 w.e.f. 22.07.2026 (00:00 hours) shall be Rs. 360.00.

3. The rates for "Annual Pass" will remain same for the financial year 2026-27 amounting to Rs. 3,075/-.

4. Other details may be obtained from the office of the Aashpur Fee Plaza.

NHAI, Project Director, PIU Aligarh
BUILDING a NATION, Not Just Roads

झारखण्ड सरकार
स्वास्थ्य, चिकित्सा शिक्षा एवं परिवार कल्याण विभाग
प्रेस विज्ञापित
राज्य के सरकारी चिकित्सा महाविद्यालयों के विभिन्न विभागों में शैक्षणिक संवर्ग के प्राध्यापक के रिक्त पदों पर संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएं प्राप्त करने हेतु विज्ञापन।

स्वास्थ्य चिकित्सा शिक्षा एवं परिवार कल्याण विभाग, झारखण्ड के नियंत्रणाधीन शहीद निर्मल महतो चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल, धनबाद, एमजीएम चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल, जमशेदपुर, कुल्लु ज्ञानो चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल, दुमका, मेदिनीराय चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल, पलामू तथा शेख निजारी चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल, हजारीबाग के विभिन्न विभागों में विभागवार प्राध्यापक के रिक्त पदों पर Walk-In-Interview के माध्यम से संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएं प्राप्त करने हेतु आवेदन आमंत्रित किये जाते हैं।

विभागवार प्राध्यापक पद की रिक्ति की विवरणी निम्नांकित है जो अधिक / कम हो सकती है:-

क्र० सं०	विभाग का नाम	प्राध्यापक			
		कुल रिक्ति	UR	ST	SC
1	एनाटोमी	5	3	1	1
2	फिजियोलॉजी	3	2	0	1
3	बायोकैमिस्ट्री	2	1	1	0
4	पैथोलॉजी	4	2	1	1
5	माइक्रोबायोलॉजी	3	2	1	0
6	एफएमटी	4	3	1	0
7	फार्माकोलॉजी	2	1	1	0
8	पीएसएम	2	1	1	0
9	ऑपथी	3	2	0	1
10	शिश्न रोग	5	4	1	0
11	सर्जरी	3	2	0	0
12	अस्थि	3	3	0	1
13	इंफेमटी	5	4	1	0
14	नेत्र	4	3	1	0
15	स्त्री एवं प्रसव	1	1	0	0
16	निश्चेतना	2	1	0	1
17	रक्त अधिकार	3	2	1	0
18	दन्त	2	1	1	0
	Total	56	38	12	6

2. अहंता :- प्राध्यापक के पद पर संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएं प्राप्त करने हेतु एमसीआई / एनएमसीआई के द्वारा निर्धारित योग्यता एवं वांछित अनुभव लागू होगा।

3. चयन का आधार :- Walk-In-Interview के माध्यम से संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएं प्राप्त करने हेतु गठित चयन समिति द्वारा शिष्टित प्रक्रिया के अन्तर्गत तत्संबंधी अभिलेखों की जाँच की जायेगी। तदनुसार विभागवार रिक्ति के विरुद्ध चयनित अभ्यर्थियों के नाम की अनुशंसा की जायेगी।

4. नियुक्ति की शर्त :-

- प्राध्यापक के पद पर संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएं प्राप्त करने के लिए एमसीआई / एनएमसीआई के द्वारा निर्धारित योग्यता एवं वांछित अनुभव संबंधी प्राधान्य लागू होगा।
- चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय के विभिन्न विभागों में प्राध्यापक के पद पर संविदा के आधार पर पदधारकों को समय-समय पर वित्त विभाग द्वारा दिये गये परामर्श के अनुरूप मासिक मानदेय देय होगा। इसके अतिरिक्त अन्य कोई भत्ता / सुविधा देय नहीं होगी।
- चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय के विभिन्न विभागों में प्राध्यापक के पद पर संविदा आधारित सेवाएं अधिकतम 02 वर्ष अथवा नियमित नियुक्ति / प्रोन्नति, जो पहले हो, तक अथवा 70 वर्ष की आयु तक होगी।
- 02 वर्ष की संविदा अवधि की समाप्ति के उपरान्त उनके Performance का मूल्यांकन संतोशजनक पाये जाने पर आगामी वर्ष हेतु एक बार में एक वर्ष के लिए सेवा विस्तार वित्त विभाग की सहमति से किया जायेगा।
- संविदा आधारित यह नियुक्ति पूर्णतः औपबन्धिक होगी एवं संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएं प्राप्त करने हेतु चयनित अभ्यर्थियों द्वारा भविष्य में नियमित नियुक्ति एवं अन्य सुविधाओं का दावा नहीं किया जायेगा।
- अवकाश :- संविदा आधारित चिकित्सा शिक्षकों को कैलेण्डर वर्ष के लिए राज्य कार्यों के अनुरूप आकस्मिक अवकाश देय होगा, परन्तु अन्य किसी अवकाश के हकदार नहीं होंगे।
- किसी चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय में संविदा पर नियुक्त प्राध्यापक का स्थानांतरण किसी अन्य चिकित्सा महाविद्यालय एवं अस्पताल में नहीं किया जायेगा।
- सभी चिकित्सा महाविद्यालयों में प्राध्यापक के उतने ही पद इस व्यवस्था से भरे जायेंगे जितना नितान्त आवश्यक होगा। इन पदों पर सेवाएं प्राप्त करने हेतु आरक्षण प्रशिक्षित का अनुपालन किया जायेगा।
- वित्त विभाग से प्राप्त परामर्श के आधार पर मंत्रिपरिषद् द्वारा लिए गए निर्ण के अनुसार संविदा राशि निर्धारण के संबंध में विभागीय संकल्प-407 (9) दिनांक 02.09.2021 एवं विभागीय अधिसूचना 357 (9) दिनांक 30.07.2024 के आलेख में प्राध्यापक के पद पर नियुक्त पद धारक को मानदेय- प्राध्यापक 2,50,000 /- (दो लाख पचास हजार रुपये) देय होगा इसके अतिरिक्त अन्य कोई भत्ता या सुविधा देय नहीं होगी।

5. अधिकतम उम्र सीमा :- संविदा आधारित चिकित्सा शिक्षकों के लिए अधिकतम उम्र सीमा सभी वर्गों के लिए 70 वर्ष होगी।

6. रिक्त पदों पर वाक-इन-इन्टरव्यू रिस्स, रॉबी के प्रशासनिक भवन में निम्नांकित तिथियों में सम्पन्न होगा :-

क्र० सं०	पदनाम	दिनांक	समय
01	प्राध्यापक	03.08.2026	पूर्वाह्न 10:30 बजे से

7. सभी इच्छुक उम्मीदवार वेबसाइट :- www.jharkhand.gov.in/health के अन्तर्गत Recruitment पर दिये गये आवेदन पत्र में अंकित सभी वांछित सूचनाएं पूर्णरूपेण भर कर, सभी मूल प्रमाण पत्रों की स्वअभिप्रेमाणित छायावृत्ति एवं मूल प्रमाण पत्रों के साथ वाक-इन-इन्टरव्यू आयोजन की तिथि पर ससमय माग लेंगे।

8. इस विज्ञापन को स्वीकृत करने, किसी आवेदन को बिना कोई कारण बताए स्वीकृत / अस्वीकृत करने एवं रिक्ति के अवशेष रहने की अवस्था में पुनः विज्ञापन प्रकाशित करने का सर्वाधिकार स्वास्थ्य चिकित्सा शिक्षा एवं परिवार कल्याण विभाग को सुरक्षित रहेगा।

निदेशक,
चिकित्सा शिक्षा,
झारखंड, राँची

PR 385529 Health Med Edu and Family Welfare (26-27)_D



In Solidarity

A DAY after protesters taking part in ‘Sansad Chalo’ rally faced lathicharge and tear gas shelling from Delhi Police, MPs from Opposition parties streamed in to express solidarity with them at Jantar Mantar on Tuesday. From Shiv Sena (UBT)’s Sanjay Raut and Arvind Sawant to CPI(M)’s John Brittas, Opposition leaders met those associated with the Cockroach Janta Party as well as the injured protesters who returned to the protest site after medical treatment.

Car Sewa

AN SUV belonging to a Congress leader was parked in a spot that served as a vantage point for anyone looking to shoot videos of the party’s protest near PM Narendra Modi’s residence on Tuesday. While initially the Congress leader didn’t let anyone lean onto his car, once the police started detaining party MPs, he gave a free pass to people who wanted to shoot videos of the police action. Some Congress workers also stood on the roof of the car and shot videos of leaders, including Rahul Gandhi and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, being pushed into the police buses. The onlookers left multiple dents on the SUV, but the Congress leader was unfazed and said that it was a “sacrifice for the country and the youth”.

Viral by Error

CONGRESS’S RAJYA Sabha MP Syed Naseer Hussain erroneously went viral on social media a day after the students’ protest in the Capital. The reason: Hussain’s resemblance to Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan. Video clips of the MP standing next to senior Congress leader Renuka Chowdhury as she attacked the BJP government for the police excesses on protesting students began doing the rounds, with many mistaking Hussain for Pradhan and attacking him.

No Absentees

THE CPWD has asked its officers to avoid taking leave for the duration of the Monsoon Session of Parliament. It is learnt that officers of the level of Superintending Engineer and above have been told their presence is essential for responding to Parliament questions and references from MPs in a time-bound manner.

Washout in both Houses amid Opp uproar over paper leaks, police action

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 21

PARLIAMENT ON Tuesday witnessed another washout on the second day of the Monsoon Session as the Opposition refused to back down from its demand for a discussion on the NEET paper leak and police crackdown on protesters in Delhi; it is likely that similar disruptions will continue in the coming days, too.

Opposition leaders told The Indian Express on Tuesday evening that they will let Parliament function only after their demands are met.

A Congress MP said: “We will discuss this on Wednesday morning during the meeting of floor leaders of Opposition parties. But there is very little possibility that the House will function until the government heeds the demands of the Opposition.” MPs of other Opposition parties also agreed that they will not let Parliament run unless their demands are met.

Speaking to *The Indian Express* on Tuesday evening, Congress whip in Lok Sabha Manickam Tagore said the party has three demands from the gov-



PM Narendra Modi, Union Ministers Amit Shah and Kiren Rijiju, and BJP president Nitin Nabin after the ‘Mangal Milan’ meeting in the Parliament Library Building, in New Delhi on Tuesday. PTI

ernment. “One is that there should be a discussion on paper leaks and the NEET examination. The second is resignation of Dharmendra Pradhan, and third is scrapping all FIRs lodged against the protesters,” he said. “You have to understand that our leader (Rahul Gandhi) met Lok Sabha

Speaker Om Birla on Tuesday, requesting allocation of time for a discussion on the NEET issue. We got no conclusive answer. He (Rahul) then went to meet the injured students and thereafter led a protest outside the PM residence. Despite all this, the government isn’t budging,” added Tagore.

Meanwhile, the day’s proceedings on Tuesday saw multiple adjournments in both Houses.

Scant legislative business could be taken up in the Upper House with three consecutive adjournments in the face of Opposition members from across party lines raising banners and slogans in the House.

While the Lok Sabha saw two successive adjournments before its proceedings were suspended for the day, the Rajya Sabha was adjourned within a minute of Deputy Chairperson Harivansh taking the seat as Opposition leaders stood up and raised slogans. Harivansh repeatedly urged the members to take their seats but to no avail.

“If you all keep standing, keep making noise, you don’t want to allow the parliament to function,” he said, adding that whatever discussion the members wanted, they should seek permission from the Chairperson as per the House rules.

“These are the etiquettes of the House... There are some rules and regulations for discussions in Parliament; rules and regulations made by you,” he said before adjourning the

House for the day.

While the day’s scheduled papers were laid as scheduled, no further proceedings could take place with regard to the Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Amendment Bill, 2026, which seeks to increase the sanctioned strength of Supreme Court judges from 34 to 38, and was tabled in the Lok Sabha by Law Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal on Monday.

In the Lower House, Opposition MPs kept raising slogans demanding a discussion on both the NEET paper leak as well as the use of tear gas shells and lathi-charge against protesters who had taken to the streets demanding Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan’s resignation. Speaker Om Birla adjourned the House for the day after witnessing two repeated disruptions.

Earlier, a delegation of Opposition leaders led by Lok Sabha Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi met Birla and put forward their demand for a discussion on the “brutality unleashed on students” and the “government’s complete lack of accountability for the examination crisis”.



Union Minister Jitendra Singh interacts with Lok Sabha Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi in New Delhi on Tuesday. PTI

Unease in BJP, allies over crackdown on protesters as govt signals outreach

Liz Mathew
New Delhi, July 21

ADAY after thousands of youths stormed central Delhi as the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP)-led march to Parliament ran into police and security personnel, who used lathi-charge and tear gas shells to push them back, there seemed to be a disquiet among a section of the ruling BJP-led NDA over how this stir was handled, even as the government signalled on Tuesday that it was open to have further talks with the protesters.

In an outreach to agitating students, Union Health Minister J P Nadda visited the injured protesters in both the RML and Lady Hardinge hospitals where they were admitted following police crackdown.

During the Monday march, taken out by the protesters to demand the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan over the NEET paper leak, Nadda held a meeting with the CJP leaders, which remained inconclusive.

On Tuesday, moments after Leader of Opposition (LoP) in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi along with several senior Congress leaders, including the Rajya Sabha LoP Mallikarjun Kharge, started a sit-in outside Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s official residence on Lok Kalyan Marg to demand the PM’s resignation over police action against protesters, the government rushed Union Minister of State for PMO Jitendra Singh to talk to Rahul.

BJP insiders said the developments around the student protests, which some party leaders alleged were influenced by external forces, took an “unexpected turn” with the dispensation struggling to “contain it in time”. They also admitted that Rahul’s move took the ruling camp by surprise.

The government sent Singh along with Union Home Secretary Govind Mohan to talk to Rahul and assure him that there would be a discussion in Parliament over the NEET issue.

The Rahul-led Congress demonstration was joined by other leaders of the Opposition INDIA bloc, such as Samajwadi Party (SP) chief Akhilesh Yadav and NCP(SP)’s Supriya Sule.

Later, the ruling camp tried to target Rahul. In an X post,

Singh stated, “For a senior leader like Shri Rahul Gandhi and the Leader of the Opposition to go back on his word is unfortunate and contrary to every norm of democracy. The government is ready to discuss in Parliament all issues related to NEET and the associated movement.” A BJP leader, though, said, “First time Rahul Gandhi made a political move... and we are on the back foot.”

The move to agree for a discussion also appeared to be a “climbdown”. Earlier in the day, the ministers maintained that PM Modi’s remarks at the NDA meeting, which were cited by Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju before the media, was “the government’s way of communicating its position”.

Holding that the NEET leak was a “grave offence”, Modi told the NDA MPs that the government has taken immediate action against the culprits and will not allow the future of students to be compromised. Asserting that the youths could be misguided by “several gangs”, he also asked the ruling MPs to reach out and guide them.

The BJP has asked its talking heads to convey that the Congress has set a “wrong and dangerous precedent by protesting outside the PM’s residence”, which was, the party said, “not only a security threat, but such spiteful behaviour is not seen in mature democracies”.

Party leaders also stressed how youth protests in the neighbouring countries like Nepal, Sri Lanka and Bangladesh had “created mayhem” there.

This political drama has intensified the standoff between the government and the Opposition, with the proceedings in both the Houses washed out for the second day of the Monsoon Session Tuesday. “It was a session which was expected to see the Opposition absolutely divided and the ruling NDA having a clear upper hand. But in contrast, parties like SP and NCP(SP) joined the Congress protest,” noted a BJP MP.

Several MPs from the BJP and its allies expressed their resentment over “negative optics” created by Monday’s developments. “The issue could have been handled in a better way... We have every machinery with us, still we mismanaged,” said a BJP MP.

EXPRESS special

How Modi faces his first broad-based protest ever — not one by specific interest groups

Vikas Pathak
New Delhi, July 21

WITH CROWDS sustaining at Jantar Mantar a day after the police crackdown on the Cockroach Janta Party’s Parliament march on Monday, the Narendra Modi government faces, arguably for the first time, a broad-based protest significantly different from the key ones since 2014 — farmers against the farm laws or minorities against the CAA.

On Tuesday afternoon, the Jantar Mantar protest site — having multiple barricades and large numbers of personnel from the Delhi Police and Rapid Action Force — again saw a packed crowd. There were young people with bandages — indicating that they decided to return a day after the clashes with the police — and many who decided to come, from Delhi as well as outside, on Tuesday after they saw visuals of the violence during the Parliament march.

And the profile of the protesters is mixed and diverse: from English-speaking youngsters to lower-middle-class young, those from Delhi to the ones from small towns beyond, and also parents of students in the age group where competitive exams become a concern for families.

Sure, the gathering has Left activists and the usual anti-BJP groups, but their relative numbers are lower once the gatherings swelled in the last two-three days. It is largely young,

and overwhelmingly Hindu. It abounds in protesters from the north of the Vindhyas, though there are some people from south India as well.

“I have a daughter in grade 9 and a son in grade 7. Exams are very important for us,” says Seema Sharma (first name changed), who hails from Haryana but has been living in Delhi for years. She pointed to a swelling just above her left wrist and added that she was hit with a baton by a policeman on Monday. She isn’t alone — there were multiple people, particularly younger ones, who had banded arms and wrists.

Abhijit Kumar (first name changed) hails from Bihar but is a student in Punjab. He told The Indian Express that he decided to come to Delhi after seeing the visuals of the Monday Parliament march. A group of youngsters, all conversing in English, refused to identify themselves but said they had all come from Mumbai after seeing Monday’s visuals.

The central glue of the protest — resignation of Minister of Education Dharmendra Pradhan and examination reforms — seems to have struck a chord with a diverse section of people, particularly youngsters. The Cockroach Janta Party is no longer a necessary fulcrum, as crowds have been thronging the venue beyond their mobilisation ability.

Sonam Wangchuk — much like Anna Hazare 15 years ago — remains a distant figure who has



Congress leader Priyanka Gandhi being detained, Tuesday. ABHINAV SAHA

evoked a vague sense of apolitical austerity. That has been an additional pull factor for the largely leaderless mobilisation — but it goes beyond him too.

While a Union minister privately expressed surprise at the numbers that gathered in Lutyens’ Delhi on Monday, two sources in the BJP told The Indian Express that this gathering is not representative of the youth in general, and that the mobilisation through Instagram reels will die down very soon. There is a view in the party that such protests get amplified by the same cast of anti-BJP characters.

However, there are also murmurs in the party that some damage may have been done, particularly because competitive exam aspirants and their families north of the Vindhyas

have a high presence of the BJP’s core voters.

Significantly, even the Congress is not enthused, with some in the party expressing skepticism over Wangchuk’s ideological leanings, and adding that it was more a diversion from

Rahul Gandhi’s programmes to raise the issue of paper leaks. However, after Sonia Gandhi’s advice days ago, the Congress has formally sympathised with

Wangchuk and has now openly condemned the violence on Monday. On Tuesday evening, Congress leaders and workers led by Rahul and Priyanka Gandhi held a separate protest outside PM Modi’s residence — with Akhilesh Yadav joining them — and were detained, thus making the political opposition try to enter the narrative that has for a

● THREE PARALLEL MARTYRS’ DAY EVENTS HELD IN KOLKATA TO COMMEMORATE DEATH OF 13 YOUTH CONGRESS WORKERS IN POLICE FIRING IN 1993

Mamata remains crowd puller, ‘rebel TMC’ unimpressive, Cong springs surprise

Ravik Bhattacharya
& Atri Mitra
Kolkata, July 21

THE COMPETING July 21 Martyrs’ Day programmes, the first since the Suwendu Adhikari-led BJP government took charge, across Kolkata laid bare the shifting political ground within the Trinamool Congress (TMC). While former Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee drew a large turnout despite recent setbacks and organisational turmoil, rival TMC factions struggled to mobilise support, even as the Congress surprised observers with a massive gathering.

Mamata’s rally near the Birla Planetarium witnessed thousands of supporters spilling onto adjoining roads through the afternoon. Not very far away on Mayo Road, the rebel TMC faction led by Leader of the Opposition in the Assembly (LoP) Ritabrata Banerjee saw a comparatively thin gathering. In Delhi, another breakaway group

comprising 20 Lok Sabha MPs led by Sudip Banerjee and Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar, now merged with the Nationalist Citizens Party of India (NCPI), observed Martyrs’ Day at Raighat.

The annual July 21 rally commemorates the 13 Youth Congress workers who were killed in police firing in 1993.

After the TMC came to power, the event remained one of Kolkata’s biggest political mobilisations, bringing central parts of the city to a standstill.

This year, however, the commemorations were split across multiple venues. Following prohibitory orders imposed by the Kolkata Police in Esplanade, the Calcutta High Court allowed the TMC to hold its programme near the Birla Planetarium.

The Ritabrata-led rebel faction was permitted to organise its event near the Mahatma Gandhi statue on the Maidan, while the Congress held its rally at the Shahid Minar grounds.

Addressing supporters, Ma-



TMC chief Mamata Banerjee at party’s rally near Birla Planetarium; rebel TMC MLAs Firhad Hakim and Ritabrata Banerjee at Mayo Road; Congress rally in Kolkata, Tuesday.

mata invoked the Opposition INDIA bloc while targeting both the BJP and the rebel factions. “I believe that those who have gathered here are the true wealth of Bengal... It is because of them that this movement continues to grow despite every challenge. No amount of intimidation, harassment, or political pressure can weaken our resolve. We have faced challenges before, and we will continue to face them with

courage. As long as the people remain united, no force will be able to stop our struggle or silence our voice. Despite facing countless temptations, offers of money, humiliation and deprivation, they never abandoned us,” she said.

Referring to the recent showdown in Delhi, Mamata said that running a government requires discipline and adherence to democratic norms. “Recent

events in Delhi have shown how quickly situations can escalate during political confrontations. I have heard reports from Parliament that the circumstances became so tense that even the Prime Minister (Narendra Modi) had to alter his plans. These developments remind us that stability and democratic conduct must always be protected. If injustice and intimidation continue, our movement will re-

main on the streets,” she added.

Reiterating her commitment to the Opposition INDIA bloc, with which she has had an uneasy relationship, Mamata said, “On Rabindra Jayanti, I made it clear that I have no personal ego or bitterness towards anyone. Across India, we fight together as part of the INDIA bloc, and we do the same in Bengal.”

Without naming individuals,

Mamata also trained guns at her former party colleagues. “I want to tell those who have spent years in the TMC and later changed their stand that one day every mask will come off. Many have left because of the fear of agencies. Around 40,000 cases have been registered against our party workers. It is unprecedented,” she said.

Even as Mamata slammed her ex-colleagues, her former as-

sociate Madan Mitra launched a scathing attack on her nephew, Abhishek Banerjee, from the rebel TMC stage.

“I am giving Mamata Banerjee one month. Let go of Abhishek’s hand and hold the hands of grassroots Trinamool workers...” he said.

Meanwhile, the Congress rally emerged as another talking point of the day, with thousands of supporters arriving from districts across the state. The large gathering left some party leaders too surprised.

“The crowd has overflowed beyond the Shahid Minar. The police are not allowing party workers to enter. Such a large gathering is a major success for the Congress. This is only the trailer; change will definitely come,” former Congress MP Adhir Ranjan Chowdhury said.

Speaking at the event, national president of the Youth Congress, Uday Bhanu Chib accused the TMC of being the BJP’s B-team.





बिहार सरकार

नगर विकास एवं आवास विभाग, बिहार

श्री सम्राट चौधरी

माननीय मुख्यमंत्री, बिहार

के कर-कमलों द्वारा



**₹46.26 करोड़ की लागत से
“भद्र घाट, नौजर घाट एवं महावीर घाट”
निर्माण कार्य**

का

उद्घाटन

विशिष्ट अतिथि

श्री विजय कुमार चौधरी

माननीय उप मुख्यमंत्री, बिहार

श्री बिजेन्द्र प्रसाद यादव

माननीय उप मुख्यमंत्री, बिहार

अध्यक्षता

श्री नीतीश मिश्रा

माननीय मंत्री, नगर विकास एवं आवास विभाग

गरिमामयी उपस्थिति

श्री रविशंकर प्रसाद

माननीय सांसद, पटना साहिब

श्री रत्नेश कुमार

माननीय सदस्य, बिहार विधान सभा, पटना साहिब

श्रीमती सीता साहू

माननीया महापौर, पटना

श्रीमती रेशमी कुमारी

माननीया उप-महापौर, पटना

22.07.2026 12:30 बजे अपराह्न ९ भद्र घाट, पटना



17 involved in Moga police station grenade attack arrested

Express News Service
Chandigarh, July 21

IN A major breakthrough Moga Police has thwarted a possible terror conspiracy with the arrest of 17 accused persons, including three main executors involved in the low-intensity grenade attack at Police Station Sadar Moga, said Director General of Police (DGP) Punjab Gaurav Yadav here on Tuesday.

Police have also recovered an Improvised Explosive Device (IED) along with explosive material and electronic detonator and one 9MM Glock pistol along with a magazine, besides, impounding the Splendor motorcycle (PB-03-AH-3088) used in committing the grenade attack. As per information, some unidentified persons threw a low-intensity grenade at the building of Sadar Moga police station during the early morning hours at around 3.15 AM on July 8, 2026.

The three main executors who executed the grenade attack were identified as Gagan alias Kali, Rajesh alias Khanna, and Shubham alias Bhinder. Remaining arrested accused — who assisted in logistics, network expansion, and harboring the operatives — were identified as Lajjar alias Aman and his wife Parveen Kaur, Swaran, Gobind, Sagar, John, Ruth, Raj, Sarabjit Kaur, Gurpreet Singh, Rahul, Karandeep Singh, Lovepreet, and Sukhwinder Kaur.

DGP Gaurav Yadav said that a preliminary probe has revealed that Iqbal Singh alias Ravi Dhalwal, based in the UK and allegedly involved in criminal activities, was the mastermind behind the conspiracy. On his directions, the accused carried out the grenade attack at Sadar Moga police station and were planning to plant an IED in a train running from Ferozepur to Jammu. The DGP said that further probe is underway to uncover the entire network and identify all associates involved. IGP Faridkot Range Nilambari Jagdale said multiple police teams were deployed to trace the perpetrators.

Wangchuk, CJP protesters are traitors: UP minister

Press Trust of India
Lucknow, July 21

UTTAR PRADESH Higher Education Minister Yogendra Upadhyay on Tuesday termed the CJP's agitation at Delhi's Jantar Mantar a "protest by traitors." The minister also termed activist Sonam Wangchuk a "rashtrodahi." "This is a protest by the traitors," he told a news channel here.

Asked whether Wangchuk, on a hunger strike for more than 20 days, was also a "traitor", the minister said, "Definitely. For whom are they holding protests? On which issue are they holding protests?"

On Union education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan, the minister said, "The Union minister is not to be blamed. It is the officials who should be blamed (for the NEET paper leak). Had the Union minister resigned, then the official would have got away."

MP Assembly passes UCC Bill, Congress slams 'RSS agenda'

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, July 21

THE MADHYA Pradesh Assembly on Tuesday passed the Madhya Pradesh Uniform Civil Code (UCC), 2026, Bill amid protests from the Opposition.

The legislation, introduced on the second day of the monsoon session on Monday, creates a common civil law governing marriage, divorce, inheritance and live-in relationships, while exempting Scheduled Tribes covered under Articles 342 and 366(25) of the Constitution. It bans polygamy, criminalises practices such as triple talaq and nikah halala, mandates registration of marriages, divorces and live-in relationships, and grants equal inheritance rights irrespective of gender.

Chief Minister Mohan Yadav, replying to the debate, described the legislation as a landmark reform. "Golden history is being written in this Assembly today," he said, adding that the law would "criminalise triple talaq and halala, prohibit polygamy, make registration of marriage and divorce mandatory and give equal inheritance rights to all children". Calling the legislation a fulfilment of the Constitution's vision under Article 44, Yadav said, "The fundamental



Congress leaders protest against the UCC Bill in Bhopal, Tuesday. PTI

spirit of the UCC is 'Equality for All, Respect for All'. It is not just our sentiment but the sentiment of the entire country. Everyone, especially women, should have their rights."

Launching a sharp attack on the Congress, he further alleged that the Opposition was opposing the legislation only for "Muslim appeasement". "If Congressmen have even a little respect for Babasaheb Ambedkar, they should wash away their sins by supporting the UCC," he said, adding, "Prime Minister Narendra Modi gave rights to Muslim women by abolishing

triple talaq. We are implementing the UCC so that Amar, Akbar, Anthony, Robin and Rahim all live under the same law."

He also defended the exclusion of Scheduled Tribes from the legislation. "The tribal community has been excluded in accordance with constitutional provisions. We have respected their constitutional safeguards and traditional rights." Explaining provisions of the law, he said, "Duties and rules are the same for everyone. The minimum age for marriage will be 21 years for men and 18 years for women. Marriage registration will be

mandatory. Only those who have married once will be allowed to live in Madhya Pradesh. Only after divorce will a person be able to live with a second life partner. No one will be able to arbitrarily say 'talaq, talaq, talaq'. Registration will also be required for live-in relationships."

He added that the UCC "is a great opportunity to provide equal opportunities and justice to people from all walks of life" and said, "This is a Bill that strengthens national unity, integrity, women's respect and social harmony."

Earlier in the debate, senior Congress MLA Arif Masood opposed the legislation and urged Speaker Narendra Singh Tomar to send it to a Select Committee. "This Bill contains many inconsistencies. The Union government itself has not implemented a Uniform Civil Code. The matter has remained pending before the Law Commission for three years." Masood argued that the legislation infringed constitutional protections. "The Bill violates the fundamental rights relating to culture and education guaranteed under Article 29 of the Constitution," he said, while moving amendments seeking detailed legislative scrutiny.

The House rejected the amendments by voice vote.

LoP Umang Singhar backed the demand to refer the legislation to a Select Committee, saying the state faced more pressing concerns. "There is no need for a Uniform Civil Code in Madhya Pradesh at present. The issue of 27 per cent reservation for OBCs is more important," he said.

Congress legislators later rushed to the Well of the House, shouting slogans, following which Speaker Narendra Singh Tomar passed the Bill by voice vote amid the din.

Outside the Assembly, Singhar accused the BJP government of using the legislation to pursue ideological objectives while ignoring governance issues. "The BJP government wants to implement the RSS agenda in the name of the UCC and is running away from the real issues of the people," Singhar said in a statement. "The government is asleep like a dead government when it comes to the people's problems. Farmers are facing a shortage of fertilisers, youth are wandering in search of employment, crimes against women are continuously increasing and scams are being exposed, but the government is silent on these serious issues."

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

BRIEFLY



CM Yumnam Khemchand Singh interacts with surrendered militants at the 'homecoming ceremony' in Imphal on Tuesday. PTI

MANIPUR

46 militants surrender; CM calls it 'significant step towards peace'

FORTY-SIX MILITANTS of the banned Kangleipak Communist Party (People's War Group) surrendered before security forces in Manipur on Tuesday, police said. Addressing the "homecoming ceremony" at the headquarters of the Inspector General Assam Rifles (South) in Imphal's Mantripukhri, CM Yumnam Khemchand Singh said it was a "significant step towards lasting peace and stability", and urged the surrendered militants to contribute to the state's progress. According to police, the surrendered militants handed over 28 weapons including AK-series rifles, rocket-propelled grenades (RPGs), pistols and other war-like stores comprising grenades, improvised explosive devices (IEDs), detonators, ammunition and wireless sets. PTI

Crackers worth Rs 39.5 cr seized in Ahmedabad

DAYS AFTER 10 people were killed in a massive explosion and fire at an illegal fireworks factory in Ramol area, Ahmedabad Rural Police said Tuesday that they seized 65,954 cartons of "hazardously stored firecrackers" worth Rs 39.57 crore from a warehouse in Changodar. Police found out about the godown Monday, and both the licensee, Amitkumar Harendra Modi and Kishan Raman Patel, have been booked under relevant sections of the BNS and The Explosives Act. ENS

Karnataka: ED conducts raids in ISIS case

THE ED Tuesday searched several locations in Karnataka as part of a money laundering probe in a case linked to radicalisation of youth to join banned international terrorist group ISIS, officials said. Eight locations in and around Bengaluru were raided by the ED. The action is being undertaken as per PMLA provisions. The probe stems from an FIR by the NIA, related to ISIS recruitment involving Igra Welfare Trust, Guidance for Mankind and several people. PTI

No stay on Kerala Waqf Board curbs, SC drops govt oversight clause

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 21

THE SUPREME COURT on Tuesday declined to interfere with the Kerala High Court's ad-interim direction barring the state Waqf Board from taking any major decisions or incurring any capital expenditure as its constitution is prima facie not in conformity with the 2025 Waqf Amendment Act that requires the inclusion of two non-Muslim members and one Shia member in it.

A three-judge bench presided over by CJI Surya Kant, however, deleted the HC's direction that the Board function under the supervision of the government's joint secretary or additional secretary.

The bench, also comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, said, "In view of the opening line of para 6 (of the high court order), whereunder Board has been directed to not undertake any capital expenditure etc. without leave of the court, we are satisfied that there is no necessity for retention of last line of para 6 of the order. Consequently, the direction that the Board shall function under supervision of jt. secy/ additional secretary of government is hereby deleted."

The top court noted that the matter was coming up before the high court again on Wednesday and urged it to decide expeditiously. The court was hearing an appeal filed by the Board against the high court's interim direction, which came on public interest litigations (PILs) questioning its constitution.

Given life, 44 Somali pirates hope to be sent home to serve out sentence

Sadaf Modak
Mumbai, July 21

THE 44 Somalis sentenced to life by a Special Court here Monday, for piracy and kidnapping among other charges, are hoping that they will be allowed to serve their terms back home.

Their convictions were the first under the Maritime Anti-Piracy Act, enacted in 2022. Ranging in ages between early 20s and 50s, the men have been jailed since April 2024. Barring one, none can speak English, and have had no visitors in the two years of their arrest.

During the sentencing Monday, the men raised their hands as accused No. 17 Li Banm Abdi Jama, the only one who can speak English among them, asked the court if they could return home to serve their punishment, as well as what the procedure would be now and when they could return.

Jama said the men had pleaded guilty in the hope that this would help their applications to serve out their time in Somalia. He talked about the severe hardships they were facing in jail due to differences in language, culture, diet and lifestyle, as well as the lack of any family and friends in the country.

Jama told *The Indian Express*: "We want to return. Even though we have no complaints in jail, it is difficult to adapt to living in a prison far from home. Communication is challenging, food prefer-



Ranging in ages between early 20s and 50s, the men have been jailed since April 2024. FILE

ences and culture are different. Currently, we are only in touch with our families through video-conferencing as per jail rules. At least in a jail in Somalia, they can visit us."

While the judgment did not lay down the next steps for the 44 men, who were brought to court with guards of the Navi Mumbai Police Commissionerate, Special Public Prosecutor Ranjeet Sangle told them in court that they could write to the Somali Embassy through the jail superintendent.

"As far as serving their life sentences are concerned, it is entirely the prerogative of the Government of India if it wishes to deport the convicts to Somalia under the bilateral Mutual Legal Assistance Treaty between the two nations," Sangle said.

Under the treaty, the Ministry of Home Affairs is the

nodal ministry and Central authority for seeking and providing mutual legal assistance in criminal law matters.

Special Judge S B Dige said the judgment will be sent to the government and the District Magistrate for further action.

As per a 2017 agreement between Somalia and India on the transfer of prisoners, nationals of the two countries can serve sentences back in their places. Similar bilateral agreements exist between India and other countries such as the UK, Italy, Russia.

Apart from charges under the Maritime Anti-Piracy Act, the men have been convicted under Sections of the IPC covering kidnapping for ransom, criminal conspiracy, attempt to murder, and carrying of weapons, after pleading guilty to the same too.

While 35 of them were ar-

rested on March 14, 2024, on charges of abducting the crew of merchant vessel Ex-Ruen, 14 days later, nine more were arrested for holding the crew of a fishing vessel hostage.

Deputy Superintendent of Police Maya More said their main challenge during the investigation was that the accused did not speak English.

"We had to go to the high seas for panchnamas. A Somali student from Pune University was contacted to act as interpreter... The men played different roles, from demanding ransom to holding the crew hostage, and had sophisticated weapons," More said, adding that it is up to the Centre to decide if the men should be sent to Somalia to serve their time.

Earlier cases

In 2017, 117 Somali men were sentenced to seven years in separate cases, following four anti-piracy operations by the Indian Navy and the Indian Coast Guard in 2011-2012. By then, they had spent almost an equal amount of time as under-trials, picking up Hindi and Marathi while in jail.

At their sentencing, the men requested the court for "maafi", saying they missed the food back home and their families whom they had not seen for years, and blamed the situation in Somalia for pushing them into piracy. However, the court told them to serve out their sentence. A year later, they returned to Mogadishu in flights chartered by the Somali government.

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, July 21

TAMIL RAPPER, lyricist and activist Arivu, whose music has often blended folk traditions with pointed social commentary, was briefly detained by Chennai police on Tuesday while leading a surprise protest outside the Tamil Nadu Secretariat, demanding the abolition of the National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test (NEET).

He was released soon afterwards and invited to meet Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay. Police said Arivu, whose given name is Arivarasu Kalainesan, and a small group of protesters gathered near the entrance of the Secretariat, a high-security zone, and started raising slogans calling for NEET to be scrapped. They also protested against the



Arivu is also identified with Chennai's vibrant Dalit cultural movement. X/@UDHAYTALIN

police action on students who had marched to Parliament in Delhi over the NEET paper leak. A senior police officer said

Arivu and three others were taken into custody as they were staging a protest in a prohibited zone. They were released after sometime. Then, Arivu received an invitation from the offices of the Chief Minister and state Minister for Public Works and Sports Development Aadhav Arjuna.

He was seen being escorted by police officers to the CM's chamber after they reached inside the Secretariat in a police van. Protest against NEET continues to resonate strongly in Tamil Nadu, where the entrance examination has long been a politically charged issue, with critics arguing that it disadvantages students from rural, government schools and economically weaker backgrounds.

Arivu's detention carried political significance beyond the protest. He has long been

identified with Chennai's vibrant Dalit cultural movement, and also associated with filmmaker Pa Ranjith, who was among the first to condemn the police action on students.

Arivu, one of Tamil independent music's most recognisable voices, has built his career by combining rap with *gaana*, folk traditions and anti-caste politics. A member of Chennai's Casteless Collective, he first gained widespread national recognition through the 2021 independent hit *Enjoy Enjaami*, whose lyrics drew on his grandmother's history as a plantation labourer and explored themes of land, labour and social justice. The song became one of the most successful Tamil independent releases globally. Beyond independent music, Arivu has written and performed popular film songs.

‘Bulldozer justice’: Allahabad HC gives split verdict on safeguards

Amaal Sheikh
New Delhi, July 21

“SELECTIVE OUTRAGE results in selective injustice.” This observation by Justice Atul Sreedharan is at the heart of a split verdict delivered on Monday by the Allahabad High Court, concerning the Supreme Court’s 2024 ruling on so-called “bulldozer justice”, a term used for punitive demolition of properties linked to accused persons.

The verdict revisits one of the key questions raised by that ruling — once courts have said that demolitions cannot be used as a form of punishment, how far can they go in preventing governments from doing just that?

A Division Bench of Justice Atul Sreedharan and Justice Siddharth Nandan said that the state cannot demolish a house to punish the family for an alleged offence. However, the bench was split on whether the HC can go beyond the SC’s own directions and create additional safeguards against state action. The matter will now be referred to a third bench.

Delivering a scathing critique of what he described as the growing phenomenon of “bulldozer justice”, Justice Sreedharan said that demolition drives immediately following criminal accusations often appear designed not to enforce planning laws. Instead, they aimed “to satiate the perceived blood lust” of a society conditioned by television and social media to demand instant punishment.

He also noted that illegal colonies continue to emerge due to rampant corruption. Correcting planning violations, he said, cannot become “one sided action to correct the measures, by way of the retributive exercise of the executive discretion”.

He proposed safeguards beyond the Supreme Court’s own directions. Where demolition proceedings follow an FIR, a dwelling linked to the accused should ordinarily not be touched for two years, he held, since “the immediate action... is to satiate the presumable public anger immediately following the offence which would dissipate with the passage of time.”

After two years, authorities remain free to act in accordance with municipal law and the SC’s safeguards.

He also proposed that anyone who has lived in an allegedly unauthorised house for three years or more should ordinarily receive a year’s advance notice before demolition proceedings begin, dispensable only for “compelling urgency” of a larger public need. He said that the State is often “particeps criminis” or an accomplice in the original construction through corruption.

SC judge recuses from hearing Gadling bail plea

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, July 21

SUPREME COURT Justice Shree Chandrashekhar on Tuesday recused himself from hearing the bail plea of advocate Surendra Gadling, accused in the 2018 Elgar Parishad-Maoist links case.

Gadling’s petition was listed before a bench comprising Justices Prashant Kumar Mishra and Justice Chandrashekhar. As the matter came up for hearing, Justice Mishra said, “It will go before some other bench, my brother has some difficulty.”

Justice Chandrashekhar is the third judge who has recused himself from hearing the matter. Earlier, Justices M M Sundresh and A S Chandurkar had recused themselves from the matter.

Last week, senior advocate Kapil Sibal, appearing for Gadling, had mentioned the matter before a bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant seeking urgent listing of the plea.

Sibal had said that Gadling has been jailed for seven and a half years and sought an urgent hearing.

He told the court that a notice regarding his bail plea was first issued in 2023, but the matter has witnessed recusals and asked the bench to list the matter urgently.

1996 Dausa blast: SC sets aside death sentence, says legal assistance denied

Court orders that Abdul Hameed be tried again, with proceedings to be concluded in a year; acquits the accused given life term

Ananthakrishnan G & Hamza Khan
New Delhi, July 21

THE SUPREME COURT Tuesday set aside the conviction and death sentence of Abdul Hameed in the 1996 Samleti, Dausa, bus bomb blast case, citing denial of adequate legal assistance during his original trial. It also set aside the conviction of another key accused, Pappu alias Salim, while refusing to interfere with the High Court’s acquittal of the remaining persons in the case.

The May 22, 1996, blast killed 14 people and injured 37 as it ripped through a Rajasthan Roadways bus travelling from Agra to Bikaner near Samleti village in Rajasthan’s Dausa district. The blast came a day after the Lajpat Nagar bomb blast in Delhi in which 13 people were killed.

Overturning a July 2019 judgment of the Rajasthan High Court that had upheld Hameed’s conviction and capital sentence, a Supreme Court Bench comprising Justices Vikram Nath, Sanjay Karol and Sandeep Mehta ordered a fresh trial, directing that the proceedings be concluded within one year.

“The true measure of justice does not lie in the swiftness of retribution, but in the discipline of restraint. It is a canonical



(L-R) Mirza Nisar Hussain, Lateef Ahmad Waja, Raees Baeg, Mohammad Ali Bhatt and Abdul Goni were acquitted in July 2019 in the 1996 Samleti blast case. ARCHIVE

maxim of criminal jurisprudence that it is better for a hundred guilty persons to escape than for one innocent person to be condemned,” the Court observed.

“If the trial is found to have been conducted in breach of the constitutional guarantee of a fair trial, the very foundation of the conviction would stand vitiated,” the apex court said, adding that the proceedings of the trial court “do not reflect that Dr Abdul Hameed was represented by a legal counsel at any stage”.

Highlighting that 30 years have passed since the attack, the Supreme Court asked the High Court to assign the retrial to a specialised fast-track court presided over by a judicial officer with at least seven years of experience in sessions trials.

Clarifying that its order is based on the lack of fairness and procedural propriety in the case, and that it had not gone into its merits, the Court said: “The special court shall indepen-

dently appreciate the evidence... and decide the matter strictly on its own merits without being influenced by any observation contained in this judgement.”

The Court also spoke to Hameed, who is lodged in Jaipur Central Jail, via videoconferencing, during which he said that he had “not engaged any private counsel and that no legal aid counsel was ever provided to him by the trial court”.

One of the arguments by the prosecution in seeking death for Hameed was that he was also named in the Republic Day blast at SMS Stadium in Jaipur in 1996.

Incidentally, an outfit called the Jammu and Kashmir Islamic Front had taken responsibility for the Samleti blast at the time.

While Hameed, who was arrested on June 26, 1997, has now been in jail for 29 years, Salim was arrested a month later and was imprisoned for over 23 years before he was released on parole in 2020.

The trial court and the accused

Among the accused, Riaz Ahmad Sheikh, died during the pendency of the trial. Another accused, Kulwinderjit Singh, was discharged by Additional Sessions Judge, Bandikui, in February 2003. In 2014, the High Court dropped charges against a third accused, Chandra Prakash Agarwal.

Finally, 18 years after the blast, on September 29, 2014, the trial court convicted seven people — Hameed, Javed Khan, Abdul Goni, Lateef Ahmad Waja, Mohammad Ali Bhatt, Mirza Nisar Hussain and Raees Baeg, while acquitting Farukh Ahmed Khan on the grounds that the evidence against him could not be proved beyond reasonable doubt.

Of those convicted, Hameed was sentenced to death, and the others given sentences ranging from life to 10 years’ rigorous imprisonment.

The trial court concluded that Hameed and an associate had boarded the ill-fated bus, planted the bomb under the seats in front of them, and then disembarked.

Subsequently, in March 2017, the trial court held Salim also guilty and awarded him life imprisonment.

HC proceedings

The Rajasthan High Court remanded Hameed’s case to the trial court again for a fresh order of sentence, observing that he had been awarded death on the same day as he was convicted, and that at the hearing on the sentence, there was no counsel representing Hameed.

In December 2015, the trial court again awarded death to Hameed.

In July 2019, the High Court

upheld death for Hameed, while acquitting the six others convicted along with him. It also upheld the acquittal of Farukh. In a separate judgment, the court affirmed the sentence given by the trial court to Salim.

In September 2020, the High Court granted Salim permanent parole on his petition against the denial of parole to him.

Supreme Court

Hameed’s lawyer Kamini Jaiswal contended in the apex court that “the entire prosecution case is founded upon conjectures, surmises and legally inadmissible material and that the courts below gravely erred”.

“The case rests substantially upon circumstantial evidence and alleged confessional statements, and the prosecution has miserably failed to establish a complete and unbroken chain of circumstances leading only to the hypothesis of guilt of the said accused,” Jaiswal said, claiming “unreliable identification evidence, doubtful recoveries, unexplained contradictions, serious investigative deficiencies and a tainted and fundamentally flawed investigation”.

The lawyer also contended that the lower courts “erred in overlooking the serious infirmities surrounding the statement of Pappu (Salim) recorded as an approver”. The entire case against Salim rests “solely upon circumstantial evidence, there being no direct evidence whatsoever... Once the confessional statements are eschewed from consideration, there is no independent evidence”, Jaiswal further argued.

As for the other accused, the Court said that it finds “no justification to interfere” with their acquittal by the High Court.



People move to a safer place from a flood-affected area in Assam’s Sivasagar district on Tuesday. PTI

Water levels unseen in half a century, says CM as Assam flood toll rises to 11; 3L affected

Sukrita Baruah
Guwahati, July 21

LARGE PARTS of Assam continued to be flooded on Tuesday morning, with one more person dying in Upper Assam, taking the total death toll in this year’s floods in the state to 11.

According to Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma, the “unprecedented flooding” in the Upper Assam districts of Sivasagar, Jorhat and Charaideo has resulted in “water levels unseen in half a century”.

As of 8 am on Tuesday, five rivers — the Brahmaputra in Neamatighat, the Burhidighing in Khowang, the Dikhong in Sivasagar, the Disang in Nganglamuraghat, and the Dhansiri in Golaghat and Numaligarh — continued to flow over danger levels.

Large swathes of Upper Assam have been hit by floods caused by rivers swelling after

heavy rains since Sunday.

On Tuesday morning, 12,720 people were in a total of 52 relief camps set up in response to the acute flood situation, and a total of 9,160 people were evacuated by boats, officials said.

According to estimates by the Assam State Disaster Management Authority, a total of 3.1 lakh people were affected as of Tuesday morning, with 14,411 hectares of crop areas submerged.

“Landslides were reported in five parts of Guwahati on Monday evening. There have been no additional incidents on Tuesday,” an ASDMA official said.

Meanwhile, the Railways announced special trains to assist passengers stranded by train cancellations because of inundation of railway tracks in and around Simalguri town in Sivasagar district.

‘People will think twice about sailor jobs’: UP village mourns man killed in Russian strike

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, July 21

ABHISHEK NISHAD, 22, a native of Uttar Pradesh’s Deoria district, was among four Indian seafarers killed on Sunday when a Russian missile struck a merchant vessel shortly after it departed Ukraine’s southern port of Odesa. A total of 10 people died in the attack.

The voyage was Nishad’s first assignment at sea. “Abhishek became interested in a maritime career after speaking with his cousin, Jairaj Nishad, a sailor for the past few years,” said his father Kaushal Nishad, who runs a cloth shop in Karmel. “..On June 9, Abhishek left for his first assignment as an Ordinary Seaman. He flew to Turkey via Mumbai to join the vessel.”

“Everyone in our family and neighbourhood was proud that one of our boys had secured a job overseas. We never imagined it would end in such a tragedy,” he said. The second of three children born to Kaushal Nishad and his wife Anita Devi, a homemaker, Abhishek was the first member of his family to secure employment abroad. “He called us regularly, and we last spoke on the evening of July 19. He asked how everyone was doing and said he was settling into his new job,” his fathers said.

“Just a few hours later, the ship came under a missile attack.” Unaware of the strike, the



Abhishek Nishad had left on June 9 for his first assignment as an Ordinary Seaman

family attempted to call him the next day, but his phone went unanswered. Representatives from the shipping firm later contacted them with the news of his death. The family is waiting for Abhishek’s remains to be repatriated and has not yet been informed when the body will arrive home.

Jitendra Bahadur Nishad, the village head, said Abhishek was among a handful of local youths who had joined the merchant navy and was the latest to do so. “This tragedy has shaken our village,” he said. “Families will now think twice before allowing their children to take up jobs at sea. Abhishek was so excited about embarking on his first voyage.” Senior district officials are expected to visit the family to offer condolences.

Meanwhile, India on Tuesday summoned Russia’s charge d’affaires and lodged a strong protest over the killing of Indian seafarers aboard the Guinea-Bissau-flagged merchant vessel struck off the coast of Ukraine.

J&K activist, scribe set to walk out on bail as Delhi HC refuses to stay release

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, July 21

THE DELHI High Court on Tuesday paved the way for release on bail for Kashmiri human rights activist Khurram Parvez and freelance journalist Irfan Mehraj by refusing to stay a trial court’s order granting them relief in a 2020 case registered by the NIA under the stringent anti-terror law — UAPA.

The counsel for the NIA sought a stay on the trial court’s bail order, passed on July 18, on the grounds that the case pertained to serious offences and their release “could seriously jeopardise national security”.

The HC, while making a preliminary observation that the trial court ought to have dis-

cussed the evidence while granting bail, noted that since the trial court has ordered their release subject to various conditions, it is not inclined to stay the grant of bail.

The HC imposed additional bail conditions: both Parvez and Mehraj will report to NIA headquarters in New Delhi twice a week, won’t indulge in “any activity similar to the activities on the basis of which” cases were lodged against them and not “associate with or participate in the activities of any group or organisation linked to the subject matter of the offence”.

Parvez has been in jail for the past four years and eight months and Mehraj for three years and four months.

Last month, the Delhi HC

had granted bail to Parvez in another NIA case from 2021 under UAPA. As part of his bail conditions, the HC had directed him not to leave NCT of Delhi without court permission.

The NIA had arrested Parvez in November 2021 for offences of allegedly waging a war against the State, criminal conspiracy, and for allegedly raising funds for terror activities. He was formally arrested in the 2020 case in March 2023 while in custody.

Parvez was the coordinator of J&K Coalition of Civil Society (JKCCS), a union of civil society organisations, involved in investigating human rights violations in the Union Territory. Mehraj, a close associate of Parvez, also worked at JKCCS as a researcher. He was arrested in March 2023.

EXPRESS special

He couldn’t find anyone to fund his movie. Now this Adivasi filmmaker has won a National Award

Shubham Tigga
Ranchi, July 21

GROWING UP in a small Adivasi hamlet in Jharkhand’s East Singhbhum district, Ravi Raj Murmu remembers evenings when stories travelled not through books or television but through the voices of elders. Parents and grandparents narrated Santhali folktales, stories of *bonga* (spirits), forests, rivers and unseen worlds, keeping alive an oral tradition that has shaped generations of Adivasi communities.

Years later, one of those stories was carried Murmu to India’s highest cinematic stage.

Murmu (33), a Santhali filmmaker from Jharkhand, has won the Best Debut Film of a Director at the 72nd National Film Awards for his 12-minute Santhali short film, *Angen*, whose title loosely translates as “invisible”, “unseen” or “vanished”. While there is no direct English equivalent, Murmu says the word evokes something that exists but gradually slips out of sight.

The recognition is significant. *Angen* is the first Santhali-language film to win a National Film Award and only the second fiction film made in an Adivasi language to be recognised at the stage. The first was *Edpa Kana* (Going Home), a Kurukh-language short film by Oraon filmmaker Niranjan Kujur, which

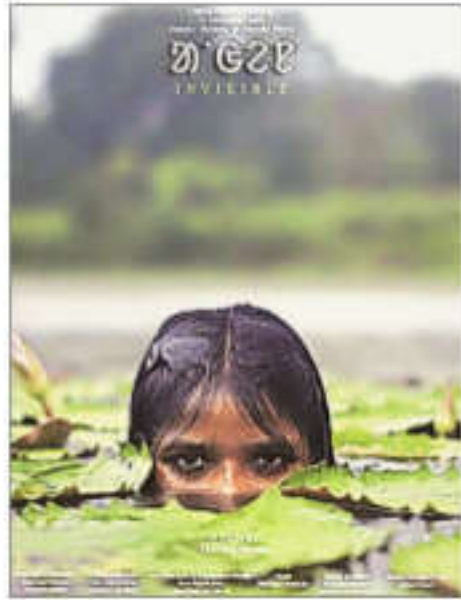
won the Best Audiography award at the 63rd National Film Awards in 2016. Earlier National Award-winning films by Adivasi filmmakers had been made in Hindi.

For Murmu, the award is less about personal recognition than about the stories he has always wanted to tell. “Every story I write comes from Jharkhand,” he said. “They are rooted in Adivasi life. At one point, I realised that if I wanted to make those films honestly, I had to return home.”

After completing his schooling in his village, Murmu studied Mass Communication in Jamshedpur before joining the Film and Television Institute of India (FTII), Pune, where he specialised in editing from 2016 to 2019. He later worked in Mumbai on projects for OTT platforms, including Netflix, Amazon Prime Video, and JioCinema, as well as advertising firms.

But despite working in the mainstream industry, he found himself returning to the stories of his childhood. “I realised our own stories have immense strength,” he said. “For a long time we grew up watching other people’s stories. I wanted Santhali cinema to tell its own story.”

Originally conceived as a feature-length film that Murmu has been writing for nearly seven years, *Angen* eventually took the form of a short film after he



struggled to secure funding. “A feature would need an investment of around Rs 25-30 crore,” he said. “Since I couldn’t find producers, I decided to make a short film first to show people what the larger story could become.”

The film travelled through several festivals, including the Mumbai International Film Festival, before finding national recognition.

Adapted from a Santhali folktale, *Angen* follows Sukku, a flute player whose music enchants a goddess living in the spirit world. Drawn into her realm through water, which serves as a portal between the human and spiritual worlds, Sukku later realises he no longer belongs there and begins searching for his village.

“The search never truly ends,” Murmu said, adding that he deliberately leaves the film



Ravi Raj Murmu has won the honours for his 12-minute Santhali short film, *Angen* (left)

open-ended because the larger feature is still being developed.

Beyond its mythical narrative, *Angen* reflects on the changing relationship between Adivasi-Indigenous people and their connected roots with nature. The movie quietly captures how rapid urbanisation reshapes landscapes once associated with Adivasi spiritual life.

Through metaphor, the film shows how, as urbanisation expands, forests disappear, natural spaces shrink, and even those spiritual spaces begin to vanish.

Water in the movie, Murmu said, was chosen consciously. “Science tells us life began with water. That’s why I made water the medium through which one world connects to another,” he said. The title too carries layered meanings, he said. “There is no literal translation of *Angen*,” he said. “You can call it invisible, vanished or unseen, but none of those words fully express what it means.”

Statehood demand key to restoring J&K’s constitutional guarantees: Omar

Naveed Iqbal
Srinagar, July 21

A DAY after he led a protest in Delhi seeking restoration of statehood for Jammu and Kashmir, Chief Minister and National Conference vice-president Omar Abdullah emphasised that the demand for statehood is foundational to restore constitutional guarantees to J&K.

“What does (Article) 370 or 371 mean without statehood? A union territory has no powers. There is no state list or a concurrent list, and that is the whole fight. Any special status that is accorded to J&K — whether it is 370 or something else — it will come down to how the Centre

and state share power and the Centre does not share power with a UT,” the CMS said on Tuesday in reference to criticism that the NC is restricting its protest to statehood and not discussing the restoration of constitutional guarantees under Article 370.

Underscoring that the party was done waiting for statehood, the NC decided in June to take its demand to New Delhi on the first day of the monsoon session of Parliament. The protest, however, was eclipsed by the Cockroach Janta Party’s march from Jantar Mantar to Parliament, and many INDIA alliance partners also gave it a miss.

Party president Farooq Abdullah led party members

through the streets, but they could not reach Central Delhi. “The police had offered us Ram-lila Maidan as an alternate venue, but we did not accept that,” Omar said.

The NC had invited several national leaders and parties, including Congress Parliamentary Party leader Sonia Gandhi, to join their demand for statehood, but only Congress leaders who are alliance partners in the J&K government were seen walking along the NC legislators in the capital.

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, Omar said that while many of them had committed to joining the protest, the leaders were unable to reach



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◆ IN 1932 ◆
BECAUSE THE TRUTH
INVOLVES US ALL

Lifting off, reaching a new space milestone

THE SUCCESSFUL launch of Skyroot Aerospace's Vikram-1 rocket marks a defining moment in India's space journey. It signals a transition from a programme led almost exclusively by the state-run ISRO to one in which private enterprise is emerging as a driver of innovation. With this achievement, India entered an exclusive league: Until Skyroot's mission on Saturday, only private companies in the United States and China had independently developed and launched rockets that reached orbit. The milestone comes six years after the government opened the space sector to private participation in 2020, a reform that was then institutionalised through the Indian Space Policy, 2023. The results of the policy are beginning to show. The country is now home to around 400 space start-ups working across the value chain, from launch vehicles and satellites to space-grade electronics and downstream applications. The sector is currently valued at roughly Rs 70,000 crore, and the government expects it to expand four- to five-fold over the coming decade.

Skyroot's mission is also important because it's directed at the Low Earth Orbit (LEO) — a region of space where an increasing number of countries are looking to carve a niche. Today, Earth observation, weather forecasting and telecommunication are no longer the preserve of government agencies. While the large geostationary satellites that operate at altitudes close to 37,000 km are unlikely to be obsolete anytime soon, much of the space economy in the coming decades is expected to be driven by satellites that orbit between 160-2,000 km above Earth's surface. The proliferation of satellites weighing anywhere from a few kg to a few hundred kg has created a market that is expanding faster than any national space agency can serve on its own. Shifting commercial launches to private players would, therefore, free ISRO to focus on deep-space exploration missions such as Chandrayaan and Gaganyaan.

That said, ISRO's handholding role cannot be discounted. India's premier space research agency provided most of the infrastructure used to design Vikram-1. By all accounts, the contours of the public-private partnership in India will be very different from the US for at least a decade — companies such as SpaceX design and build products independently of NASA and then sell them to the space research agency. Indian companies like Skyroot could, instead, become competitive by working on the country's traditional strength in low-cost manufacturing. This is the way forward, but they will have their work cut out in an ecosystem whose unforgiving nature has been demonstrated by the collapse of US companies such as Vector Launch and Virgin Orbit.

Protect seafarers, and the maritime order

THE KILLING of four Indian seafarers in the Russia-Ukraine war is tragic. It also signals the erosion of long-standing norms, underpinned by international law, that are meant to protect civilian maritime commerce. The *MV Golden Leo*, struck by a Russian missile in an attack that killed 10 seafarers in all while departing a Ukrainian port, was not a military vessel but a merchant ship. New Delhi has summoned Russia's chargé d'affaires and lodged a protest — rightly so, given the loss of Indian lives and India's stake in the freedom and safety of commerce at sea. In the past few weeks, Indian seafarers, including three aboard the *MT Settebello*, have been among sailors killed in and around the Strait of Hormuz, as merchant shipping and civilian crews are increasingly caught in the line of fire.

The purpose of International Humanitarian Law is to shield non-combatants from the horrors of war. Repeated attacks on shipping suggest that these protections are being increasingly violated, especially when great-power interests are involved. Merchant vessels engaged in civilian commerce cannot lawfully be attacked unless they are being used for military purposes. The *MV Golden Leo* was reportedly carrying grain when it was struck. The global economy depends on maritime shipping and its continuance even amid conflict. Ukraine remains one of the world's leading grain exporters, supplying markets across Europe, North Africa and Asia; disruptions across the Hormuz have already exposed the vulnerability of global energy supplies.

More than 10 per cent of the world's seafarers are Indian, many serving aboard foreign-flagged vessels such as the *MV Golden Leo* (Guinea-Bissau) and the *MT Settebello* (Palau). Following the deaths of two Indian seafarers in West Asia last week, the Directorate General of Shipping has advised shipowners, ship managers and recruitment agencies against deploying Indian seafarers on voyages through the Strait of Hormuz. These are necessary steps. New Delhi must also defend the norms that protect civilian shipping. When merchant ships become targets, it is not only seafarers who are at risk, but the maritime order that has long kept the world's commerce afloat.

Sindhu comes back on the right track

PV SINDHU'S Japan Open title might seem like it came suddenly. It's been seven years since she stood on the top step of the podium after winning an equivalent tournament. At 31, having achieved two Olympic and five World Championship medals, there was no dearth of well-wishers asking her to gracefully walk into the sunset. But this week, she made it clear that none of the questions of relevance gnawed at her. She would worry, but only about how to fight back from injuries and get stronger. In her comeback struggle, she found an ally in her husband Venkata Datta Sai.

Sindhu's commitment to fitness reflects in every choice she has made. Not a single day missed for a set of crunches. Datta, a sports and technology buff, was determined to use every available technology to squeeze out even a decimal-sized improvement. This involves data analysis, deploying multiple wearable tech devices to monitor not just muscle fatigue but mental stress levels, and sleep. Infrared rooms, temperature controlled mattresses, inversion tables and calorimeters were all part of her regimen.

With her coaching situation stable after many years, and a Top 10 list in women's singles at its weakest in decades, except for the near-unbeatable An Se-young, Sindhu senses an opportunity. The injuries are a looming word and age makes bouncing back harder, but her game is more well-rounded. Through science, Team Sindhu are looking to ace the recovery game that helped Federer, Nadal, Djokovic, Ronaldo, Kohli, LeBron, Brady prolong their active years. As far back as a decade ago, Sindhu's coaches knew that she could go upto 35 and stay competitive. The Japan Open was an affirmation that she's on the right track.

I was part of the protest march in Delhi, saw democratic politics take a new turn



DESH KAAL
BY YOGENDRA YADAV

THE REGIME — and the silence — often made me wonder whether I'm completely crazy for coming back... But today — to see this democratic spirit which has been silenced for so long come back alive again — I feel whole again. Even if temporarily".

I read these lines well past 3 am, still trying to process all that I had witnessed on the streets of Delhi this Monday. These lines, posted on X by Vanya Vaidehi Bhargav, herself a fine political theorist, captured why July 20 may be remembered in the history of Indian democracy.

This column has argued that as we slip from competitive authoritarianism to electoral autocracy, the focus of the Opposition must switch from electoral politics to a politics of resistance. Here are six reasons why the Jantar Mantar protest was a perfect illustration of what the politics of resistance may look like.

Firstly, the numbers. No one has a good estimate. But it was undoubtedly many times more than the 15,000-20,000 the organisers had hoped and planned for. Drone images suggest that well over a lakh joined this protest. Originally planned as a march, it turned into a rally, then a *raita* — a mass flow. By the afternoon, every road leading to

Parliament and much of Lutyens' Delhi was packed with the protesters. It was India's "Occupy" moment.

What made the numbers stand out even more is that this was an organic mobilisation. Far from the culture of rent-a-crowd political rallies or spectacles of organisational prowess, the Jantar Mantar protest comprised almost entirely self-mobilised youth responding to a social media call, arranging for their travel and walking long distances. The last time I witnessed this spontaneous synchronisation was the famous Republic Day tractor march organised by the farmers' movement in 2021.

Third, notice their "utterly absurd diversity", as a friend called it. I met a person who travelled from Arunachal Pradesh, a group of adults from Dharamshala in Himachal Pradesh, a wheel-chair bound student of Spanish, a group of girls from Dehradun, scores of boys and girls from all over UP, Bihar and MP, students from elite private universities, national public universities as well as time-pass colleges, and of course a large chunk of "aspirants" from Mukherjee Nagar and similar hotspots. The proportion of women was striking and exhilarating. These were not your usual suspects. An overwhelming majority were first-time participants in any protest. Their families mostly supported the BJP. So did they, till yesterday. That must worry the regime.

Fourth, the issue that brought them together was much larger and more enduring than just the recent paper leaks. There were, of course, students who suffered the NEET cancellation and the CBSE scam, parents who lost their children due to this fiasco, aspirants waiting in-

More than direct sufferers, the protesters were primarily potential sufferers, those who know that it could be their turn tomorrow, those who realise that the education-employment system has broken down

Students need to guard against undermining institutions



ADITI NARAYANI PASWAN

TO UNDERSTAND the chaos gripping our educational spaces — as seen in the recent protests in Delhi and elsewhere — it is necessary to revisit Jean-Jacques Rousseau's concept of the Social Contract. Rousseau has noted, "True political liberty is never found in a state of chaos or unbridled individual impulse."

But real freedom is built when citizens willingly enter a community, agreeing and binding themselves to shared rules and institutional structures." He had also warned that when individuals choose disruption over collective agreement, it leads to the fracturing of the civic bond that underpins democratic existence.

Public institutions and administration are a microcosm of the social contract. Participating in them calls for mutual agreement to listen, follow the process, and respect the forum.

As teachers, when we allow students to treat these structures as permanently broken or as enemies, we are misinforming and mis-educating them. It leads to alienation from the tools of civic governance that students need to master.

We need to establish a dialogue between government bodies and their citizens; we need to demand institutional accountability rather than disrupt governance and create an environment of political polarisation.

Democracy is kept alive through the day-to-day, exhausting work of policy implementation and institutional negotiation. It does not function through continuous agitation.

Our real job as educators is to anchor students and their energies in constitutional boundaries and civic responsibility. Classrooms need to be the spaces where these evolving state reforms are understood, where we promote curiosity and scepticism and encourage critical thinking.

But there is a fine line between questioning a system and trying to dismantle its legitimacy in public. When students are misled and continuously pushed to-

ward confrontation, it leads to a shrinking of the faith citizens have in their public institutions, with the focus shifting to physical clashes.

Therefore, any genuine progress in administrative reforms is sidelined by political polarisation. The debate is now not about improving education or public institutions. They are now consumed by binary shouting matches with zero outcomes.

When, as a teacher, I see impatience among India's youth, I feel that it is a healthy sign of an aspirational democracy. It means these ignited minds aspire for rapid development.

But this passion must go hand in hand with maintaining the stability of our foundational institutions, which form the cornerstone of democracy. There are multiple democratic tools to effect changes. The state has built robust, highly responsive institutional tools — from transparent online RTI portals to localised grievance cells and elected academic councils.

These handle student anxieties. Our public institutions must be spaces where youth and students learn to navigate institutional realities, and master the art of constructive civil discourse in the larger spirit of democracy.

Ultimately, we must remember Mahatma Gandhi, who built our independence struggle on the principle of peaceful *satyagraha*. For Gandhi, the means were as pure as the end itself.

The raw disruption and aggression we witnessed in Delhi this week from all stakeholders violated the true Gandhian spirit. It replaced moral persuasion with force.

The true task before our youth today is to look past structural anger. True democratic empowerment is born when we partner with and reform the public institutions through engagement from within, rather than letting raw friction bring them to a halt.

The writer is associate professor, Dr Ambedkar International Centre

definitely for jobs, and victims of recruitment scams. But more than direct sufferers, the protesters were primarily potential sufferers, those who know that it could be their turn tomorrow, those who realise that the education-employment system has broken down.

Anger against Minister Dharmendra Pradhan is only the tip of the iceberg. The underlying urge is for an equitable, meaningful and quality education and for a universal right to employment. It is after half a century — since the JP movement in Bihar in 1974 — that a youth protest has placed education and employment at the centre of the national agenda.

Fifth, the spirit of resistance goes beyond names and labels. Sonam Wangchuk is clearly their hero, but the hero-worship quotient is much more muted than during the Anna movement. The youth related to the CJP and its leadership, but were not shy to offer healthy criticism. They heard and cheered political leaders and activists from the podium, but were not swayed by any one personality. This democratic spirit augurs well for the future.

Sixth, the repeated chants of "*Godi media, go back*" were a reminder that the youth have found a way past the narratives of mainstream media. For the last one

month, the Noida channels and the notional press more or less erased the protest at Jantar Mantar, when not mocking or demonising it. Yet every calculation of the regime and every narrative of its spin doctors was defied. Just as in the farmers' movement, media black-outs actually spurred the participants into developing their parallel information channels through social media, word of mouth and Whats-

App. Their posters were punchy: "The true test of a democracy isn't the protest. It's how the state responds to it". Their slogans were innovative. I heard this one for the first time: "*Jab jab Modi darta hai, Hindu-Muslim karta hai*". The authoritarian narrative is being punctured.

Seventh, and above all, July 20 shows a fracturing of the spell of fear. Today's youth understand the risks of surveillance and profiling under the present regime, something absent during the Ramlila Maidan mobilisation of the anti-corruption movement. That deterred many of them from coming to Jantar Mantar for the first two weeks. But somehow, something shattered it on Monday. Perhaps the safety of the crowd. Perhaps the adrenaline of hopelessness. Or maybe a faint hope. But these young people were not afraid of being heard, photographed or even tear-gassed.

Finally, in a way almost unnoticed, the movement could mark a new phase in the politics of social justice. The youth of India have come together in a movement led by a Dalit, Abhijeet Dipke, and inspired by an Adivasi, Sonam Wangchuk, one not limited to the stereotypical "SC/ST issues". Instead of demanding its share in the nation, bahujan politics can now define what the nation is.

For many months now, I have been repeating a dialogue to anyone who asks me about the future of India: "*Sawal ye nahin hai ki janata tanashahi ke khilaaf khari hogi ya nahin. Sawal sirf itna hai ki jab janata khari hogi tab tak kahin ham toh nahin baith jayenge*". Yesterday, I saw it unfold before my eyes. Janata was standing. And so was I.

The writer is member, Swaraj India, and national convener, Bharat Jodo Abhiyaan. Views are personal

Ajit Dada didn't let pressures of politics diminish his humanity



RAJAGOPAL DEVARA

AS MAHARASHTRA remembers Ajit Pawar on his birth anniversary, my thoughts go back to the years I had the opportunity to work closely with him in government. For more than three decades, Ajit *dada*, as he was fondly called, occupied an important place in Maharashtra's political and administrative landscape. What impressed me most was not merely the scale of his responsibilities but the manner in which he discharged them.

One quality stood out immediately — his respect for time. Meetings chaired by Ajit *dada* were conducted with precision. If an officer or a minister whose presence was essential had not arrived, he would simply pick up the phone. There was never any unnecessary display of authority, only a quiet firmness. Those who entered late would invariably find him looking first at the wall clock and then at them, often with a gentle smile. Nothing more needed to be said. Working with him, I also experienced his extraordinary attention to detail. He wanted to understand every aspect before taking a decision. During the planning of GST Bhavan at Wadala, discussions extended beyond the larger vision to seemingly ordinary details — the size of washrooms, facilities for persons with disabilities and the convenience of citizens who would visit the building. National memorials and projects of public importance received the same meticulous attention.

His commitment to Maharashtra's cooperative movement was equally deep. During my tenure as Commissioner for Cooperation, Maharashtra, difficult decisions had to be taken following NABARD's observations on financial irregularities in the Maharashtra State Cooperative Bank. With the concurrence of the RBI, an administrator was appointed. Naturally, Ajit *dada* was disturbed. There was even talk of a political storm. But what impressed me was what happened later. Over the years, as the bank regained financial strength, he openly appreciated the decision. He acknowledged that protecting the institution was more important than protecting individuals. It is rare to find a leader willing to revisit a difficult decision and appreciate it.

Yet, if someone asks me today what I remember most about Ajit *dada*, it is a small gesture. At some point, he had observed that I liked a particular food item served by the Mantralaya canteen in his morning meetings. Whenever I happened to attend his meetings, he would quietly, with his trademark mischievous smile, indicate to the staff to serve it. It was his way of saying, "I remember." Looking back, I realise the gesture was never about food. It reflected his ability to observe people, to remember the smallest details about them and to make them feel valued. Many leaders are remembered for the decisions they take, some for the institutions they build. As Maharashtra remembers him today, I remember a disciplined administrator, a perfectionist in governance and a leader who never allowed the pressures of public life to diminish his humanity. That, to me, was the real Ajit *dada*.

The writer is former additional chief secretary and currently Member, Maharashtra Real Estate Appellate Tribunal

40 YEARS AGO

July 22, 1986



Six killed in Assam violence

THE AGITATION over the language issue in Cachar grew worse as six persons including three constables were killed and over 35 hurt in police firing in Karimganj. The mob indulged in arson and fire-stones at the district headquarters. An indefinite curfew has been clamped on the town and troops have been alerted for any emergency. The trouble spread to Silchar also. The violence marked the first visit by the Chief Minister, Prafulla Mahanta, to the Cachar division since he assumed office in December.

Nine dead in Bihar train mishap

NINE PERSONS were killed and 53 others injured, 19 seriously, when a goods train

rammed into the 28-Up Maurya Express, about to leave the Gomoh station, according to the divisional railway manager, D K Mathur. The killed included the wife, two children and brother of the Janata Party MP from Chapra, Ram Bahadur Singh.

Police lapses caused massacre

THE CHIEF Minister, Vir Bahadur Singh, admitting lapses on the part of the police resulting in the massacre of nine persons in a village in Banda, said that the police superintendent, circle officer and station house officer of May had been transferred. Singh, on his return from the scene of the crime in Ramu-Ka Purwa hamlet, said he had ordered payment of Rs 20,000 to the next of kin of all the nine persons murdered

by the dacoits and Rs 2,000 to each of the six injured. The Chief Minister said the villagers had alleged they had to pay the price for having helped the police in getting two dacoits arrested and regretted that no arrangement was made by the police for their protection.

Furore over PM's remark

PRIME MINISTER Rajiv Gandhi's assertion in the Lok Sabha that the Government would not allow the "personal interests of individual trade union leaders to hold the country to ransom" sparked off a noisy protest from the opposition. The protest culminated in the chair directing the Bombay labour leader Datta Samant to withdraw from the House.



From 1991, three foreign policy lessons for managing disruption of certainties



RAJA MANDALA
BY C RAJA MOHAN

HISTORICAL ANALOGIES must be approached with caution. Yet there is a striking symmetry between the foreign policy challenges that confronted India in 1990-91 and those now posed by the wars in Iran and Ukraine. Simultaneous upheavals in the Middle East and Europe in 1991 shattered India's economic and strategic assumptions. Today, the two regions are again compelling Delhi to reconsider the foundations of its national strategy.

Iraq's invasion of Kuwait in August 1990, and the US-led war to reverse Saddam Hussein's annexation, sent oil prices soaring, disrupted remittances and aggravated India's balance-of-payments crisis. Within months, the Soviet Union — the principal anchor of Indian foreign policy during the Cold War — collapsed. The twin shocks forced India to reform its economy, diversify its international partnerships and rethink its place in the world.

The circumstances today are different, but the underlying challenge is familiar. The war that began with the killing of Iran's Supreme Leader on February 28 has raised energy costs, disrupted navigation through the Strait of Hormuz and exposed India's dependence on the Middle East.

The relief in Delhi after Washington and Tehran signed a memorandum of understanding in June has proved premature as the conflict escalates again. In Europe, meanwhile, the Ukraine war has entered its fifth year without a clear path to settlement. Russia is not about to disintegrate as the Soviet Union did in 1991. But the prolonged war, with its mounting costs, is generating new questions about Russia's future at home and abroad.

India is much better placed to manage these shocks than it was in 1991. It has a larger economy, greater diplomatic weight, and wider international partnerships. Yet its ex-



ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

posure to the world and the resulting vulnerabilities are greater.

American policies are intensifying this vulnerability. The sanctions legislation associated with the late Senator Lindsey Graham is proposing massive punitive tariffs against China, India and others importing Russian oil. President Donald Trump has also called for the legislation to be expanded to cover Iran. Whether or not Congress accepts that proposal, India's energy diplomacy will come under increasing stress.

The Indian government has shown considerable flexibility in navigating these pressures so far; but it could get trickier in the days ahead. As in 1991, however, the government appears more flexible than the foreign policy debate surrounding it might suggest. When Saddam invaded Kuwait, India's official position was caught between competing imperatives. It had to evacuate a large Indian expatriate population, preserve relations with Iraq and the Arab world, respond to the violation of Kuwaiti sovereignty, and accommodate the overwhelming military power assembled by the United States. The government's contradictory manoeuvres — including Foreign Minister I K Gujral's embrace of Saddam and

Iraq's invasion of Kuwait in August 1990, and the US-led war to reverse Saddam Hussein's annexation, sent oil prices soaring, disrupted remittances and aggravated India's balance-of-payments crisis

the provision of refuelling facilities to American military aircraft — reflected these multiple pressures.

But the domestic strategic consensus in 1991 was hardly realistic. Large sections of the political and foreign policy establishment sympathised instinctively with Saddam, long viewed as a friend of India and a representative of secular Arab nationalism. His annexation of an independent country was viewed as less important than his confrontation with the United States.

The same rigidity shaped Indian reactions to the Soviet crisis. By the late 1980s, Mikhail Gorbachev's internal reforms and retrenchment abroad had made clear that the old Soviet order was unsustainable. Yet a large section of Delhi's foreign policy community denounced him for seeking accommodation with the West. When communist hardliners attempted a coup in August 1991, there was barely concealed political glee in parts of Delhi. The coup collapsed within three days; the Soviet Union disappeared in December.

The protagonists have changed, but the instinct survives. Sympathy for Tehran often rests less on the character or conduct of the Islamic Republic than on its resistance to

America. Saddam's secular autocracy and Iran's Islamic theocracy are as different as chalk and cheese. Yet, the Indian foreign policy community embraced them both as symbols of anti-American defiance.

The debate on Russia is similarly personalised around Putin and sentimentalised through the memory of Soviet support for India. This obscures the need to examine Russia's internal strains, its changing relationship with China and its imperatives for reconciling with Europe and America. India's interests require an empathetic understanding of the domestic politics of Russia and Iran — not reflexive signalling of solidarity to the governments of the moment.

The first lesson from 1991, therefore, is that no balance of power is permanent. The certainties of the 1980s — a stable Soviet Union, a bipolar order and dependable partnerships — vanished with astonishing speed in 1991. Unpredictability is not an interruption of normal international politics; it is one of its permanent features. Indian strategy must devote as much attention to discontinuity as to continuity.

The second is that debate itself is a strategic asset. A foreign policy community organised around a rigid consensus will repeatedly miss inconvenient possibilities. India needs stronger expertise on Russia, Iran, Central Asia and the internal politics of the Middle East. India needs sustained investment, more than ever, in languages, history and regional specialisation. It also needs institutions willing to reflect on competing scenarios and encourage contrarian judgments.

The third and most important lesson is that external shocks and systemic changes cannot be managed by diplomacy alone. What rescued India after 1991 were the internal reforms. The answer must be the same today — sweeping domestic reform to cope with a changing world. Diplomacy's role then and now is to support internal transformation.

The writer is a contributing editor on international affairs for The Indian Express. He is also a Distinguished Professor at the Motwani-Jadeja Institute of American Studies, Jindal Global University and the Korea Foundation Chair on Asian Geopolitics at the Council for Strategic and Defense Research, Delhi

Delhi's winter pollution toolkit needs AI forecasts



MANMEET SINGH AND SANDEEP JUNEJA

DELHI'S DECISION to introduce a permanent winter pollution management framework marks an important shift in how the city responds to its annual air quality crisis. Measures such as staggered office timings, work-from-home arrangements, construction restrictions and tighter controls on vehicular emissions show that the government is moving from emergency response to advance planning. But one critical question remains: Even if emissions are reduced, when should people go outdoors?

Every winter, Delhi experiences strong temperature inversions that trap pollutants close to the ground, producing some of the world's highest concentrations of fine particulate matter, or PM2.5. Yet millions of schoolchildren, athletes, coaches, outdoor workers and event organisers continue to follow fixed morning schedules rather than atmospheric conditions. Daily Air Quality Index bulletins tell people when the air is "poor" or "severe," but rarely answer the more practical health question: What is the safest time today to be outside?

Our analysis of winter observations from November to January, using data from the Central Pollution Control Board, points to a clear pattern. We compared PM2.5 concentrations during the traditional morning window for school sports and outdoor activities, from 9 am to 12 pm, with those in the late afternoon, from 3 pm to 6 pm, when stronger atmospheric mixing typically helps disperse pollutants. The difference is striking.

At Anand Vihar, average PM2.5 concentrations fall from 275.3 ug/m³ in the morning to 170.4 ug/m³ in the late afternoon, a reduction of 38 per cent. In Rohini, concentrations decline by 40 per cent. R K Puram and Ashok Vihar record reductions of around one-third. Even Lodhi Road, among Delhi's cleaner monitoring locations, sees an average reduction of nearly 29 per cent. Pollution levels between 6 AM and 9 AM, when many training sessions and fitness activities begin, are similarly high to those between 9 AM and noon.

This pattern reflects a familiar feature of Delhi's winter atmosphere. Pollution remains trapped near the surface through the



ILLUSTRATION: TANUSHRI MITRA

morning and often stays elevated into the early afternoon. The most consistent improvement occurs later in the day, between 3 pm and 6 pm.

For children playing football, hockey, cricket or athletics, this timing matters. During vigorous exercise, breathing rates can rise by up to twenty-fold, allowing fine particulate matter to penetrate deeper into the lungs. A two-hour sporting event can therefore involve far greater pollution exposure than simply standing outdoors. Shifting activity to a cleaner time of day can substantially reduce exposure without requiring new infrastructure or additional regulation.

This is where AI can make Delhi's winter strategy more effective. Historical observations reveal broad patterns, but pollution varies from day to day depending on wind, temperature, cloud cover, regional biomass burning and local emissions. AI models can combine weather forecasts, satellite observations, ground-level monitoring and emissions data to predict how pollution will evolve hour by hour, and increasingly several days in advance.

That can turn air quality forecasting from a general information service into a practical decision-support tool. Instead of issuing only a generic warning that air quality will be "very poor," AI-enabled forecasts can answer operational questions: Should tomorrow's school sports meet begin at 9 AM or shift to 4 PM? Will pollution remain hazardous all day, requiring outdoor activity to be postponed? Which parts of the city are likely to see air quality improve earliest?

Delhi's new winter pollution framework rightly focuses on reducing emissions. AI forecasting would complement those efforts by helping governments, schools and communities reduce exposure while pollution-control measures take effect. With high-quality data, such forecasts could support decisions on school sports, marathons, outdoor work, public events and emergency health advisories. The evidence already supports one simple recommendation: Wherever possible, winter school sports and other outdoor physical activities should be scheduled in the late afternoon, between 3 pm and 6 pm.

India already uses predictive science to prepare for cyclones, floods and heatwaves. Air pollution should be treated no differently. Delhi has taken an important step by planning ahead to reduce emissions. The next step is to use AI-powered forecasts to help people decide when it is safest to step outside.

Singh is academic visitor and Juneja is director, Safexpress Centre for Data, Learning and Decision Sciences, Ashoka University, Delhi-NCR. Views are personal

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Jantar Mantar protest

INDIA'S EXAMINATION ecosystem has witnessed repeated controversies, including paper leaks, impersonation rackets and organised cheating networks, indicating that the problem extends beyond administrative failures to structural weaknesses requiring comprehensive reform ("Can't have sabka vishwas with tear gas and lathi", *IE*, July 21). Equally disturbing are reports of protesters being ignored or dispersed through coercive measures even before avenues for dialogue have been exhausted.

Vaibhav Goyal, Chandigarh

THE REPEATED crossing of red lines by this NDA government will cost it dearly in the years to come ("Can't have sabka vishwas with tear gas and lathi", *IE*, July 21). The high-handed approach to dealing with a sensitive issue related to the aspirations of millions of young people in this country cannot be justified in any manner, even if one accepts all the social media theories promoted by the administration. The delayed, too little, too late action was of no consequence in light of the brutal police action against students and young people, watched in horror by a nation whose foundation was laid on the principles of non-violence and peaceful protest. I hope that good sense will prevail among our political masters.

Sanjeev Raina

Two fasts

THE COMPARISON between the two movements is instructive ('Anna Hazare to Sonam Wangchuk, a tale of two fasts — and a democracy', *IE*, July 21). What separates lasting impact from fleeting attention is often organisation and political timing, rather than the sincerity of the cause. Civil society movements need clearer institutional channels to convert public sentiment into policy action. Legislatures could benefit from formal mechanisms to register and respond to sustained public demands.

SM Jeeva, Chennai



SUPRIYA SANKARAN AND PAVITHRA MANIVANNAN

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE is coming to India's courts, not as a distant possibility but as an active policy question. This June, the Supreme Court published draft regulations for the use of AI in courts for public comments. They govern how AI may be used across the entire judiciary, create institutions to oversee their adoption and prescribe approval processes for AI systems.

But courts are only beginning to use AI, and no one fully understands yet how it will behave in practice. These regulations will need to evolve as experience accumulates.

The more important question, then, is whether the foundations are right. Two things in particular are hard to reverse once set, and will shape the integrity of everything that follows. Both need to be answered before AI enters the courtroom.

The first is about institutions. Every wave of technology use in India's judiciary has created a new governance body. Computerisation brought computer committees. AI is now producing an apex body, five standing committees, High Court AI committees, district AI secretariats, and a new Centre of Research and Excellence.

The problem is architecture. Institutional structures must not be built around individual technologies. Computerisation, digitisation, video conferencing, and AI are

What must a system explain, and to whom? What error rate is acceptable in a bail matter versus a scheduling task? Where does training data come from?

A checklist for a new-age courtroom

successive tools in the same transformation of court administration. For instance, an AI-assisted scheduling system is simultaneously a case management, infrastructure, digitisation and AI project. If each of these tools and functions has separate committees, it fragments accountability and slows decision-making. The judiciary needs a permanent institution capable of absorbing the functions currently held by the e-Committee alongside the new AI governance mandate, and whatever technology comes next. India has done this before: TNMSC, professionalised medicine procurement in Tamil Nadu and became a model for other states; UIDAI built and maintains the Aadhaar ecosystem. Execution requires permanence, expertise and clear ownership — none of which committees with rotating members can provide.

The second is about standards. When India built its payments infrastructure, it made one decision that changed everything: It separated the standard from the market. NPCI wrote the specification for UPI and stepped back. It didn't build PhonePe or Google Pay — the market did. The standard was shared; the innovation happened around it. India's courts are now at a similar inflection point with AI.

The Draft Regulations establish who approves AI systems for court use and how. What they do not establish is what any system must ac-

tually demonstrate to earn that approval. This is not a minor gap. Before a pharmaceutical company can sell a drug in India, its manufacturing process must meet internationally defined quality standards.

For judicial AI, the equivalent is missing. What must a system explain, and to whom? What error rate is acceptable in a bail matter versus a scheduling task? Where does training data come from? Without these answers defined in advance, each of India's 25 high courts must independently determine what constitutes an acceptable AI system. Given the wide variation in technical capacity across the judiciary, they will arrive at different answers. The result is inconsistent approvals — and inconsistent justice.

Standards cannot be set by the body that procures against them. The Draft Regulations already envision a Centre of Research and Excellence on AI (CoRE-AI). It should be set up as a neutral body with no stake in which vendor wins, no procurement budget to defend. A permanent technical institution should procure against them. A Judicial Committee should approve them. Just as NPCI stepped back and let the market build, CoRE-AI's value lies precisely in staying out of the game it is refereeing. The SC must push for foundations that will hold not just for today's AI, but for whatever comes next.

Sankaran is a co-founder of PUCAR and Agami. Manivannan is research lead at XKDR Forum

NEET and beyond, a systematic assault on education



D RAJA

EDUCATION IS not merely another government department. It is the foundation upon which a democratic republic builds its future. B R Ambedkar's immortal call — "Educate, Agitate, Organise" — was not simply a slogan. It was a roadmap for creating an informed, empowered and egalitarian society. Over the past 12 years, however, the Modi government has moved in the opposite direction. Ever since the BJP came to power in 2014, its education policy has been driven by three interconnected objectives: The communalisation, commercialisation and centralisation of education. The result has been a systematic weakening of public education

and an unprecedented crisis in examinations, recruitment and employment.

The Ministry of Education under Dharmendra Pradhan has failed to restore confidence in this system. Every fresh controversy has deepened public distrust. Thousands of students are on the streets demanding his resignation, including activists sitting on hunger strike for more than two weeks, demanding accountability.

The assault began with India's premier public universities. Jawaharlal Nehru University, the University of Hyderabad, Jamia Millia Islamia, Tata Institute of Social Sciences and several other institutions became targets of political attacks. Students and teachers questioning the government were routinely branded "anti-national", "tukde-tukde gang" or "urban Naxals". This was accompanied by financial pressure on

public education. Universities reported shrinking grants, delays in fellowships, financial constraints and pressure to raise fees.

If the first pillar of the BJP's education policy has been weakening public institutions, the second has been the collapse of credibility in examinations and recruitment. No institution symbolises this collapse more than the National Testing Agency (NTA). Established to bring professionalism and trans-

Pradhan bears ministerial responsibility for the repeated breakdown of India's examination system. The scale of the NEET and NTA crises alone warrants his resignation

parency, the NTA has instead become associated with repeated controversies, technical failures, paper leak allegations, arbitrary examination centre allotments and administrative confusion.

The NEET crisis has become the defining example. In 2024, over 24 lakh candidates registered for the examination. Allegations of paper leaks, the controversial award of grace marks to 1,563 candidates, multiple perfect scores, nationwide protests, a CBI investigation and proceedings before the Supreme Court shattered public confidence in the examination process. Before confidence could be restored, an even bigger crisis unfolded. The NEET-UG 2026 examination, taken by around 22 lakh aspiring doctors, was cancelled after the integrity of the examination was compromised.

Behind every cancelled examination lies

an enormous human cost. Years of preparation, family savings and emotional investment disappear overnight. India has repeatedly witnessed heartbreaking reports of students dying by suicide amid examination stress and recruitment uncertainty. While every such tragedy has multiple causes, together they reflect a system that has become increasingly unforgiving and unpredictable.

Pradhan bears ministerial responsibility for these repeated breakdowns. The scale of the NEET and NTA crises alone warrants his resignation. The struggle, however, is larger than one minister or government. It is about defending education as a public good rather than a marketplace, a constitutional right rather than a privilege, and a means of nation-building rather than ideological control.

The writer is General Secretary, CPI

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Rakesh, S/o: Kamal Singh, R/o: H.No-304, Gali Akhade Wali, Subzi Mandi, Delhi-110007** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 125/2020, U/s: 188/34 Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita 2023, P.S. Subzi Mandi, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Rakesh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Rakesh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Rakesh of P.S. Subzi Mandi, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **31.08.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Preeti Rajoria
Ld. JMFC-07, Room No. 32,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/9911/N/2026

ANDHRA PRADESH MEDICAL SERVICES & INFRASTRUCTURE DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION

2nd Floor, Plot No.9, Survey No.49, IT Park, Mangalagiri - 522 503
email: aphmhdc@gmail.com & ed.apmsidc16@gmail.com

Tender Notice No.1/APMSIDC/2026-27 Dated: 20.07.2026

APMSIDC invites tenders through e-procurement platform <https://tender.aeprocurement.gov.in> for 1. RFP for selection of Agency to Design, Development, Implementation along with AI-enabled Functionality implementation and end-to-end Maintenance of Dr. NTR VST 2. RFP for Selection of Agency for operation and maintenance of Sanjeevani - State wide integrated digital care coordination and healthcare delivery system in A.P. 3. Procurement and supply of equipment & furniture to New/Old Govt. Medical colleges/Hospitals under DME in A.P. 4. Various Govt. Hospitals in A.P. under NHM budget. 5. Certain Training Aids/Firefighting Equipment/Systems to A.P. State Disaster Response and Fire Services department under the 15th Finance Commission 6. Critical Care Blocks and IPHLs under PMABHM in A.P.

For detailed notification and further details please visit the web site <https://apmsidc.ap.nic.in> & www.tender.aeprocurement.gov.in.

APMSIDC will reserve the right to cancel the tenders at any time without assigning any reasons.

for Managing Director

उपसिदा 3090 राज्य औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण

ए-1/4, सलमपुर, कामपुर

ई-निविदा सूचना

एलटद्वारा सूचित किया जाता है, कि निम्नलिखित श्रेणी के अनुरोधित विकास/अनुसंधान / संशोधन कार्य हेतु सरकारी विभागों/संवर्धनित उपक्रमों/ निगमों/ प्राधिकरणों/परियोजना/नगर निगमों में कार्यरत फर्मों/उद्योगों से ई-निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती है, जिसको अपलोड करने की समयसीमा निम्नवत है:-

अंकित कार्य की निविदा दिनांक 22.07.2026 को पूर्वान्न 11.00 बजे से दिनांक 11.08.2026 को अपरान्न 5.00 बजे तक अपलोड की जा सकती है, बिना दिनांक 11.08.2026 को अपरान्न 5.30 बजे खोला जायेगा (पूर्णांकित)

निविदादाताओं द्वारा केवल साधनार्थ की मूल प्रतियाँ निविदा प्रपत्रों में उल्लिखित दिनांक तक कार्यालय में जमा की जा सकेंगी। ई-निविदा के माध्यम से आमंत्रित की जाने वाली निविदाओं का विवरण निम्नवत है:-

क्रमांक	कार्य का नाम	कोटेशन/प्रति
1	Construction/ Development of Park P-2 at Industrial Area CDF Complex District- Aligarh.	126.83
2	Construction / Development of Park P-2 at Industrial Area Salempur, District- Hathras	139.13
3	Development of Park P-1,2 & 3 at Industrial Area Talanagri Housing Sector District- Aligarh	163.18

नोट:- निविदादाता अपनी निविदाओं में समस्त कर सहित दरें अंकित करें। जीएसटीडीए अलग से देय होगा। निविदा सम्बन्धी विस्तृत जानकारी प्राधिकरण की website: <https://beta.upsidamarketplace.com> पर लिखित ई-लिंक एवं यूट्यूब चैनल की website: <http://tender.up.nic.in> पर देखी जा सकती है। अन्य जानकारी हेतु कार्यालय के वरिष्ठ प्रबंधक (निविदा) की श्री प्रवीण कुमार सलोनिया मोबाइल नं० 9871090103 पर सम्पर्क किया जा सकता है।

साधनार्थक(सि), उपसिदाऔपनिवेश, कामपुर

LOK SABHA SECRETARIAT [VIGILANCE BRANCH]

417, Parliament House Annexe, New Delhi 110001

PUBLIC NOTICE

Shri Rajesh Kumar Chaubey, Library Attendant Gr-II (Emp. ID 13118) of the Lok Sabha Secretariat, last known to be residing at C-321, Albert Square, Sector-C, Block-7, New Delhi 110001, with permanent address at Village Bandhuchak, Post Babubel (Haldi), Ballia, Uttar Pradesh 277402, has been unauthorisedly absenting himself from duty since 30.12.2024. He is not responding to official communications sent to him by Registered Post/Speed Post to both his local and permanent addresses.

2. Charge sheet dated 26.05.2026 has been framed against him under Rule 14 of the Central Civil Services (Classification, Control and Appeal) Rules, 1965, for misconduct in relation to his prolonged unauthorised absence and related acts.

3. Shri Rajesh Kumar Chaubey, Library Attendant Gr-II, is hereby given an opportunity to submit his written statement of defence in response to the aforesaid charge sheet, within 15 days of the date of publication of this Notice. He is also required to state whether he desires to be heard in person.

4. If Shri Rajesh Kumar Chaubey fails to submit his written statement of defence within the time stipulated above, or fails to appear before the Inquiring Authority, the Inquiring Authority may hold inquiry against him ex-parte, without any further notice, and appropriate disciplinary action under the provisions of the Central Civil Services (Classification, Control and Appeal) Rules, 1965, as adopted by the Lok Sabha Secretariat, may be taken against him for violation of various provisions of the Lok Sabha Secretariat (Conduct) Rules, 1955.

CBC 31201/11/0001/2627

Director (Vigilance)

SRINAGAR DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY

Bemina, Bye Pass Near SKI MS Medical College, Srinagar, Kashmir-190018
TEL: 0194-2493191, FAX: 0194-2493180,
EMAIL: vcsda-jk@nic.in

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL No: 01/RFP/EE of 2026-2027

Srinagar Development Authority (SDA), Housing and Urban Development Department, Government of Union Territory, Jammu & Kashmir (hereinafter called "SDA or Authority") wants to Selection of Developer for Development and Monetization of 3.No Land Parcels of of Srinagar development Authority (SDA), at Sangarmall, Srinagar, in the Union Territory of Jammu & Kashmir.

S. no	Particulars	Details
1	Developer for Development and Monetization of 3 no of land parcels of Srinagar development Authority (SDA), located at Sangarmall, Srinagar, in the Union Territory of Jammu & Kashmir.	Selection of Developer for Development and Monetization of Land Parcels of Srinagar Development Authority (SDA), in Union Territory of Jammu & Kashmir.
2	Download of RFP Document	Complete RFP documents can be downloaded from the Website: http://jktenders.gov.in (8th of July to 30th of July 2026)
3	Last Date for Submission of RFP	30th of July 2026 (05.30 pm)
4	Address for Communication	Office of Executive Engineer, Srinagar Development Authority (SDA), Bemina Bye pass, Near SKIMS Medical college, Housing and Urban Dev. Department, Government of UT of J & K
5	RFP Application Downloading Start Date	8th of July 2026
6	Last date for sending pre-RFP Queries	15th of July 2026 upto 4.30 pm
7	Pre-Bid meeting date	16th of July 2026 at 1.30 pm
8	Last date for submission of RFP online	30th of July 2026 (upto 5.30 pm)
9	Opening of RFP	31st of July 2026 (12.00 noon)
10	Meeting, if decide by Authority from eligible Applicants	To be intimated to eligible Applicant/s

Sd/-

No: SDA/EE/1570-73

Srinagar Development Authority

DIP NO.: DIPK-NB-1154/26 DATE 21.07.2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC/84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Dharmender Kumar @ Juddi S/o Shobhan Mandal R/o Jhuggi No. 208, Deen Dayal Upadhaya Camp, Road No. 77, Punjabi Bagh West, Delhi-110026** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 16804/2025 U/S 317(2) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, PS Janak Puri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Dharmender Kumar @ Juddi** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Dharmender Kumar @ Juddi** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Dharmender Kumar @ Juddi of FIR No. 16804/2025 U/S 317(2) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, PS Janak Puri, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **31.08.2026**

By Order,
Sh. Harjot Singh Aujla
Judicial Magistrate Class- 11
South-West District, Court No. 05
Dwarka Courts, New Delhi

DP/9682/WD/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, **namely, Manoj S/o Vinod Kumar R/o H.No 260, Near Purani Chopal, Bijwasan, Kapashera, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 773/2022, U/s: 498A/406/34 IPC**, registered at **P.S.: Dabri, Delhi**, and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Manoj**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Manoj**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person, **Manoj, FIR No.773/2022, U/s: 498A/406/34 IPC**, registered at **P.S.: Dabri, Delhi**, is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **25.08.2026**

By Order
Ms Shubhi Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class
Mahila Court-05, (Court No. 310),
Dwarka Courts Complex, New Delhi

DP/10053/DW/2026

(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person(s) **Abdul Rashid Khan S/o: Mr. Abdul Wahid, R/o: House No. X-14, X-Block, New Ranjit Nagar, Central, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 3857/2022, U/s: 138 NI ACT, PS: South Rohini, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Abdul Rashid Khan**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Abdul Rashid Khan**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Abdul Rashid Khan, of FIR No. 3857/2022, U/s: 138 NI ACT, PS: South Rohini, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **22.08.2026**.

By Order
Sanyam Jain
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04 (NW)
1st Floor Room No. 112
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/10043/RD/2026

(Court Matter)

HARYANA ROADWAYS ENGINEERING CORPORATION, Gurugram

(A GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA UNDERTAKING)
REGD. OFFICE & FACTORY: 6TH MILE STONE, JAIPUR HIGHWAY
BEHRAMPUR ROAD, KHANDSA, GURUGRAM (HARYANA)
EMAIL.ID: gm.hrcc27@gmail.com TEL.0124-2215660, TEL.FAX.0124-2215389
(CIN-U34101HR1987SGC029904) GSTIN-06AAAFH8157K1Z6

सुदृष्टिपत्र (CORRIGENDUM)

विषय: 24 Nos. Store Group Items की खरीद हेतु प्रकाशित ई-टेंडर की अंतिम तिथि बढ़ाए जाने के संबंध में।

यह सूचित किया जाता है कि 24 Nos. Store Group Items की खरीद हेतु प्रकाशित ई-टेंडर की ऑनलाइन बोली जमा करने की अंतिम तिथि दिनांक 25.07.2026 को सांघ 05:00 बजे निर्धारित की गई थी।

किन्तु तकनीकी कारणों (Technical Issues) के कारण ई-टेंडर पोर्टल पर बोली प्रस्तुत करने में आ रही कठिनाइयों को दृष्टिगत रखते हुए, उक्त ई-टेंडर की ऑनलाइन बोली जमा करने की अंतिम तिथि बढ़ाकर दिनांक 05.08.2026 को सांघ 05:00 बजे तक कर दी गई है।

साध ही, ई.एम.डी, टेंडर फीस एवं ई-सर्विस फीस जमा कराने की अंतिम तिथि तथा तकनीकी एवं वित्तीय बोलियों को खोलने की तिथियाँ भी संशोधित कार्यक्रमानुसार निर्धारित की जाएंगी।

ई-टेंडर की अन्य सभी शर्तें एवं नियम पूर्ववत् रहेंगे।

महाप्रबंधक

हरियाणा रोडवेज इंजीनियरिंग कॉर्पोरेशन,

गुरुग्राम।

No. 47362/HRV

Union territory of Jammu and Kashmir OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL COMMISSIONER STATE TAXES (ADMINISTRATION & ENFORCEMENT), JAMMU EXCISE AND TAXATION COMPLEX RAIL HEAD, JAMMU

NOTICE INVITING BID FOR OUTSOURCING OF DOUBLE STOREY STRUCTURE LOCATED AT BUS STAND LAKHANPUR, DISTRICT KATHUA, J&K, FOR ESTABLISHMENT OF COMMUTER FACILITATION SERVICES.

REFERENCE – a) Govt. Order No. 204-FD of 2026 Dated: 04.06.2025

b) Office Order No: 20/ADM OF 2026 DATED: 10.06.2026

For and on behalf of Lieutenant Governor of Union Territory of Jammu Kashmir, State Taxes Department invites e-bids through GeM for outsourcing of double storey structure located at bus stand Lakanpur, District Kathua (Jammu & Kashmir) for establishment of Commuter Facilitation Services "AS IS AND WHERE IS BASIS", The details of which are as under:

S. No	Name of the Asset	Purpose	Minimum Reserved Bid/Price per annum exclusive of all applicable taxes	Earnest Money Deposit	Period of Contract	Who can apply
1	Double-Storey structure located at Bus Stand Lakanpur, District Kathua (Jammu & Kashmir)	Establishment of Commuter Facilitation Services such as cateries, dhabs/ bar/ restaurant, toilets/washroom facilities, resting area and other civic amenities, including provision for upkeep and maintenance of the premises.	Rs. 6.50 Lakh (Six Lakh Fifty Thousand)	5% of the Quoted Bid/Price	Five years extendable for another five years subject to approval from the Competent Authority	Firm/Agency/ Company

Timeline: The interested bidder shall follow the following timeline:

Issue Date	13.07.2026
PQ Submission Start Date	13.07.2026
PQ Submission End Date	27.07.2026
PQ Assessment End Date	31.07.2026
EMD Payment Start Date	01.08.2026
EMD Payment End Date	06.08.2026
Auction Start Date & Time	10.08.2026 (10:00 am)
Auction End Date & Time	12.08.2026 (12:00 pm)
Bid Clarification Contact	Ms. Mavesh Ara, JKAS, Ph: No.6005900522, Email-ID: adcetadmj@jkcomtax.gov.in

The details regarding the above mentioned tender/bid can be downloaded from GeM portal at www.gem.gov.in

No: ACST(A&E)/Estate/10/A

Date: 13.07.2026

Namrita Dogra, JKAS Additional

Commissioner State Taxes (Adm & Enf) Jammu.

DIP NO. DIP/J-6308/26 DATE 21.07.2026



GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
KATAKA (R&B) CIRCLE, KATAKA
E-mail:ID-sectcrb_2006@yahoo.co.in
Tel/Fax-0671-2301751/2302751

('E' - PROCUREMENT NOTICE)

Bid Identification No.CCE.Ctr.(R&B) 6/2026-27

1. The Chief Construction Engineer, Kataka (R&B) Circle, Kataka on behalf of Governor of Odisha invites on Percentage rate basis bid in double cover system in ONLINE MODE from eligible contractors for Road and Building works as mentioned below.

2. No. of work :- 04 Nos.

3. Nature of work :- Road and Building works

4. Class of contractor :- 'B', 'A' & Special Class

5. Tender paper cost :- Rs.10000/- (online)

6. Available of bid document in the web site :- From 30.07.2026 to 17.30 Hours of 13.08.2026

7. Date of opening of bid :- Dt.14.08.2026 at 11.00 Hours.

8. The Bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only. Further details can be seen from the website <https://tendersodisha.gov.in>. Any addendum / corrigendum / cancellation of tender can also be seen in the said web site

Sd/-

Chief Construction Engineer
Kataka(R&B)Circle

OIPR-34001/34012/1/26-27/0021

INDIAN RAILWAYS

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

MINISTRY OF RAILWAYS

(RAILWAY BOARD)

E-TENDER NO.2026RSIR741TC

Principal Executive Director, Railway Stores (S), Ministry of Railways, Railway Board, Government of India invites e-tender for procurement of 1,22,158 Nos. Upgraded Class 'E' (6" x 11") Cartridge Tapered Roller Bearings used on Cast Steel Bogies (Narrow/Wide-Jaw of Freight Stock of Indian Railways for 22.9/25T Axle Load application through E-Reverse Auction.

2.0 The interested tenderers are advised to visit the website <http://ireps.gov.in> for details of the tender and submission of their e-bids.

3.0 No manual offers will be accepted against e-tender.

4.0 Tender will be closed at 15.00 hours on 24.08.2026.

5.0 Any corrigendum to this tender will be published on the website <http://ireps.gov.in> only and not in print media.



Director, Railway Stores (W),
Ministry of Railways, Railway Board, New Delhi,
For and on behalf of the President of India

2506/26

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

WESTERN RAILWAY

Material Management Department

VARIOUS MATERIALS SUPPLY

E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE No. S/39/2026 Date 17.07.2026

S.N.	Tender No.	Short Description of items	Quantity	T.O.D.
327	06261185	Brushless Alternator of 4.5 KW	260 Nos	03-Sep-26
328	06261419	Mobile Contact Assembly	1837 Nos	01-Sep-26
329	02363585	CC Poly Urethane Side Bearer Pad Assembly	1730 Nos	31-Aug-26
330	24262546	Gear Box Oil	26402 Ltr	19-Aug-26
331	22265008	Supply, Installation And Commissioning of Electrically Operated Wind Screen Wiper Assembly Complete	208 Set	19-Aug-26
332	09265016	Traction Transformer Complete with Cooling System	1 Nos	17-Aug-26
333	22265031	Main Compressor Onboard type (Oil Lubricated) 1745 LPM	140 Nos	17-Aug-26
334	06265049A	Copper Catenary Wire 125 mm2	52 KM	14-Aug-26
335	29262132	Drug Eluting Coronary Stent System	200 Nos	14-Aug-26
336	09265003	Hearing make IV coupler	4 Set	13-Aug-26
337	06261176	Electronic Rectifier Cum Regulator	90 Nos	13-Aug-26

CORRIGENDUM

Please read the due date as "20.08.2026" for the Tender Notice No.: S-37-2026 Dated: 10.07.2026 at Sr. No. 313

Regarding detailed notice EMD, Purchase restrictions and detailed tender conditions, please visit website www.ireps.gov.in and wr.indianrailways.gov.in.

0383

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North Eastern Railway

Open Tender Notice No. :
NER-BSB0Snt-OF-34-2026

"Open Tenders" through online (E-Tendering) are invited by Divisional Railway Manager (Signal & Telecomm)/ Varanasi N.E. Railway for and behalf of the President of India for the following works:

S.N. : 1, Tender Notice No. and Description of Work : NER-BSB0Snt-OF-34-2026 : Name of Work : Provision of coach guidance system at Aurhar Jn. station of Varanasi Division. Approx. Value: ₹ 3,28,49,362.47, Earnest Money : ₹ 6,57,000.00, Cost of Tender Form : Rs. 00.00, Completion Period : 180 Days, Tender Closing Date & Time : 14.08.2026 upto 15.00 Hrs.

I. Tender Online will be submitted up to 15.00 Hrs. on date 14.08.2026. 2. For full details and submission of bid kindly visit the official website of Indian Railways i.e. www.ireps.gov.in.

Divl. Rly. Manager (S&T)
N.E. Railway, Varanasi

CPRO/Sig-70

Do not travel with inflammable article in train

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA

TENDER NOTICE

SR NO	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	DIRECTORATE OF INFORMATION, PUBLIC RELATIONS & LANGUAGES DEPARTMENT, HARYANA	FOR HIRING OF MANPOWER AGENCY FOR PMU UNIT IN INFORMATION PUBLIC RELATION LANGUAGES AND CULTURE DEPT. HARYANA	23.07.2026 06.08.2026		https://tenders.hry.nic.in https://pharyana.gov.in	0172-5059101 esttpr@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 47383/HR

AAVAS FINANCIERS LIMITED

(CIN:L65922RJ2011PLC034297) Regd. & Corp. Office: 201-202, 2nd Floor, South End Square, Mansarovar Industrial Area, Jaipur. 302020

POSSESSION NOTICE

Whereas, The undersigned being the Authorised Officer of AAVAS FINANCIERS LIMITED under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of powers conferred upon me under section 13(1)(i) read with Rule 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued a Demand Notice calling upon the borrowers mentioned herein below to repay the amount mentioned in the respective notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice. The borrowers having failed to repay the amount, undersigned has taken possession of the properties described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on me under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 9 of the said rules on the dates mentioned as below. The borrower and Guarantor in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the properties and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of the AAVAS FINANCIERS LIMITED for an amount mentioned as below and further interest thereon.

Name of the Borrower	Date & Amount of Demand Notice	Description of Property	Date & Type of Possession
Baby Baby, Adarsh Kumar, Rajesh Kumar (A/C NO.) 241224704001632	8 Jul 25 Rs. 2911422/- 4 Jul 25	Araji No. 1565, Mauza Jhansi Khas Abadi, Bahar Unnav Gate, Panchwati Tehsil And District Jhansi Uttar Pradesh 284002 Admeasuring 55.41 Sq.Mtr.	Physical Possession Taken On 16 Jul 26
Vidyawati Vidyawati, Devendra Yadab (A/C NO.) 241227304636272	7 May 26 Rs. 846411/- 7 May 26	A House At Village Mankapur Sarura Pargana, The And Dist. Budaun, Budaun Uttar Pradesh (In)- 243601 / Admeasuring 389.05 Sq. Mtr.	Symbolic Possession Taken On 16 Jul 26

Place : Uttar Pradesh Date: 22-07-2026 Authorised Officer Aavas Financiers Limited

GOVT.OF NCT OF DELHI DEPARTMENT OF SOCIAL WELFARE (PERSONS WITH DISABILITIES WELFARE BRANCH) 7th FLOOR, MSO BUILDING, ITO, NEW DELHI-110002 ADMISSION NOTICE

Applications are invited for admission to Atal Drishti Hostel for College-Going Divyang Girl Students, Timarpur, Delhi, run by the Department of Social Welfare, GNCTD, for the students studying in Delhi but are not able to get accommodation in the college hostels.

- Female students with 80% or above disability as per UDID/Disability Certificate (relaxable to 60% or above disability in case of seats available).
- Bonafide residents of Delhi.
- Age not below 17 years and not above of 30 years.
- Passed Senior Secondary (10+2) examination from CBSE or other recognized Board/passed Graduation from University/College in Delhi.
- Bona fide student of recognized Colleges/Institutions in Delhi.
- Students of correspondence/Distance learning course or an online course will not be eligible.

Category-wise Seats Available

Category	No. of Seats Available
Girls with Locomotor Disabilities	24
Girls with Multiple Disabilities and Other Disabilities	24
Girls with Hearing Impairment, Speech and Language Impairment	24
Girls with Visual Impairment (including Blindness)	24

Admission Procedure

- Apply in prescribed form (available at <https://socialwelfare.delhi.gov.in>) with required documents.
- Applicants will be interviewed by the Admission Committee and the decision of the Committee shall be final.
- Selected candidates must deposit ₹ 5000 refundable caution money or submit a surety bond of equivalent amount.
- Admission/re-admission is not a matter of right.
- Admission in the middle of the ongoing academic session/year may be considered based on the availability of seats.

The Big Picture

WEDNESDAY, JULY 22, 2026

13

IT BEGAN with a sound heard for the first time in the forests of Panna National Park. The crack of hydraulic breakers echoed, followed by the growl of excavators and the relentless crawl of bulldozers.

Hillsides were cut open, and forest tracks widened into construction roads. Concrete and steel arrived where only rock, river and trees stood before. One of India's largest engineering projects, the Rs 44,605-crore Ken-Betwa Link Project, had begun reshaping the landscape.

After decades of uncertainty, the project to link the Ken and Betwa rivers has entered a decisive phase, triggering a race to evacuate nearly 2,000 families across 10 villages — a rushed deadline that has fuelled protests across the submergence zone as residents challenge compensation surveys, eligibility lists and the terms on which they are being asked to leave.

For the administration, the remaining months are about meeting engineering timelines, completing rehabilitation and clearing the reservoir before the next phase of construction. For the many families still living in the shadow of the Daudhan dam — one of the main architectural features under the project — it's a struggle of a different kind: proving, through Aadhaar cards, school certificates, revenue records and decades-old family registers, that they belong to the places they are being asked to abandon.

When two rivers meet

The idea of linking India's rivers dates back to the early 1980s. The National Water Development Agency, set up in 1982 to examine the feasibility of interlinking river basins, identified the Ken-Betwa Link, as a priority project. The project, India's first inter-basin river link, aims to transfer water from the Ken to the Betwa basin.

A feasibility report followed in 1995, and in August 2005, Madhya Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh and the Centre agreed to prepare a Detailed Project Report. The Union Cabinet finally approved the project in December 2021, transforming the landscape around the rivers into construction sites.

Officials say that once ready, the project will irrigate 9.04 lakh hectares, utilise more than 4,843 million cubic metres of water, generate 103 MW of hydropower and 27 MW of solar energy, and supply nearly 194 million cubic metres of drinking water each year.

The irrigation network will extend across some of the most parched districts of Bundelkhand such as Chhatarpur, Tikamgarh, Panna, Damoh, Vidisha, Sagar, Shivpur, Datia and Raisen in Madhya Pradesh, and Banda, Mahoba, Jhansi and Lalitpur in Uttar Pradesh.

At the heart of the project is the Daudhan dam planned across the Ken river in Madhya Pradesh — a structure that stretches for more than 2 km. The reservoir of the dam is designed to hold 2,853 million cubic metres of water, while two proposed power stations at the site are expected to generate more than 219 million units of electricity annually.

Water from the Daudhan reservoir will flow through a 221-km link canal (which gives the Ken-Betwa Link project its name) into the Betwa basin. The network also includes other irrigational structures such as the Lower Orr Project, the Kotha Barrage, the Bina Complex Multipurpose Project across Sagar and Raisen districts and the restored Ken Canal System in Uttar Pradesh.

Construction gathered pace in April 2025. By February 2026, officials said most of the machinery was in place, river diversion works were underway, and excavation of the Daudhan dam's foundation was in progress.

Beneath the appearance of steady progress is a parallel story — of environmental, administrative and engineering challenges.

Officials say additional private land is still needed to widen the approach roads to the dam. Acquisition proceedings covering nearly 28 hectares are underway, with notifications issued in some cases and records still being processed in others. Water pipelines, electricity lines and government structures within the project's right of way also remain incomplete, said a project engineer.

But the biggest set of unresolved tasks concerns rehabilitation. Villages within the submergence zone must be evacuated before construction can proceed in full.

Official project documents estimate that construction of the Daudhan dam will directly submerge about 2,171 hectares of village land, while the wider submergence area spans roughly 9,000 hectares.

The project's resettlement and rehabilitation plan identifies 1,913 affected families across 10 villages, with an estimated population of 8,339. The region has a significant tribal presence: Scheduled Tribes account for 33.9% of residents.

But the biggest headache for the state government is the Environmental Clearance stipulation by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change which mandates that all "rehabilitation and resettlement issues be completed before commissioning of the project".

Those left behind

The paperwork suggests rehabilitation is nearing completion, but Daudhan village — a 20-minute ride from the dam site through unmotorable roads cutting through the forest — suggests otherwise.

Houses stand ripped open, roofs pulled down, walls sliced in half by excavators. Entire lanes end in mounds of rubble, twisted steel and broken timber. On May 13, 2026, the administration brought in bulldozers. While officials say they only pulled down homes of those who had relocated, as well as vacant structures on government land, villagers allege the demolition was carried out without adequate warning.

For two weeks, a few hundred villagers from Daudhan, Palkhua and Sukwaha, the three villages in the submergence zone of the dam, sat on a protest by the banks of the



INDIA'S FIRST INTER-BASIN RIVER LINK

KEN, BETWA AND A LINE DRAWN ON WATER

After decades of uncertainty, the Ken-Betwa river linking project, which aims to irrigate the parched Bundelkhand region, is now racing to meet new deadlines. ANAND MOHAN J travels along the Ken to see how a Rs 44,605-crore engineering project is reshaping the river — and the lives along its banks



For two weeks, villagers from Daudhan, Palkhua and Sukwaha sat on a protest by the banks of the Ken, in Kupi village; in Daudhan, houses stand ripped open, roofs pulled down; at the resettlement colony in Kavar Karondiya, in Chhatarpur district. PHOTOGRAPHS BY ANAND MOHAN J



• The project in numbers

9,000 ha

of land likely to be submerged

5,258 ha

of this is forest land

4,141 ha

is core Panna Tiger Reserve land

9.04 lakh ha

of land is expected to get water for irrigation from the project

194

million cubic metres of drinking water is expected to be supplied every year, once the river linking project is ready

Ken, in Kupi village, alleging irregularities in land acquisition, rehabilitation and compensation for families affected by the project. On July 19, police detained their leader, social activist Amit Bhatnagar and several other demonstrators from the site, effectively ending the protest for now.

In September 2023, the Madhya Pradesh government had announced a special rehabilitation package for families affected by the Daudhan dam, under which every adult in a family is entitled to Rs 12.5 lakh, with a couple counted as a single unit. Compensation for homes range from Rs 50,000 to Rs 1.5 lakh. In addition to this, they are given plots in Kavar Karondiya, a notified resettlement colony 25-30 km by road from Daudhan, where they can build new homes.

Yet, amid the rubble in Daudhan, dozens of families remain, many insisting they were left out of surveys, denied compensation or never recognised as separate households.

Nandkishore Adivasi spends most afternoons squatting on the floor of his mud house in Daudhan, grinding red chillies into chutney on a stone slab. The house has stood here for generations. His family has already moved to the resettlement colony in Karondiya, but he stayed behind because the house was never counted during the survey and his mother was not counted. "I want to leave; my house does not have electricity, water or even a proper toilet. But not until my mother receives her compensation," he says.

A few lanes away, Phool Chand was counted, but his daughter was not. "My house has also not been counted. The local *patwari* (land record official) made a mess of the survey. My elder daughter was not counted. The school in the village has been shut for months now, and my younger daughter is at home," he says.

Mannu Yadav, widowed decades ago when her husband drowned in the Ken,



clutches her Aadhaar card as she speaks. In the absence of any other document, it is the only one with which she can argue that she exists in a place where, according to the survey records, she does not. "The government does not recognise me, they didn't count me. I am fighting to change that," she says.

Across Daudhan, where an estimated 100-150 people still remain, the same administrative gaps recur with minor variations: a house omitted from the survey, a missing name, an excluded family member, an undercounted parcel of land.

Chhatarpur Collector Parth Jaiswal says the district has already shifted about 380 families from Daudhan in the first phase and subsequently extended rehabilitation benefits to another 100 families. "We have disbursed around Rs 750 crore in compensation. If there are people left behind, I will ensure as many surveys as possible," he said.

Official reports show the rehabilitation exercise has advanced well: in Chhatarpur, nearly 89% of land compensation, almost 96% of asset compensation and more than 96% of rehabilitation payments have been

disbursed. Across neighbouring Panna, close to 90% of land compensation and almost all rehabilitation payments have been released.

"Once the river diversion begins, the remaining houses cannot stay in the submergence area. We have to complete the evacuation before that stage," says Jaiswal.

Jaiswal said only about 30 to 35 cases remain unresolved in Daudhan village, but they are also the most complicated. "These are not simple cases... Most involve disputes over eligibility or documentation."

The struggle to get counted

What a family loses by leaving Daudhan extends far beyond what any compensation schedule can capture. Those living in the forests around Panna collect seasonal produce, and walk familiar paths with landmarks that existed only because generations before them had learnt where water lingered, where wildlife moved and where crops could survive another uncertain monsoon.

A good mahua season could pay for a wedding, school fees or an old debt. The tendu harvest brought weeks of work, while amla, honey and fuelwood sustained families through the year. Even those who migrated to construction sites in Delhi or Gurgaon often returned for the mahua bloom and the tendu harvest.

What the *patwari*'s compensation register does record — land, houses, standing crops and recognised family units — has, in the final months before these villages disappear, acquired extraordinary importance. For generations, land anchored a family's identity and inheritance. Today, that role increasingly belongs to the plastic folder carrying Aadhaar cards, school certificates, voter identity cards, revenue records and handwritten family registers, shuttled from one government office to another in the hope of proving who the state recognises.

• Key projects

DAUDHAN DAM

77-METRE-HIGH

• 2,853 million cubic metres gross storage capacity

• 70% foundation excavation is done

• 13% excavation completed for dam approach channel

• Work on river diversion, foundation concreting, construction of the main dam body, spillway, gates yet to begin

LINK CANAL

EARLY STAGES

• 65% of work on access roads completed

• Designs of 2 tunnels are yet to be finalised

• 21% of tunnel portals is built

HYDROPOWER STATIONS

130 MW TOTAL CAPACITY

• Power House-I location is under verification

• DPR for Power House-II yet to be finalised

Collector Jaiswal rejects allegations that the rehabilitation survey was flawed. "Every house was photographed, every family documented. People were informed repeatedly through *gram sabhas*," he says.

Sukwaha sits deep inside the forest, reached by an uneven track that is still not fully motorable, making this a 70-km commute from Daudhan dam.

The village is small, with its mud houses — many of them now partially razed, like in Daudhan and Palkhua — scattered between patches of cultivation and trees.

Krishna Adivasi struggles to describe his loss in monetary terms because much of what sustained his family was never recognised as an asset in the first place. "They took our forest, our river and our mahua," he says.

His family of eight received a mere Rs 12 lakh; he says he won't move out until he gets what he is entitled to. Today, several of his family members travel to Chhatarpur for daily-wage work. "Everything has changed. My children dropped out of school," he says.

Vidya Rani once owned three houses and farmland in Sukwaha. Only her husband received Rs 12 lakh in compensation. "If we want to buy new fertile land, the rates are up to Rs 10-20 lakh. We can never buy back what we lost," she says. Her school-age children work as farm labourers in villages. "We don't want more money. We just want enough land to survive."

Santosh Adivasi has become an unlikely broker in Palkhua village, 10 km from the dam site. A property dealer, he sits with a cloth bag full of cash, counting bundles of notes into the hands of villagers as they sell whatever private land lies outside the project's acquisition boundary. For many, these sales are the only way to bridge the gap between the compensation received and the cost of starting over elsewhere. Most plots, he says, fetch between Rs 2 lakh and Rs 5 lakh.

Kalu Adivasi spent years working on construction sites in Delhi before returning to Palkhua when the work dried up. He had bought a parcel of land to set up a store near his village for Rs 3 lakh. He was forced to sell it for Rs 2.5 lakh. "The administration warned us to find new land, otherwise my shop will be demolished after the monsoons. So we have to sell our precious land...it's heartbreaking," he said.

A new beginning

At the resettlement colony in Kavar Karondiya, in Chhatarpur district, fresh brick houses stand beside half-finished ones. Courtyards are filled not with cattle or kitchens, but stacks of bricks, steel rods and cement bags waiting for the next stage of construction. There is no water supply and the resettled villagers shell out Rs 500 for 5,000-litre water tankers.

Ram Swarup says he has spent nearly half his compensation money on building two modest houses. His 17-year-old son has dropped out of school to work as a labourer. Around him, neighbours constantly weigh the price of bricks, cement, iron and sand against the compensation they received.

Dasharath Adivasi from Daudhan, who now runs a small shop selling chips, chewing gum and ice lollies in Karondiya, says he earns Rs 300-400 a day. Back in the village, there were days when he made Rs 5,000 a day. "Half the village hasn't shifted here yet. Without people, there is no business," he says.

Durji Adivasi walks nearly a kilometre every morning to the colony's only hand pump. Filling two buckets can take up to 40 minutes before she carries them home. The family cannot afford tanker water, she says, and the nearest ration shop is about six kilometres away. But she is gradually discovering a new life. "In Daudhan, our house didn't even have electricity," she says, sitting under a lone, white bulb. "Also, I now have a radio. I have been listening to songs".

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If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

• ECONOMY

Education’s falling share in Budget over 12 years



UDIT MISRA

OVER THE past three days, New Delhi’s Jan-tar Mantar has attracted significant attention as many disgruntled youth from across India have come together under the leadership of the so-called Cockroach Janta Party to demand the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan.

The immediate trigger for the protests was the leak of the 2026 NEET-UG question paper. Every year, millions of students hoping to become doctors take the exam. This was neither the first time NEET papers got leaked, nor was it the only examination to witness such a lapse. Reports suggest that over the past decade, test papers have been leaked in over 150 different competitive examinations held in India.

What has intensified criticism is the sense of lack of accountability around such repeated lapses. A recent investigation by *The Indian Express* into the status of cases linked to 45 major exam paper leaks over the past two decades, where each exam saw at least one lakh applicants, threw up stark results. Only two of these cases led to convictions. Most are either trapped in legal quicksand or have hit a dead end. In fact, two of the accused in exam leaks are now representatives in the Uttar Pradesh Assembly.

At a time when the Narendra Modi-led government’s handling of the education sector is under scrutiny, how can its performance be analysed? There is no singular metric, but the allocation of money from annual Budgets to the relevant departments and ministries is a good way to understand the importance any government attaches to a particular issue.

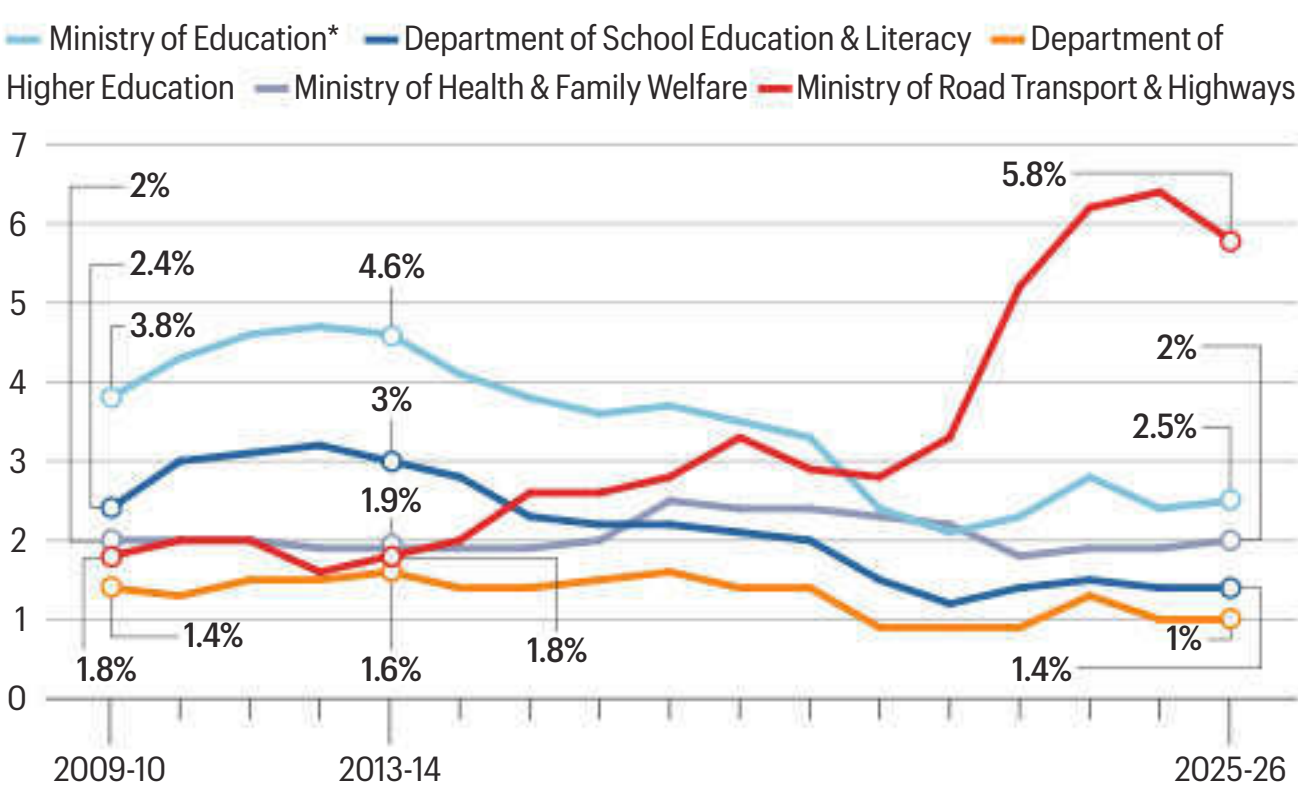
In the past, several scholars have repeatedly criticised Indian governments for not allocating enough funds to critical ministries such as education and health. Here is a look at how the annual allocations towards the Education Ministry in the Union Budgets have changed over the years.

Examining Budget allocations

It is natural that over time, the absolute amount allocated to any major ministry

• WHERE THE GOVERNMENT CHOSE TO SPEND

The chart & table show allocation to various ministries and departments as a % of total Union Budget



*EARLIER CALLED MINISTRY OF HUMAN RESOURCE DEVELOPMENT; SOURCE: CMIE, INDIAN EXPRESS RESEARCH

While the government has come up with the Skill India initiative, the share allocated to the Skill Development ministry has also remained minuscule

Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship	
2015-16	0.06%
2016-17	0.08%
2017-18	0.10%
2018-19	0.11%
2019-20	0.09%
2020-21	0.07%
2021-22	0.06%
2022-23	0.03%
2023-24	0.07%
2024-25	0.06%
2025-26	0.05%

years ago, while the Department of Higher Education’s share is just around 60% of what it used to be.

The share of allocation to the Health Ministry has gone up and down marginally from one year to another, but the share is stagnant over the long term.

In sharp contrast, the share of money spent on making roads and highways has almost trebled in the past 12 years. In fact, 12 years ago, education and health together received 6.5% of the annual Budget while the ministry received just 1.8% of the total expenditure. All these years on, education and health together received only about 4.5% of the annual Budget while the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways receives 5.8% alone.

Skill development allocations

Over the years, especially with the rise of artificial intelligence, governments have focused on skilling over and above education. In fact, in 2015-16, the Union government created a new ministry just for this purpose. However, the share of the Budget spent on skilling presents a sobering picture, and is quite in contrast to the government’s pronouncements to “Skill India”.

As the table shows, the share of allocations to the Ministry of Skill Development was a minuscule 0.06% to begin with, and has now slid to 0.05%.

The takeaway

Looking at the share, level and trend of allocations provides a good understanding of a government’s priorities. To be sure, each government is entitled to choose its own set of priorities — after all, this is exactly why voters choose or discard governments. The Modi government is now in its third consecutive term, suggesting that voters have resoundingly ratified the government’s policy choices.

Yet, the decline in the share of allocation to the Ministry of Education is worrying for the future of India’s youth and their growing aspirations. And while spending more money is no guarantee for the quality of expenditure — as many cases of sinking new roads and falling bridges attest — it is often a necessary first step towards improving the situation. The picture emerging from this data echoes the words of the noted economist John Kenneth Galbraith: “I am worried about our tendency to over invest in things and under invest in people.”

• SCIENCE

IISc’s novel method holds promise for oral cancer treatment

Arnav Chandrasekhar

Bengaluru, July 21

IN A recent scientific breakthrough, researchers from the Indian Institute of Science (IISc) in Bengaluru, in collaboration with the M S Ramaiah Medical College, have discovered potential applications of an ultrasound stimulation technology in treating oral cancer.

Given the prevalence of chewable tobacco products, oral cancer is a significant health concern in India, accounting for about 1 in 4 of all global cases. The study, titled “Revealing biomechanical vulnerabilities in oral cancer cells using 3D coculture platform and low-frequency ultrasound”, was published in the journal *Materials Today Bio*.

What were the findings?

The study used samples taken from 15 patients with Stage 4 oral cancer. It found that oral cancer cells were selectively vulnerable to Low Frequency Ultrasound (LFU) mechanostimulation, a non-invasive procedure.

The team used a “3D co-culture platform” that essentially mimicked the environment of a tumour. Cancer cells form a barrier-like structure around the centre of a solid tumour, which normally blocks infiltration by drugs and immune cells. The treatment focused on breaking down these cells.

According to assistant professor Ajay Tijore, corresponding author of the study, high-frequency ultrasound is widely used in medicine (mostly for diagnostic and imaging purposes), but it has relatively low penetration depth in the body — only upto a few centimetres. Another type is High Intensity Focused Ultrasound (HIFU), which generates heat to “burn” cells in cases such as prostate cancer, which has certain side effects.

USE OF ULTRASOUND

According to professor Ajay Tijore, high-frequency ultrasound is widely used in medicine (mostly for diagnostic and imaging purposes).

But it has relatively low penetration depth in the body. Another form is High Intensity Focused Ultrasound, which generates heat to “burn” cells in cases such as prostate cancer, with certain side effects.

The reason for this selective effect on cancer cells without affecting normal ones was the presence of a protein called Tropomyosin 2.1, which is present in normal cells but found at a lower level in cancer cells. Professor Tijore said, “Due to the loss of these proteins... when you apply such LFU mechanical stimulation from the outside, cancer cells cannot withstand these forces.”

What applications could it have?

A 2024 study in the journal *Oral Oncology* stated that Indians have a five-year survival rate of 50% after treatment, compared with 68% in developed nations. The rate refers to the likelihood of survival after detection, seen in relation to the population without cancer.

According to Tamil Nadu-based oral and maxillofacial surgeon Dr Senthil Kumar, people seeking oral cancer treatment in India currently face several challenges, such as high costs.

“Another issue is identifying the case at earlier stages, and for patients to seek early treatment. Educating patients and inculcating awareness is also important... if there is a benign lesion in the mouth, it has to be followed and evaluated every 3 to 6 months,” he said. Generally, treatment includes a combination of surgery and radiation, and chemotherapy.

Before its use, the new IISc ultrasound technology must also consider potential problems, Dr Kumar said. “On application of pressure, the spillage of cancer cells into neighbouring tissues is the biggest concern. Most surgical-onco treatments like neck dissection (to remove lymph nodes from the neck) are designed based on this consideration.”

The new LFU method could be used across different cancer treatments, such as breast cancer and melanoma (a type of skin cancer). Professor Tijore said, “This is because these are the relatively superficial cancers which could be monitored easily compared to tumours located deep inside the body.” IISc has also patented the ultrasound technology.

• LEGAL

How a new law aims to place ‘Vande Mataram’ on a par with ‘Jana Gana Mana’

Vineet Bhalla

New Delhi, July 21

UNION HOME Minister Amit Shah is set to introduce the Prevention of Insults to National Honour (Amendment) Bill, 2026, in Rajya Sabha during the Monsoon Session. This will amend the Prevention of Insults to National Honour Act, 1971, to grant the national song, *Vande Mataram*, the same statutory protection currently given to the national anthem, *Jana Gana Mana*.

According to Section 3 of the Act, intentionally preventing the singing of the national anthem or causing a disturbance to any assembly engaged in such singing is a criminal offence punishable with imprisonment of up to three years, a fine or both. The Bill proposes to include the national song within the ambit of this section.

Legal status of national song

This year, the Ministry of Home Affairs issued guidelines regarding the singing and playing of the national song. The “orders

relating to the National Song of India” detailed the authorised lyrics, written by Bankim Chandra Chatterjee, and specified occasions for its mass singing, such as “on the unfurling of the National Flag, on cultural occasions or ceremonial functions”.

The orders also stated that “whenever the official version of the National Song is sung or played, the audience shall stand to attention”, and suggested that “in all schools, the day’s work may begin with community singing of the National Song”.

A petition, filed in the Supreme Court by one Muhammed Sayeed Noori, challenged the directives. Arguing for him, Senior Advocate Sanjay Hegde questioned whether people could be “compelled to sing the song in the garb of an advisory”.

A three-judge bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, however, dismissed the plea as “premature” and based on a “vague apprehension of discrimination”. The court said that the government’s directive was advisory in nature and there were no penal consequences for those who

chose not to sing the national song.

How it differs from the national anthem

The Statement of Objects and Reasons of the Bill states that on January 24, 1950, Constituent Assembly President Rajendra Prasad declared that ‘Vande Mataram’ should be “honoured equally” and have “equal status” with ‘Jana Gana Mana’. It then states that “presently, there is no specific legal provision to prevent insults” to the national song.

The national anthem and the national song, however, don’t have equal status within the legal framework. Under Article 51A(a) of the Constitution, it is a fundamental duty of every citizen to respect the national flag and the national anthem. The national song is not mentioned here or anywhere else in the Constitution.

This distinction is also reflected in the government’s executive orders containing guidelines on both. While the playing of both is recommended for the arrival of the

More than maritime infra

The sea-land transit route from Chabahar, that allows India to bypass Pakistan, is viewed as an important part of the International North-South Transport Corridor (INSTC).

INSTC is a multi-mode transport network connecting India with Iran, Russia, Europe and parts of Central Asia. In that sense, the port represents far more than maritime infrastructure.

The end of the US’s Chabahar waivers tilts the regional balance toward China and Pakistan.

President, a Governor or a Lieutenant Governor at state functions, immediately before and after the President addresses the nation over All India Radio and “(w)hen the National Flag is brought on parade”, the anthem is additionally mandated for “Civil and Military investitures”, during parades, for “hoisting of colours in the Navy” and “when the Regimental Colours are presented”.

The orders for the national song exclude such military protocols, specifying its playing only for “civil investitures”.

Disrupting anthem’s singing

To understand how the amended law might operate, one might look at how courts have interpreted the existing Section 3 of the 1971 Act, which currently applies only to the national anthem.

In 2014, the Kerala High Court in *Salman v. State of Kerala* clarified what constitutes such a disturbance. The court refused to quash an FIR against the petitioner, accused of “making noise and hue and cry” while the national anthem was being sung,



targeted sanctions waiver for the Chabahar port to support humanitarian and economic efforts in Afghanistan.

For several years, the port facilitated the delivery of Indian wheat and medical supplies to Afghanistan. In September last year, the US administration withdrew the sanctions waiver, only to grant the exemption again through a six-month waiver in October that officially expired on April 26.

Owing to the end of the sanctions

waivers, India is losing its direct operational control over the Chabahar project.

The MEA has said India has been in discussions with “relevant stakeholders” after the expiry of the waiver.

Importance for Delhi, Tehran

Chabahar is vital for India not only because it provides direct, secure access to Afghanistan and Central Asia, but also because it serves as a counterweight to China’s development of the Gwadar Port in Pakistan, located just 140 km away.

For Tehran, it also serves as a crucial economic hub in the Sistan-Baluchistan province, functioning as a gateway to connect Iran with landlocked Central Asian states, Afghanistan and Russia.

Future hangs in balance

Chabahar had received an allocation of Rs 400 crore in the previous financial year. But the Union Budget for 2026-27 made no allocation for the port.

The current situation has left questions hanging over the future of this strategic route. Without Chabahar, India loses its primary non-Pakistani corridor to landlocked markets, effectively undoing New Delhi’s decades of connectivity planning.

THE GOVERNMENT IS WEIGHING A STANDALONE LAW TO REGULATE AI

AI law may cover agent autonomy, deepfakes

Two legal experts have been asked to submit separate draft liability frameworks for AI models

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, July 21

THE MINISTRY of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) is exploring a consent-based framework for synthetically-generated content, along with curbs on agentic AI autonomy, and regulatory sandboxes for high-risk applications as it weighs a separate law to regulate artificial intelligence (AI), *The Indian Express* has learnt.

Synthetically-generated content is digital media made or altered by AI, rather than humans. The AI law is likely to be presented as a standalone piece of legislation, rather than being under the umbrella of the Information Technology Act, 2000, a senior government official told *The Indian Express*.

The cyber laws division of the IT Ministry, which is responsible for formulating laws and policies that impact tech companies, has been asked to carry out a regulatory analysis of the IT Act, and the various rules made under it, to understand existing gaps.

In the case of agentic AI, the government is expected to consider how much autonomy such agents should have, and whether they should be permitted to retain and reuse data.

Agentic AI refers to autonomous AI systems that go beyond simply generating text. Given a high-level goal, they independently plan multi-step actions, utilise external tools, and adjust their strategy in real

REGULATING AI

IN THE case of agentic AI, the government is expected to consider how much autonomy such agents should have, and whether they should be permitted to retain and reuse data

AGENTIC AI defers to autonomous AI systems that go beyond simply generating text. Given a high-level goal, they independently plan multi-step actions, utilise external tools, and adjust their strategy in real time to achieve the desired outcome with minimal human supervision



THE IT Ministry is also expected to consult the RBI, and the SEBI, to set up a regulatory sandbox for AI applications, particularly in high-impact areas such as finance and public services

time to achieve the desired outcome with minimal human supervision.

The IT Ministry is also expected to consult the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), and the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI), to set up a regulatory sandbox for AI applications, particularly in high-impact areas such as finance and public services.

Platform liability, safe harbour in AI era

Another major conversation currently taking place is the liability that AI platforms and companies – that have developed them – should have for the content that the models generate.

In the consumer Internet world, social media platforms have something called safe harbour, which is legal immunity from hosting user-generated content. This is based on the idea that platforms can not preempt what a user is going to post, and therefore should not be held liable for any problematic speech they may have made.

In the AI world, however,

that same logic is difficult to translate directly. AI models are trained on content present on the Internet, and inevitably use that information to build their responses.

However, while pattern matching for keywords, these models also editorialise their responses in a way where it may be hard to track its exact statements back to a particular source.

It is understood that the government has asked two legal experts from the private sector to submit separate draft liability frameworks for AI models.

Queries sent to the IT Ministry remained unanswered until publication.

“Building a consent-based framework for synthetically generated media would be one of the key requirements for an AI law. We have seen the rapid proliferation of deepfakes on the Internet, and most of them, if not all, are generated by using pictures or videos of individuals whose consent has not been sought by the creator or the platform generating such media,” a senior government official said, requesting anonymity.

“Though the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 looks at broader privacy issues, the questions of consent and data ownership in an AI age merits further examination,” he added.

India’s data protection law exempts personal data that has been voluntarily made public by an individual from any protections that the Act offers.

Many believe that if an AI platform were to scrape pictures of a person’s public social media profile, for instance, such processing is unlikely to have any guardrails under the data protection law.

While the government is now working on an AI law, it had previously said that the country does not need one, and its existing laws were enough to deal with challenges posed by the proliferation of AI platforms.

The government has been enacting piecemeal legislation to bring AI under control. For example, in April, it proposed that social media companies like YouTube, Instagram and X will have to “continuously” display labels on content generated through AI.

However, a broad rethink from targeted lawmaking to an expansive regulatory framework comes amid growing instances of objectionable, high-quality deepfakes, and the government’s anxieties over agentic AI.

Earlier this year, it reprimanded Elon Musk’s Grok AI for aiding in the creation of objectionable deepfakes of women.

In a meeting with stakeholders last month, the IT Ministry particularly flagged Singapore’s governance framework for agentic AI (which was announced in May), and how some jurisdictions that have generally followed a lighter-touch approach to regulation were also re-examining their position.

BRIEFLY

Maruti Suzuki to hike prices by up to Rs 30,000

New Delhi: Car market leader Maruti Suzuki India on Tuesday said it will hike prices of its vehicles across models by up to Rs 30,000 from August to partially offset the sustained increase in input costs. The exact quantum of change will vary from model to model, Maruti Suzuki India said. “In view of the continuous sustained increase in input costs, the company has decided to increase the prices of its models across its portfolio by up to Rs 30,000,” the company said. PTI

‘50k to take part in Franklin MF Olympiad 2026’

Mumbai: Franklin Templeton National Mutual Fund Olympiad (FTNMFO) 2026 — which aims to strengthen financial literacy and investment awareness among students — is expected to reach out to 50,000 students from more than 1,000 colleges across India for their participation, said FinX, a platform for BFSI learning and certification programmes. Undergraduate and postgraduate students across academic disciplines are invited to participate, with the Olympiad expected to engage over 50,000 students from more than 1,000 colleges across India, it said. ENS

MARKETS

 Sensex 77,470.11 -238.41 -0.31%	 NIFTY 24,187.70 -50.80 -0.21%	 Gold ▲ ₹1,43,137	 US Dollar ▼ ₹96.24
 Silver ▲ ₹2,23,204	 Oil ▲ \$85.51	NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION DATA GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF JULY 20, 2026	

FIRM’S MARKET CAPITALIZATION STANDS AT RS 1.24 LAKH CR

SBI Funds lists at 7% gain, misses Street expectations

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, July 21

SBI FUNDS Management ended its debut trading session up around 6.3% from its issue price of Rs 575 on Tuesday.

The asset management wing of SBI had earlier made its market debut at a 7% premium, missing grey-market expectations of a 13-16% listing day gain. The stock, which had listed at Rs 613.30 a share on the National Stock Exchange (NSE), rose to as much as Rs 624.95 at its intraday high before ending the session at Rs 610.15 on the NSE.

The listing gains took the company’s market capitalization to Rs 1.24 lakh crore. Peers ICICI Prudential and HDFC Asset Management Company have a market cap of Rs 1.56 lakh crore and Rs 1.11 lakh crore, respectively.

Despite the below-expected listing, analysts remained positive on the stock due to its market leadership, competitive valuations, and long-term growth potential. SBI Funds Management is India’s largest asset management company, with over Rs 12.5 lakh crore in assets under management and over 15% market share as of March 31.

The fund’s strong distribution strength has built one of the country’s biggest SIP franchises, which sets the company up for long-term success with an attractively valued stock, analysts from Equirius Capital said in a report. The company raised Rs 9,813 crore from its public issue, which was subscribed 41.66

● **SBI Funds is 2nd-largest AMC by market cap**



FUND HOUSE	MARKET CAP (RS CR)
ICICI Prudential AMC	1,55,889
SBI Funds	1,24,277
HDFC AMC	1,10,836
Nippon Life India AMC	74,337
360 ONE WAM	45,362
Aditya Birla Sun Life AMC	30,245

SOURCE: NSE

Setty: SBI not looking at further diluting stake in MF subsidiary

Mumbai: State Bank of India is not looking to dilute its stake further in its asset management arm SBI Funds Management, a top official said on Tuesday. Speaking at the listing ceremony of SBI FM, the largest asset manager in the country, SBI chairman CS Setty said, “At this moment, we are not looking for any more dilution”. He quickly added that

capital markets regulator SEBI’s minimum public holding norms will dictate any stake sales from here on.

SBI sold around 6% of its stake in the asset management company as part of the IPO process and now owns over a 55% stake. Its joint venture partner Amundi, a global asset manager, diluted its nearly 4% stake and owns a 32.5% stake. PTI

times its issue size as of the final day of bidding. It had raised Rs 2,663 crore from global powerhouses such as BlackRock and sovereign wealth funds from Norway and Abu Dhabi, as well as Indian names like LIC, ICICI Prudential, and Kotak Mutual Fund. Amundi, SBI’s joint venture partner in the company, divested a near 4% stake during the issue. The French financial giant’s deputy CEO said it does

not plan to divest any further stake in the asset management company. SBI Chairman also said the bank is not looking for any further dilution. SBI Funds’ positive public issue may provide a boost to India’s sluggish IPO market so far this year following record deals in 2025, with big issues such as NSE and Reliance Jio lined up for the rest of the year. FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Vijay Singh to remain on board of Sir Dorabji Tata Trust, 6 smaller trusts

George Mathew
Mumbai, July 21

VIJAY SINGH, Vice Chairman of Tata Trusts, will continue to serve as a trustee of the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT) and six other smaller trusts for at least another year, even though he has chosen not to seek another term on the board of the Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT) after his current tenure ends on August 14. Singh’s tenure as a trustee of the SDTT will continue until July 2027. He will also remain a trustee of six other smaller Tata trusts.

“My term in SRTT ends on August 14 and I will not put myself up for another term. That’s a decision I had taken earlier,” Singh said. In SDTT, Singh’s term is till next July and he will continue in SDTT and other small trusts for a year or so, he said. Singh is a trustee of JRD Tata Trust, RD Tata Trust, Tata Education Trust, JRD and Thelma Trust, Tata Social Welfare Trust and Jamsetji Tata Trust.

As these trusts are affiliated to SDTT, Singh will continue as a trustee on their boards.

Noel N Tata, Venu Srinivasan, Darius Khambata, Neville N Tata and Bhaskar Bhat are on the boards of SDTT. However, Navajbai Ratan Tata Trust and Bai Hiralal Jamsetji Tata Navsari Charitable Institution are affiliated to SRTT.

SRTT and SDTT are the two major trusts within the Tata Trusts umbrella. SDTT, where Singh will continue as a trustee, holds a 27.98% stake in Tata Sons. On the other hand, SRTT holds a lesser 23.5% stake in Tata Sons.

Tata Trusts holds 66% stake in Tata Sons, the principal holding company of the Tata group. Pallonji Mistry group holds 18.3% in Tata Sons.

However, SRTT may be unable to exercise its voting rights at Tata Sons’ Annual General Meeting (AGM) on August 18 unless it receives approval from the Maharashtra Charity Commissioner, complicating decision-making at a crucial shareholder meeting. The Commissioner is expected to hear Tata Trusts’ response to the various complaints before the AGM. FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

\$314 million tax demand: Pernod drops court case

New Delhi: Pernod Ricard has withdrawn a court challenge against government’s demand of \$314 million in back taxes for allegedly undervaluing Scotch whisky imports for years, an order shows, marking a new twist in a four-year investigation. The tax case is a major challenge for the French spirits maker in India, which contributes roughly 10% of the group’s worldwide sales and is its biggest market by volume. The dispute comes on top of an antitrust case and a separate ban in New Delhi city that Pernod is contesting over allegations of liquor policy violations, which it denies. Pernod had challenged the

tax demand issued last September, which alleged the company withheld the composition of its whisky imports and the age of the blends, significantly reducing its 150% tariff charges, Reuters reported in May.

Seeking to quash the demand, Pernod argued in a New Delhi court that India had not provided it with investigation data during the probe, which could have helped it defend itself. Pernod, the maker of Chivas Regal whisky and Absolut vodka, has now decided to take the case via the tax authority appeal route, although it was not clear why, nine months after starting a court challenge. REUTERS

RBI plans wider test for foreign control of firms

Mumbai: The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Tuesday proposed changes to foreign exchange management rules, broadening the conditions used to determine whether an Indian firm is controlled by foreign shareholders.

The changes were part of draft rules that the RBI said aim to create a more user-friendly framework for foreign investment. The central bank has sought feedback by 31 August.

Under the proposed framework, an Indian entity would be deemed foreign-controlled if a foreign investor holds 10% or more of voting rights, can appoint a majority of directors or can influence management and policy decisions.

The proposals drew immediate concern from lawyers, who warned the new numerical threshold could expand the definition of foreign control.

“The RBI has introduced a numerical benchmark that does not presently exist and could expand the circumstances in which a foreign investor is regarded as exercising control and attract higher compliances,” said Anuroop Omkar, founding partner at AK & Partners, a law firm.

The RBI proposals are part of India’s broader push to attract foreign investment including through tax cuts and lower compliance costs, even as capital outflows persist.

The concern centres on minority investors. Anjali Malhotra, partner, regulatory, at consultancy firm Nangia Global, said the proposed definition of control warrants further consideration. REUTERS



IIFL HOME LOAN

IIFL Home Finance Limited

CIN: U65993MH2006PLC166475

Regd. Office -IIFL House, Sun Infotech Park, Road No. 16V, Plot No. B-23, MIDC, Thane Industrial Area, Wagle Estate, Thane-400604, Maharashtra | **Tel:** (91-124) 478 0900
Fax: (91-221) 2580 6654 | **Email:** secretarialhfc@iiflhomeloans.com | **Website:** www.iiflhomeloans.com

STATEMENT OF UNAUDITED STANDALONE FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED JUNE 30, 2026

₹ in crores except otherwise stated

S. No.	Particulars	Quarter Ended June 30, 2026 Unaudited	Quarter Ended June 30, 2025 Unaudited	Year Ended March 31, 2026 Audited
1	Total Income from Operations	987.99	948.62	3,807.61
2	Net Profit / (Loss) for the periods / year (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items*)	237.32	252.90	974.09
3	Net Profit / (Loss) for the periods / year before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items*)	237.32	252.90	974.09
4	Net Profit / (Loss) for the periods / year after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items*)	184.20	197.68	745.81
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the periods / year [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the periods / year (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	219.28	191.73	747.58
6	Paid up Equity Share Capital	26.34	26.34	26.34
7	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve, if any)	8,268.61	7,658.78	8,038.34
8	Securities Premium Account (included in Sl. No.7-Reserves)	2,969.65	2,969.65	2,969.65
9	Net worth	8,294.95	7,685.12	8,064.68
10	Paid up Debt Capital / Outstanding Debt	23,059.17	19,313.75	22,712.67
11	Outstanding Redeemable Preference Shares	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable
12	Debt Equity Ratio (in-times)	2.78	2.51	2.82
13	Earnings Per Share (of ₹10/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations) (not annualised for the quarters)			
	• Basic: (₹)	69.92	75.04	283.10
	• Diluted: (₹)	69.25	74.12	280.77
14	Capital Redemption Reserve	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable
15	Debenture Redemption Reserve	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable
16	Debt Service Coverage Ratio	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable
17	Interest Service Coverage Ratio	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable

- Exceptional and/ or Extraordinary items adjusted in the Statement of Profit and Loss in accordance with Ind AS Rules/ AS Rules, whichever is applicable.

Note:

- The above unaudited standalone financial results for the quarter ended June 30, 2026, have been reviewed and recommended by the Audit Committee and subsequently approved by the Board of Directors of the Company at their respective meetings held on July 20, 2026. The Joint Statutory Auditors have carried out the limited review of the aforesaid results and have issued an unmodified conclusion.
- The above is an extract of the detailed format of financial results for the quarter ended June 30, 2026 filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 ("Listing Regulations"). The full format of the financial results are available on National Stock Exchange of India Limited (NSE): www.nseindia.com, BSE Limited (BSE): www.bseindia.com and can be accessed on the website of the Company: www.iiflhomeloans.com/investor-relations/financials.
- For the other line items referred in Regulation 52(4) of the Listing Regulations, pertinent disclosures have been made to Stock Exchanges and available on NSE: www.nseindia.com, BSE: www.bseindia.com and can be accessed on the website of the Company: www.iiflhomeloans.com/investor-relations/financials.
- The Accounting policies adopted in the preparation of the financial results are consistent with those followed in the previous periods /year unless otherwise stated.
- Previous periods / year figures have been regrouped/reclassified wherever necessary to conform to the current period's presentation.

By order of the Board
For IIFL Home Finance Limited

Girish Kousgi
Managing Director & CEO
DIN: 08524205

Date: July 20, 2026
Place: Mumbai

SALUTE THE SOLDIER

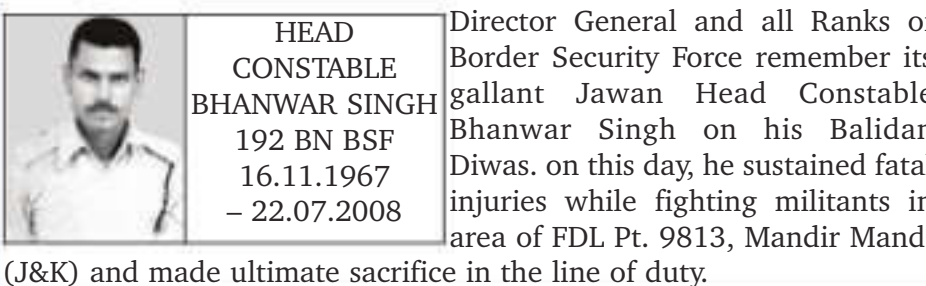
ASSAM RIFLE



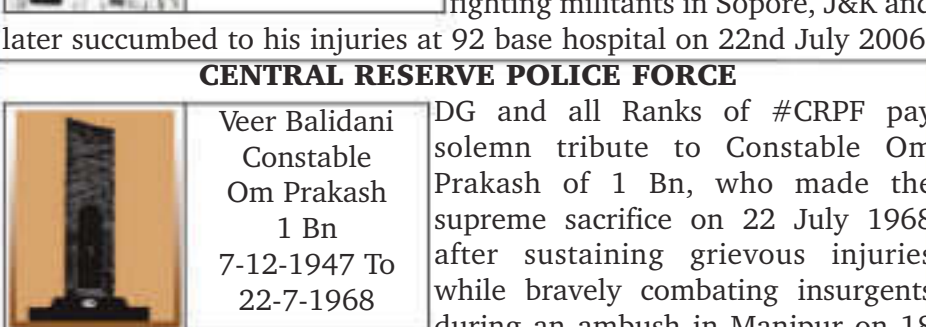
The Tagra Teyees family proudly remembers its Bravehearts who in the true traditions of the Assam Rifles made supreme sacrifice while bravely combating terrorists in Puneja, Doda District, (J&K) on 22nd July 1995. May the Almighty grant eternal peace to their soul. Their gallant action will continue to inspire us all.

DEEPLY REMEMBERED BY COMMANDANT & ALL RANKS 23 ASSAM RIFLES 'TAGRA TEYEEs'

BORDER SECURITY FORCE

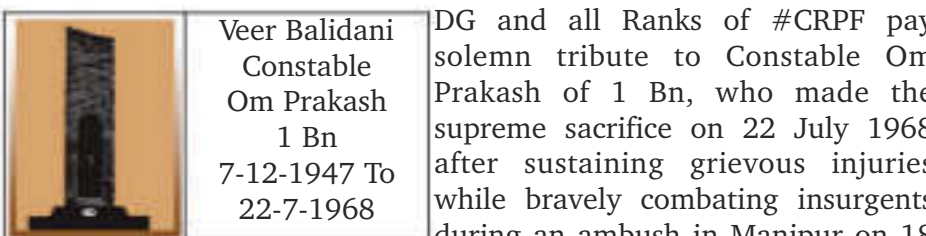


Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable/Tradesman Bhanwar Singh on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal injuries while fighting militants in area of FDL Pt. 9813, Mandir Mandi (J&K) and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.

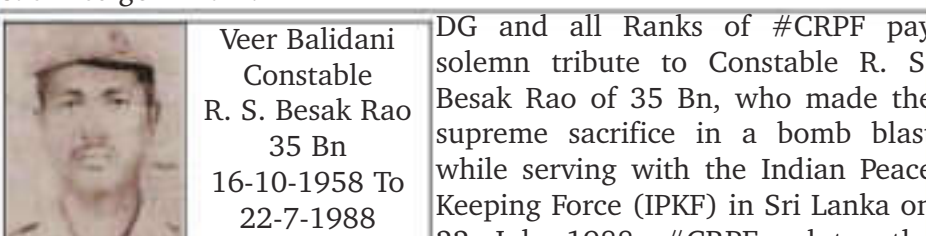


Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable/Tradesman Anil Kumar on his Balidan Diwas. On 04th July 2006, he sustained fatal injuries in a grenade blast while fighting militants in Sopore, J&K and later succumbed to his injuries at 92 base hospital on 22nd July 2006.

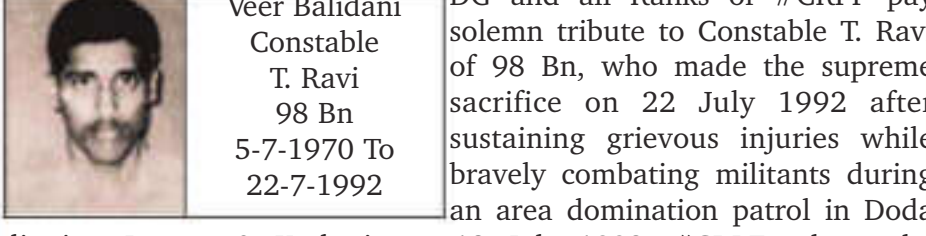
CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE



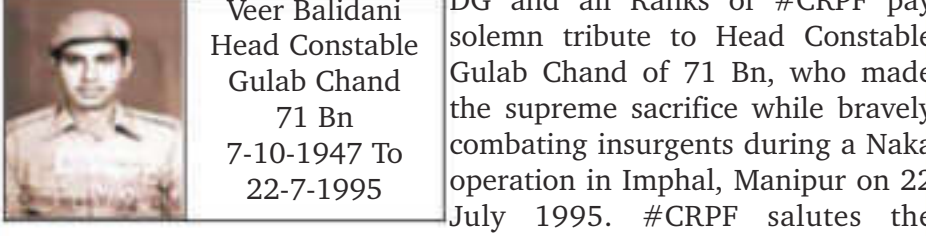
DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Om Prakash of 1 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice on 22 July 1968 after sustaining grievous injuries while bravely combating insurgents during an ambush in Manipur on 18 July 1968. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable R. S. Besak Rao of 35 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice in a bomb blast while serving with the Indian Peace Keeping Force (IPKF) in Sri Lanka on 22 July 1988. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



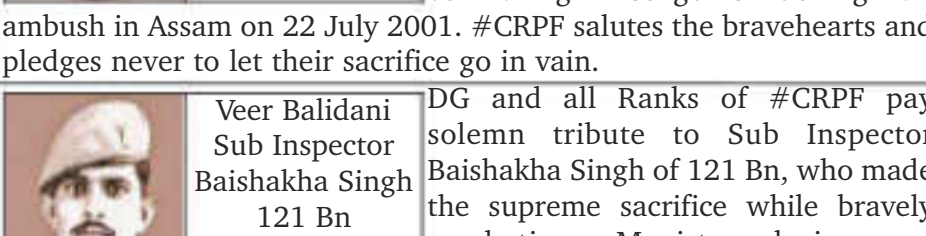
DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable T. Ravi of 98 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice on 22 July 1992 after sustaining grievous injuries while bravely combating militants during an area domination patrol in Doda 18 July 1992. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Head Constable Gulab Chand of 71 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating insurgents during a Naka operation in Imphal, Manipur on 22 July 1995. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

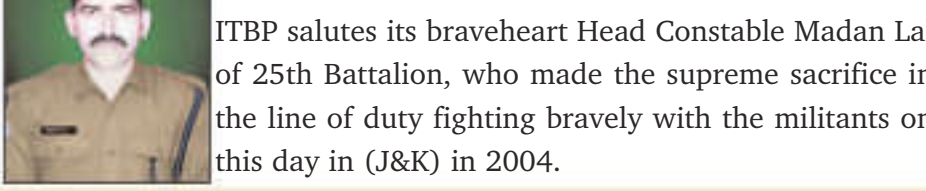


DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Asst Comdt Shri Vinod Kumar Yadav, Constable/Bugler Khem Singh, and Constable/Driver Rajbir Singh of 40 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating insurgents during an ambush in Assam on 22 July 2001. #CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.



DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Sub Inspector Baishakha Singh of 121 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating Maoists during an operation in Jharkhand on 22 July 2003. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

INDO-TIBETAN BORDER POLICE(ITBP)



ITBP salutes its braveheart Head Constable Madan Lal of 25th Battalion, who made the supreme sacrifice in the line of duty fighting bravely with the militants on this day in (J&K) in 2004.

दक्षिणांचल विद्युत वितरण निगम लि०

अधीक्षण अभियन्ता विद्युत वितरण मण्डल-हाथरस

पत्रांक-2503 / विचि०म०हा० / वितरण / दिनांक 21/07/26

अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा सूचना

1- EDCH-28/2026-27- विद्युत वितरण मण्डल हाथरस के क्षेत्रान्तर्गत "टर्नकी" आधार पर पूर्णजमा योजना मद में नामागि गये क्रमान्तर्गत कार्य कराये जाना।

ई-निविदा की अंतिम तिथि: 05.08.2026,

विस्तृत जानकारी एवं प्रश्न वेबसाइट <https://etender.up.nic.in> पर उपलब्ध है।

अधोतर समस्त सूचनाएं वेबसाइट पर ही प्रदर्शित की जाएंगी।

हस्ता./- अधीक्षण अभियन्ता

AAVAS FINANCIERS LIMITED

(CIN:L65922RJ2011PLCO34297) Regd. & Corp. Office: 201-202, 2nd Floor, South End Square, Mansarovar Industrial Area, Jaipur. 302020

AUCTION NOTICE

Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower (s) and Guarantor (s) that the below described immovable property mortgaged/charged to the Secured Creditor, the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of AAVAS FINANCIERS LIMITED Secured Creditor, will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is", and "Whatever there is" basis. The details of the cases are as under.

Name of Borrowers/ Co-Borrowers/ Guarantors/Mortgagors	Dues As on	Date & Amount of 13(2) Demand Notice	Date of Possession	Description of Property	Reserve Price For Property	Earnest Money For Property	Date & Time of Auction	Place of Tender Submission, Tender Open & Auction at Aavas Financiers Ltd.
Ganesh Ganesh, Geeta G (AC NO.) 241224604037411	Rs. 18,34,038.00/- Dues As On 21 July 2026	07 Oct 25 Rs. 1586381/- Dues As On 03 Oct 25	19 May 26	House On Kharsa No.Min 454 And 455 At Mauza Ukharha, Teshli Agra, Colony Name Mahadev Nager, Agra Agra Uttar Pradesh (In)-282001 / Admeasuring 80 Sq. Yard	Rs. 2075200/-	Rs. 207520/-	11.00 Am To 01.00 Pm 22 Aug 2026	Office No 1, 2nd Floor, Block No. 38/4a, Sumridhi Business Suites, Sanjay Place, Agra-282002, Uttar Pradesh-India

Terms & Conditions: 1). The person, taking part in the tender, will have to deposit his offer in the tender form provided by the AFL which is to be collected from the above branch offices during working hours of any working day, super scribing "Tender Offer for name of the property" on the sealed envelope along with the Cheque/DD/pay order of 10% of the Reserve Price as Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) in favour of AAVAS FINANCIERS LIMITED payable at Jaipur on/before time of auction during office hours at the above mentioned offices. The sealed envelopes will be opened in the presence of the available interested parties at above mentioned office of AAVAS FINANCIERS LIMITED The Inter-se bidding, if necessary will also take place among the available bidders. The EMD is refundable if the bid is not successful. 2). The successful bidder will deposit 25% of the bidding amount adjusting the EMD amount as initial deposit immediately or within 24hrs after the fall of the hammer towards the purchase of the asset. The successful bidder failing to deposit the said 25% towards initial payment, the entire EMD deposited will be forfeited & balance amount of the sale price will have to be deposited within 15 days after the confirmation of the sale by the secured creditor; otherwise his initial payment deposited amount will be forfeited. 3). The Authorised officer has absolute right to accept or reject any bid or adjourn/postpone the sale process without assigning any reason therefore. If the date of tender depositing or the date of tender opening is declared as holiday by Government, then the auction will be held on next working day. 4). For inspection and interested parties who want to know about the procedure of tender may contact AAVAS FINANCIERS LIMITED 201,202, 1Ind Floor, South End Square, Mansarovar Industrial Area, jaipur-302020 or **Rajesh Kumar - 8306252400** or respective branch during office hours. **Note:** This is also a 15/30 days notice under Rule 9(1)&(8) to the Borrowers/Guarantors/Mortgagor of the above said loan accounts about tender inter se bidding sale on the above mentioned date. The property will be sold, if their out standing dues are not repaid in full.

Place : Uttar Pradesh Date : 22-07-2026

Authorised Officer Aavas Financiers Limited

AP POWER GENERATION CORPORATION LIMITED V.S. VIJAYAWADA-520004

(A Govt. of A.P. Undertaking)

NIT No: 610002334

Name of the work: "Engineering, Supply, Installation and Commissioning of Auxiliary Power System of Stage-III, Dr. NTTPS" through e-procurement. Schedule available Date & Time : 17.07.2026-18.00 Hrs onwards Bid submission Closing Date & Time: 07.08.2026-13.00 Hrs. For other details visit website, viz. www.apgenco.gov.in (or) <https://etender.apgenco.gov.in/cri/porta>.

R.No.- 5271PP/Dt: 21.07.2026

BANGALORE ELECTRICITY SUPPLY COMPANY LIMITED

(Wholly Owned by Government of Karnataka Undertaking) (CIN-U04010KA2002SGC030438)

BRIEF TENDER NOTIFICATION (Through KPP portal)

BESCOM invites tender for the following Enquiry/Indent No.: **BESCOM/2026-27/EL/ WORK_INDENT1155**. Preventive and Breakdown maintenance of all makes & all configurations of DAS and Non DAS RMUs in BRAZ area of BESCOM on Total Turnkey on Percentage quoting basis. For the above Work: Bid documents will be available from **27-07-2026**. Last Date for submission is **27-08-2026**. Opening of Bids is **28-08-2026 at 17:15 hrs**. The Tender Documents can be obtained through KPP portal website <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>. Aspiring bidders need to register on KPP portal. Further Bidders can take assistance with KPPM help desk contact numbers (080-46010000, 080-68948777) or email at support@eprochelpdesk.com. Further details can be obtained from the office of the undersigned.

Sd/- Chief General Manager(Elc.,) Procurement, BESCOM

For electricity related complaints Call: 1912 Download BESCOM Mithra Mobile APP

BIHAR SCHOOL EXAMINATION BOARD

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

(Through e-procurement mode only over <https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in>)

Tender Notice No. : PR 165/2026

Bihar School Examination Board invites e-tenders under two bid systems from the reputed Service Providers/ Firms /Companies/ Agencies/ Societies for "Selection of Agency for Design, Development, Implementation and Maintenance on a real time interactive one to one Learning Support Platform (24x7) for Students of Class 9th to 12th in Model Schools of Bihar." Detailed tender document containing eligibility criteria, other terms and conditions are available on the website <https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in>.

Tender Schedule

Date and Time for Activity	Date/Time: Duration
Online Sale/ Download Date of Tender Documents	From: 22/07/2026 (15:00 Hrs.) to 11/08/2026 (15:00 Hrs.) (https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
Pre-Bid Meeting	31/07/2026 at 12:30 Hrs. (Bihar School Examination Board, Sinha Library Road, Patna-800017)
Last Date/ Time for Submission/ uploading of Online Bid	11/08/2026 up to 15:00 Hrs. (https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
Last Date and Time for Submission of EMD in Hard Copy / Original (Only in case of BG)	11/08/2026 at 15:30 Hrs.
Date & Time for Opening of Technical Bid	11/08/2026 at 16:00 Hrs (https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
Date & Time for Opening of Financial Bid	Date to be announced later by Competent Authority.
Cost of the Tender Document	₹5,900/- (Five Thousand Nine Hundred Rupees Only) (Non-Refundable)
Tender Processing Fee	₹5,900/- (Five Thousand Nine Hundred Rupees Only) (Non-Refundable)
Earnest Money	₹10,00,000/- (Ten Lakh Rupees only) (Refundable)

* Contact Details: Nodal Officer, Mobile No.: +91 62999 23095, E-Mail ID: eproc-bseb-bih@gov.in/ eproc.bseb@gmail.com

* **Note:** Bihar School Examination Board reserves the right to accept/ cancel/ reschedule tenders without assigning any reasons. Prospective bidders are advised to regularly visit <https://eproc2.bihar.gov.in>. Corrigendum/ Amendments etc., if any, will be notified on this portal only and no separate advertisement will be made.

Secretary

GOVERNMENT OF JHARKHAND

Directorate of Food & Consumer Affairs

3rd FLOOR JSFC BHAVAN, KADRU MAIN ROAD, RANCHI, JHARKHAND, 834002

Letter no- Kha.Up.Ni-02-Dho.Sa.Yo.-03/2026-1246 Dated :- 20-07-2026

Corrigendum Notice

Following modifications/amendments are being made for GeM Bid Number – GEM/2026/B/7647392, for supply of Dhoti, Saree and Lungi, under Sona Sobran Dhoti Saree Distribution Scheme:-

Sl No.	Clause No.	Existing terms	Modified terms
1	10.2	The bidding entities shall be Registered under company act 1956 such as Private Limited/ Limited/ Public Limited Company /Govt./ Semi Govt. institutions fulfilling the minimum eligibility Criteria. The bidder shall be a single entity. No consortium/joint venture shall be allowed. Certificate of incorporation must be submitted in this context.	The bidding entities shall be any individual or partnership firm or society or trust or company, fulfilling the minimum eligibility Criteria. The bidder shall be a single entity. No consortium/joint venture shall be allowed. Registration/incorporation of individual or partnership firm or society or trust or company must be submitted in this context.
2	10.12	Bidder should have minimum processing capacity of 3,00,000 meters/day which should be complied with consent provided by pollution control board of the state, a certificate issued by Ministry of Commerce and Industry, GoI/MSME/District Industry Authority is required for processing capacity verification along with Consent issued by state pollution control Board.	Bidder should have minimum processing capacity of 3,00,000 meters/day The bidder shall submit valid Consent to Operate (CTO) Certificate(s) issued by the State Pollution Control Board(s) of the concerned state where the processing unit is established. The certificate should clearly indicate an approved and existing production capacity at least 3,00,000 meters/day, along with certificate issued by Ministry of Commerce and Industry, GoI/MSME/District Industry Authority is required for processing capacity verification.
3	10.5	To ensure quality through all stages of manufacturing process, the Bidder should have their own in-house facility for Spinning, Weaving, Processing (Bleaching, Dyeing, Printing, finishing).	To ensure quality through all stages of manufacturing process, the Bidder should have their own facility (under one PAN) for Spinning, Weaving, Processing (Bleaching, Dyeing, Printing, finishing), which may/may not be located at different places or states.
4	Date Extension	Existing last date and time of bid submission 25-07-2026 at 1700 hrs.	Extended last date and time of bid submission 29-07-2026 at 1700 hrs.

All others terms and conditions/clauses published by PR No-382106 bearing letter No- 1019 dated- 10-06-2026 shall remain same.

Sd/- Deputy Secretary, Directorate of Food and Consumer Affairs

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER CONSTRUCTION CIRCLE, U.P. JAL NIGAM (URBAN)

GWALIOR ROAD, JHANSI-284001

Email:- seurbanjhsircle@gmail.com

Letter No: 1036/F-03/145 Date: 20.07.2026

TENDER NOTICE

U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) E-bids are invited in two bid system on percentage rate basis for "Feeder main Pipe Line Shifting From Risala Chungi To Bhagwantpura Jhansi U.P." from eligible, reputed and experienced bidder. E-bid documents will be available for download from 22.07.2026 by 15:00 Hrs. Pre-bid meeting will be held on dated 27.07.2026 at 12:30 Hrs in undersigned office. E-bids can be submitted till 06.08.2026 up to 15:00 Hrs. and technical bid shall be opened on 06.08.2026 at 15:30 Hrs. in the office of Superintending Engineer Construction Circle, UPJN (Urban) Jhansi in presence of contractor or their authorized representative, E-tender cost is Rs 10000.00 + GST @ 18% for tender. Details are available on U.P. Govt. e-procurement portal <http://etender.up.nic.in> and U.P.J.N website www.jn.upscd.gov.in.

WESTERN RAILWAY

SUPPLYING & REPLACEMENT WORK

Divisional Railway Manager (WA), Western Railway, 6th floor, Engr. Deptt., Mumbai Central, Mumbai - 400 008, Invites E-Tender

Notice No: BC726-27/101 dt.17/07/2026.

Work and Location: Virar-Joravasan Section- Supplying & Replacement of H-Beam Sleeper fittings on various bridges under jurisdiction of Sr.DEN/North. **Approx. Cost of Work: ₹ 9,29,34,998.74. EMD: ₹ 18,58,700/-.** **Date & Time of Submission:** Till 14.08.2026, 15:00 hrs. **Date & Time of Opening:** On 14.08.2026 at 15:30 hrs. For further details please visit our website www.irops.gov.in 0381

Like us on: facebook.com/WesternRly

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

Open Tender Notice No. : NER-BSBOSnT-OT-32-2026

"Open Tenders" through Online (E-Tendering) are invited by Divisional Railway Manager (Signal & Telecomm) / Varanasi / N. E. Railway for and behalf of the President of India for the following works:-

SN 1, Tender Notice No. and Description of Work: NER-BSBOSnT-OT-32-2026; Name of work: Provision of Multi section Digital axle counter in Berthing tracks & water logging track portions at GCT station of Varanasi division. Approx Value: Rs. 1347401.28; Earnest Money : Rs. 269500.00/-, Cost of Tender Form: Rs. 00.00/-, Completion Period : 10 Months; Tender Closing date & Time : 13.08.2026 up to 15.00 Hrs.

1. Tender Notice will be submitted up to 15:00 Hrs on date 13.08.2026. 2. For full details and submission of bid kindly visit the Official website of Indian railways i.e. www.irops.gov.in

Divl. Rly. Manager (S&T), Varanasi CPRO/Sig - 69

"Never travel on roof and foot boards"

CHITTARANJAN LOCOMOTIVE WORKS

E- Tender Notice

Tender Notice No: PCMM/CLW/HWH/E-Procurement/26/29, Dated: 15/07/2026. PCMM/CLW/HWH on behalf of the President of India invites electronic bids from established reliable manufacturer for supply of the followings. The following E-Tender/s is for supply of materials for manufacture of Electric Locomotive. The Prospective/ likely suppliers are requested to look up the website www.irops.gov.in, for detailed instructions. These are E-Tenders only electronic offer bids shall be accepted. SL No.; Tender No.; Description of Stores; Quantity; Due On: Tender Cost are as follows: [113]; 31265008A; Set of kit items for implementation of RDSO modifications in Panels and Harnessed Cable as per scope of supply enclosed in doc. Tab; As Per Tender/Document; 05/08/2026, ₹ 0.00. [114]; 14262636; Oil Pump Bracket Fixing To Drg./Spec. No. CLW/ES/3/0148/A; As Per Tender/Document; 05/08/2026, ₹ 0.00. [115]; 14262993; Set Of Bus Bar For Other Section For WAG-9HC (Consisting Of 04 Items) For CLW/CRJ and Dankuni To Drg./Spec.No. CLW/ES/3/0118/M (Set Detail Attached); As Per Tender/Document; 13/08/2026; ₹ 0.00. [116]; 23265037A; 3 Core 185 Sq.mm XLPE insulated and PVC sheathed stranded, screened steel strip Armoured Aluminium Conductor Cable rated for 11KV. (As per IS:7098-2), Make: POLYCAB/ Havell's/ Finolex/ RR Kabel/ KEL or similar. [Quantity Tolerance (+/-): 5%, Item Category: Normal, Total PO value variation Permitted: Max 8 lacs; As Per Tender/Document; 20/08/2026, ₹ 0.00.

PR6/430 PCMM/CLW/Howrah

Visit us on: www.facebook.com/clwrailways

Govt. of Bihar

OFFICE OF THE RESIDENT ENGINEER

BUILDING DIVISION, BIHAR BHAWAN, NEW DELHI

National Competitive Bidding by e-tendering Website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in

E-tender Notice

CORRIGENDUM

This is to inform to all that in E-tender notice No-01/2026-27 whose PR No. is IPRD_PR_007073/26-27 Published in daily new-paper and issued from this office by letter No. 408 enc, dated 03.07.2026 following modifications are being made.

Name of Work:- Comprehensive Housekeeping, Maintenance and operation Contract (for 5 years) of Bihar Sadan, Dwarka, New Delhi 2026-31

Sl. No	Particulars	Last Modified Date and time	4 th Modified Date and Time
1	Last date and time of sale (download) of BOQ	from Date 22.07.2026 up to 15.00 hrs	from Date 06.08.2026 to 01.09.2026 up to 15.00 hrs
2	Last Date and time of submission (upload) of tender	Date 18.08.2026 upto 15.00 hrs	Date 02.09.2026 upto 15.00 hrs
3	Date and time of opening of tender (Technical Bid)	Date 19.08.2026 upto 15.30 hrs	Date 03.09.2026 upto 15.30 hrs
4	Date and time of opening of tender (Financial Bid)	After disposal of Technical Bid from Departmental Tender Committee	After disposal of Technical Bid from Departmental Tender Committee
5	Pre Bid Meeting Date/Time/Place	Date 30.07.2026 at 15.00 Hrs. in office of Chief Engineer (Patna), BCD, Patna. Date 06.08.2026 at 15.00 Hrs. in office of Bihar Bhawan, New Delhi.	Date 13.08.2026 at 15.00 Hrs. in office of Chief Engineer (Patna), BCD, Patna. Date 17.08.2026 at 15.00 Hrs. in office of Bihar Bhawan, New Delhi.

All other conditions will remain unchanged

Resident Engineer Building Division Bihar Bhawan, New Delhi

This information is available on website state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar also PR.No.008236 (BCD) 2026-27

नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

Govt. of Bihar

ROAD CONSTRUCTION DEPARTMENT

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER, ROAD DIVISION, LAKHISARAI.

Email ID:- ecerdlakhisarai2019@gmail.com, Mob:-9470001270

SBD BASED NOTICE INVITING TENDER

(National Competitive Bidding)

(Through e-procurement mode only <http://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in>)

NIT No.- RCD / Lakhisarai / e-Tendering / 04 / 2026-27

1. Designation And Address of The Advertiser :-	Executive Engineer, R.C.D., Road Division, Lakhisarai.
2. Date Of Issue of Notice Inviting Tender :-	17.07.2026
3. Period For Download of Tender Document :-	From 10.08.2026 to 17.08.2026 Up to 15:00 hrs: (From Website: http://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in) Only.
4. Date, Time & Place of Pre-Bid Meeting :-	12.08.2026 at 11:00 hrs. at Office of The Chief Engineer, South, RCD, Bihar, Patna.
5. Last Date & Time for Uploading Tender Document By Bidder :-	18.08.2026 Up to 15:00 hrs. On Website: (http://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in) Only.
6. Date, Time & Place Of Opening Of Technical Bid :-	Date-18.08.2026 after 15:30 hrs. On Website : http://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
7. Authority :-	As per direction of higher authority of RCD, Bihar, Patna
8. Details Of Works:	

Group No.	Name of work	Estimated Cost (in Lakh)	Amount of Earnest money (Rs. in Lakh)	Cost of B.O.O. (To be paid through online mode (Non-refundable) (In Rs.)	Bid Processing Fee (To be paid through online mode (Non-refundable) (In Rs.)	Time of completion of work (in months) including monsoon period.
1	Widening and Strengthening of Haisi to Manjhiway Road From km. 0.00 to km. 10.350 under Road Division, Lakhisarai for the Year 2024-25	2876.294	38.77	10000.00	5900.00 or As per eproc-2 website	15 Months

9. Date, Time & Place of opening of Financial Bid:- to be announced after approval of Technical Bid by Competent Authority (on Website : <https://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in>)

10. Bid Validity :- 120 Days

For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar

Executive Engineer, RCD, Road Division, Lakhisarai

PR. No. 008229 (RCD) 2026-27

बिहार में शराब का व्यापार, बिक्री एवं सेवन अवेध है। इससे संबंधित शिकायत इस नंबर पर दर्ज कराये, आपकी जानकारी गुप्त रखी जाएगी।

टॉल फ्री नं- 15545 या 1800 345 6268

UTTARAKHAND POWER CORPORATION LTD.

(A Govt. of Uttarakhand Undertaking)

Corporate Identity No. UA40109UP2001SGC025867/2358

Victoria Cross Vijeta Gabar Singh Urja Bhawan, Kanwali Road, Dehradun-248001

Telephone-0135-2763672-76, Fax No.0135-2760289 Website: www.uktenders.gov.in

No. 533/EE(CM)/UPCL/A-2 E-TENDER NOTICE Date :- 20.07.2026

TENDER SPECIFICATION NO. CCP-II/8/2026-2027

Uttarakhand Power Corporation Ltd. Dehradun invites e-tender for following item:-

Name of Item	Quantity (Nos.)	Estimated Cost (in ₹ Crore)	Average Yearly Turn Over of preceding Three Financial Year (in ₹ Crore)	Earnest Money (in ₹ Lakh)	Cost of Tender Document including GST (in ₹)	Last date & time of online request for Tender and submission of tender in online & off line mode	Date of opening of Part-I of tender in online & off line mode
33kV, 1250A Outdoor Vacuum Circuit Breaker	50	1.600	3.202	3.202	11 800	05.08.2026 upto 17:00 Hrs.	06.08.2026 at 15:30 Hrs.

For further details, please visit our website www.uktenders.gov.in

Superintending Engineer Corporate (Contract & Procurement-II)

"Save Electricity in the Interest of the Nation" Use LED Bulb to save Electricity. (Toll Free -1912) "Pay Electricity bill online 24 x 7 from www.upcl.org." (For information on Electricity Theft, informer may report to Toll Free No. 1800 180 4185/Fax : 0135-2760911)

Office of the Executive Engineer

Drinking Water & Sanitation Mechanical Division Dumka

e-Procurement Notice

Very Short Term Tender

Tender Reference No.:DWSD/Mech. Div.Dumka/03/2026-27 (2nd Call) Date- 21.07.2026

1	Department Name :	Drinking Water & Sanitation Department
2	Name & Address of the office Inviting Tender :	Executive Engineer, D. W. & S. Mechanical Division Dumka
3	Date of Publication of tender/time in website :	24.07.2026/11:00 AM
4	Last date/time for receipt of online bid :	01.08.2026/04:00 PM
5	Last date/time of online submission of Earnest Money and Cost of BOQ (As per Letter No. - 120, dated-03-10-2023 of Secretary, Information Technology & e-Governance Department, Govt. of Jharkhand) :	01.08.2026/04:00 PM
6	Date of opening of tender' time :	03.08.2026/04:00 PM

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I,MANJIT KAUR W/O DHARMINDER SINGH ADD:-F-7/10,F-BLOCK,MALVIYA NAGAR,NEW DELHI 110017,changed my name to **MANJEET KAUR** 0040867319-4

It is for general information that I, RAJESH MAHAJAN S/O JOGINDER MAHAJAN R/O A-1/67, THIRD FLOOR, NEAR PANCHSHEEL PARK METRO STATION, PANCHSHEEL ENCLAVE, MALVIYA NAGAR, SOUTH DELHI, DELHI-110017 declare that name of my minor daughter has been wrongly written as ANANYA RAJESH MAHAJAN aged 15 in her school records. The actual name of my minor daughter is ANANYA MAHAJAN, which may be amended accordingly. 0040867191-2

I,SWEETY Gupta w/o AJAY KIKAN,R/o C-57 INDIRA ENCLAVE NEB SARAI ignou South DELHI-110068, have changed my name to **SWEETY KIKAN.** 0040867336-8

I, Rajnish Singh Duvrijay singh Chauhan S/o Duvrijay Singh R/o 386 Block B Sigma Apartments Beta 1 Greater Noida G.B Nagar, I have changed my name from Rajnish Singh Duvrijay Singh Chauhan to Rajnish Singh Chauhan for all future purposes. 0071049004-1

I,SM.T. DURGA KASHYAP,W/O-RAVINDER SINGH MALIK R/O-PIPLI KHERA(G)SONIPAT HARYANA-131039,Changed my name to **DURGASH** for all future purposes. 0040867357-3

I, Mejar Singh Shekhawat S/o Chhattu Singh Shekhawat, R/o House No. 154/54, Pooth Khurd, Delhi-110039, have changed my name to Major Singh. 0071049037-1

I,Sadhvi Satya Prabha,D/o-Ram Shankar, R/O-LUV-102,Plot.No.66,Paran Shakti Peeth,Agrasen Awas, I.P.Extn,Shakarpur,East-Delhi-110092,have changed my name to **Satya Prabha,Sadhvi Satya Prabha,**and **Satya Prabha** is one and the same person. 0040867336-1

I, Rajani Choudhary S/o Veer Chaudary R/o 171, Sector-20, Navada, Greater Noida, Birondi, Chakrasenpur Gautam Buddha Nagar Uttar Pradesh-201310 has changed my name from **RAJANI CHOUDHARY** to **RAJNI CHOUDHARY** for all future Purposes. 0071048980-1

I,Zeba Zaidi,D/o Late Wali Haider and,W/o-Shabab Raza Zaidi,R/o-Second-floor, C-20A,Okhla-Vihar,Jamia-NAGAR,New Delhi-110025, Have Changed My Name From **Zaiba Parveen To Zeba Zaidi,** for all purposes. 0040867343-5

In my service record my son's name as **Abhisekh Singh** and his date of birth as 04/12/2000, whereas his correct name is **Abhishek Singh** and his date of birth is 25/09/2009. **Indrajeet Singh, Army No. 9/114470L (HAU/GD), S/o Shivdady Singh R/o 129, Naukaganr near shiv mandir bairia, Dayra Chhupra Ballia District, Uttar Pradesh-277205.** 0071049016-1

I,AMIT S/O-JAGDISH,R/O,1-2ND-165,GROUND-FLOOR,MADANGIR DELHI-110062, have changed the name of my-minor son **SHAURYA** aged-12-years and he shall hereafter be known as **SHORRIYA SEJWAL**. 0040867357-12

I Gita Devi W/o Harichandra Rajwanshi R/o Vill-Meskaur, PO-Meskaur, Distt-Nawada, Bihar - 805122, have changed my name to **Lakhi Rajwar** 0071049066-1

I,hitherto known as **AMAN SANGELIA S/O-RAJ PAL R/O-6610, NABI KARIM NEEM WALA CHOWK, PAHAR GANJ, NEW DELHI-55** have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as **AMAN.** 0040867275-1

I,SHIPRA SINGH,W/O,KAMLESH KUMAR SINGH,R/O FLAT.NO-G-1827,SAYA ZION,BLOCK-E,GAUR CITY-1,GREATER NOIDA WEST,GAUTAM BUDDH-NAGAR, UTTAR-PRADESH-201305,have changed my name to **KUMARI SHIPRA SINGH** 0040867319-6

It is for general information that I Deepali Sharma daughter of Narayan Datt Sharma residing at D-47, Plot No. 91, Arya Nagar CGHS Limited, I P Extension, Delhi-110092 declare that the name of my father has been wrongly written as **Naresh Sharma** in my educational documents, service book, passport and Pan Card. The Actual name of my father is **Narayan Datt Sharma** which may be amended accordingly. It is certified that I have complied with other legal requirements in this connection. 0040867197-1

I,MOHAMMAD RAHISH KHAN,S/O-ABDUL MAZID & RAISA BEGUM,R/o F-58,2nd Floor,Vishwakarma Colony,Near-Faridi Masjid,Pul-Pehladpur,New Delhi-110044, have changed my name to **MOHD RAIS KHAN,** for all purposes. 0040867336-10

I,Harjeet Singh,S/o-Sardar Kuldeep Singh,presently,residing at,House No.1348-B, Gali.No.13,Govindpurj,Kalkaji,South Delhi,Delhi-110019,have changed the name of my minor son **Akam Singh** aged-07 years and he shall hereafter be known as **Akam Partap Singh.** 0040867343-12

I,EHTASHAM UDDIN AHMED,S/O-SAEEDUDDIN AHMED QURESHI,R/O-H.NO.3746,CHURI-WALAN NEAR SEEMA LODGE DELHI-110066, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO **EHTASHAMUDDIN QURESHI,** FOR FUTURE. 0040867357-5

I, Ashiya w/o Mohd Yusuf,R/o F75,West Jawahar Park Gali No.10 Laxmi Nagar, Delhi-110092, have changed my name to **AISHA SIDDIQUA** permanently. 0130067077-1

I, Lata Sharma W/o Sh. Ramesh Chand R/o Ward No.9, Farrukhnagar, Distt. Gurugram, 122506, have wrongly written my name as **Lata** in my 10th Marksheet. My actual name is **Lata Sharma.** 0050293544-1

I,Pranjal Yadav,S/o Shri Gajendra Yadav,R/o-99-B,GH-2,Ankur-Apartment, Paschim-Vihar,Paschim-Vihar, New Delhi-110063, have changed my name to **Rao Pradyumn Gajendra Singh Yadav,** for all legal and future purposes 0040867336-3

I, Ramveer Yadav S/o Shibba Singh R/o-204, Blk-I, Khora Gaon, Khora, Ghaziabad have changed my name to **Rambir Yadav.** 0071048990-1

It is, for general information that I, Shehwar Bano, daughter of Azizuddin, born on 23/09/1994, residing at H.No.430, First-Floor, Gali No.14, Chand Bagh, Karawal Nagar, Delhi-110094, declare that, my name and date-of-birth were wrongly recorded as **Sanjana Jain** and 23/09/1992, respectively, in my Aadhaar-card during an update. My actual and correct name is **Shehwar Bano** and my correct date-of-birth is 23/09/1994, which may be amended accordingly in all official-records. It is certified that I, have complied with all legal requirements in this connection. 0040867343-7

I,Mohd Tabrez,Father of Ayra,R/o C-236,Pul Pehladpur,South-East Delhi-110044, have changed my minor daughter's name from **Ayra** to **Ayra Fatima,** for all, future purposes. 0040867357-14

It is for general information that I, Anandi Priya D/o Kumar Mukesh R/o Chitrawani Road Taxi Stand, Ward No-14, Purnea, Purnia, Bihar - 854301, declare that name of my father has been wrongly written as **Mukesh Kumar Sinha** in my 10th Class School Certificate Cum Marksheet. The actual name of my father is **Kumar Mukesh,** which may be amended accordingly. 0071049073-1

I,HARPREET SINGH GABA,S/O-GURDEV SINGH GABA,R/O G-340,PREET VIHAR,LAXMI NAGAR,EAST DELHI-110092, inform that **HARPREET SINGH** and **HARPREET SINGH GABA,** both names are same person. 0040867319-8

I, Manav kumar Mittal S/O Satish Mittal R/O, H no 21, Bara mohalla, Near Duggal Colony, Devli Road Khand pur Pushpa Bhawan South Delhi 110062 have changed my name to **Manav Mittal** 0071048956-1

I, Shikha Yadav D/o Kanhaiya Singh Yadav, R/o A-8, Flat.No.601, Gardenia Glory, Sector-46, Noida, declare that **Shikha Kumari** and **Shikha Yadav** are one and the same person. 0071048957-1

I,Archana Devi,wife of,Pankaj Kumar Singh,presently,residing at,SNCO's'Mess, Room.no.10,AFND, Lok Kalayan-Marg,New-Delhi-110003, have changed my name, from **ARCHANA DEVI** to **ARCHANA KUMARI,** vide-affidavit,dated-21.JULY.2026. 0040867336-13

I, Rajni Mehta, W/o Vikas Handa, R/O C-186, Surajmal Vihar, Delhi-92, now known as **Pallvi Handa** after marriage. **Pallavi Handa** and **Pallvi Handa** are one and the same person. 0040867253-1

I,DEEPAK,S/O-KHARATI LAL GANGWANI,R/O-22,NEW MARKET TIMARPUR,DELHI-110054,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO **DEEPAK GANGWANI,** FOR FUTURE 0040867357-7

I Suresh Kumar S/o Govind Prasad Sultania R/o Mangal Talab, Guru Govind Path, Sampatchak, Patna, Bihar - 800008, have changed my name to **Suresh Kumar Sultania** 0071049051-1

I,Sandeep Singh Dhalival,S/o Harbans Singh,R/o 11/15,Palm-Road Shipra Suncity Indirapuram Ghaziabad(U.P.)-201014 changed my name to **Sandeep Singh,** for all purposes. 0040867319-1

I,Utkarsh S/O Nitesh Dubey R/O H.No.60, Block-C, Sector-19, Noida(U.P.) have changed my name to **Utkarsh Dubey** for all future purposes. 0040867209-1

I Charanjeet Jawa, S/o-Sant Lal R/o A-165, Upper Ground Floor, A-Block, Meera-Bagh, Paschim-Vihar, Delhi-110087, have changed my name **Charanjeet Jawa** to **Charanjeet, for all purpose.** 0040867336-5

I, RATAN HALDAR, residing at C-341 New ASHOK NAGAR, KONDLI, VASUNDHRA ENCLAVE, DELHI-110096 want my minor daughter's name changed/corrected from **SAVANI HALDAR** to **SABUNI HALDAR,** born on 20-07-2011 and residing at the same address, vide Affidavit dated 16 July 2026 sworn before Notary JAGESHWAR BUDDHPRIYA/GB NAGAR. 0040867287-1

I,PURSHOTAM SHARMA,S/O,BIRI LAL,R/O D5-1103,MIRALA ASPIRE,SECTOR-16, GREATER NOIDA,GAUTAM BUDDH-NAGAR,UTTAR PRADESH-201305, have changed my name to **PURSHOTTAM SHARMA.** 0040867319-7

I, Shaina W/o Inam Ali R/o Niwara, Gauripur, Baghpatt, UP have changed my name to **Saina.** 0071048998-1

I,Govind Kumar Yadav S/O Shri Chandra Bhan Yadav R/O F-7A/140,(Ground Floor),Sector-16,Rohini,Delhi-110089, inform that my daughter name is wrongly mentioned as **Lawanya Yadav** instead of **Lavanya Yadav** in her school records.Both the name **Lavanya Yadav** and **Lawanya Yadav** are of one and same person. 0040867355-1

I Ngangom Ibecha Devi W/o Ng Ningthemjao R/o Waheng Khuman Mayai Leikai, Nambol Sub Division, PO:Nambol, Dist:Bishnupur, Manipur, 795134 have changed my name from Ngangom Ibecha Devi to **Oinam Ibecha.** Henceforth I would be known by the name of **Oinam Ibecha** for all future purposes. 0071049030-1

I,Ayushi W/o-Achal Kumar Singhal,R/o R-2/235, Rajnagar,Ghaziabad, have changed my name to **Ayushi Singhal,** for future purpose. 0040867375-2

I, LAL JI S/O PARAS NATH R/O KHASRA NO.19/26 GROUND FLOOR GALI NO.19 KAUSHIKI , ENCLAVE, NEAR BHAGWATI MARBLE , BURARI DELHI-110084 have changed my name to **LAL JI CHAURSIYA** for all purposes. 0071048954-1

It is for general information that I, Tarun Jain, S/o-Sushil Kumar Jain, Residing at IX/2537-A, Gali No.12, and 15, Kailash Nagar, Gandhi-Nagar, East Delhi-110031, Declare that name of mine has been wrongly written as **Ayush Jain** in my 10th Class Marksheet and School Leaving Certificate. The actual name of mine is **Tarun Jain** which may be amended accordingly. 0040867319-10

I, Deepak Uppal S/o Ramesh Kumar Uppal R/o J-164, Gulshan Ikebana, Sector-143, Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, UP-201301, have changed my minor daughter's name from **YASHIKA UPAL** to **YASHIKA UPAL** for all future purposes. 0040867357-4

I,BALIRAM S/O-Dhani Bhagat R/O-TC-174-Camp Pandav Nagar New Delhi-110008, have changed my name to **BALIRAM BHAGAT,** permanently 0040867342-2

I, Dhruv mohan, S/o Vijay Mohan Aggarwal, R/O-H.No-19/51, Sector-7,Rohini,Rajpur kalan, Delhi-110085, have changed my name **Dhruv mohan Aggarwal** to **Dhruv mohan** 0040867210-2

I,Mohit Kumar,S/O-Jitendra Kumar Gupta,R/O-72 Patti Hulasrai, Near Bugarasi chauraha,Siyana,Bulandshaha r,UP-245412, Have changed my name to **Mohit Kumar Gupta,** for all, future purposes. 0040867357-9

I,Dharamvir Gandass,S/o Paras Ram,R/o 55/4 Village-Garoli Khurd Gurgaon (HR)-122001, changed my name to **Dharamvir Singh** for all purposes. 0040867319-3

I Rajkumar Puri S/o Vijay Puri R/o A-75, 1st Floor, Block-A, Yojna Vihar, Anand Vihar, Po: Laxmi Nagar, East Delhi, Delhi-110092 have changed the name of my minor daughter from **Krishna** to **Vrinda Puri** for all purposes. 0040867191-1

I Pushan Nayyar S/o Anup Nayyar R/o C-1,Bhagwan Dass Nagar New-Delhi-26, have changed my name to **Pushaan Nayyar.** 0040867336-7

I, PRAVEEN KR. NAGAR S/O Satish Nagar, R/o 9/4066, Gali No.17, Shanti Mohalla Raghubar pura, Gandhi Nagar Delhi-110031, Have Changed my Name to **PRAVEEN KUMAR NAGAR** for all future Purposes 0071049001-1

I,Arvinder Singh S/O. Harbans Singh,R/O-D-76, Fateh Nagar, Tilak Nagar, Delhi-110018, Have Changed My Name To **Arvinder Singh Oberoi** Permanently. 0040867357-2

I,DEEPAK,S/O-KHARATI LAL GANGWANI,R/O-22,NEW MARKET TIMARPUR,DELHI-110054,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO **DEEPAK GANGWANI,** FOR FUTURE 0040867357-7

I Pramod Kumar Maurya S/o Nandlal Kushwaha, R/o House No.B-10, Sai Garden, Chipiyana Buzurg, G.B.Nagar, U.P.-201009 declare that my name mentioned incorrectly as **PARMOD KUMAR MAURYA** in my Driving license Correct name is **PRAMOD KUMAR MAURYA** 0071049035-1

It is for general information that I, AMAN UL HAQUE son of MOHAMMAD MUZAFFARUL HAQUE residing at 17/904, EAST END APARTMENTS, MAYUR VIHAR PHASE-1 EXTN., DELHI-110096, declare that name of mine and my father have been wrongly written as **MOHAMMAD AMAMUL HAQUE** in my 10th Class Mark Sheet and name of mine and my father as **MD. AMAMUL HAQUE** and **MD. MUZAFFARUL HAQUE** in my 10th class school leaving certificate. The actual name of mine and my father are **AMAN UL HAQUE** and **MOHAMMAD MUZAFFARUL HAQUE** respectively, which may be amended accordingly. 0040867196-1

I, JAYAPRAKASH T N R/O 17-G POCKET B-7, MAYUR VIHAR PHASE III, DELHI -110096 I HAVE CHANGE THE NAME OF MY MINOR SON'S FROM **RISHI PRAKASH** TO **RISHDEV VINESH** FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES. 0040867287-1

I, Gulshan W/o Aziz R/o 71, Don Bosco Road, Pani Ki Tanki Ke Pass, Alirajpur, PO- Alirajpur, Distt- Alirajpur, Madhya Pradesh - 460330, have changed my minor daughter's name from **Geeta Alias Meena** Markam aged 15 years to **Geeta Markam** forever 0071049069-1

I, Babalu Marakam S/o Dillu Marakam R/o VTC-Sehara, PO-Kesha, Distt-Betul, Madhya Pradesh - 460330, have changed my name to **Shehrebanu** 0071049063-1

I, Sheikh Alaudin S/o Late Sh. Sheikh Dalil R/o House No 289 T Huks, Near Desu Office, Radhu Peliche, Laxmi Nagar, East Delhi, Delhi-110092, have Changed my Name from **Sheikh Shaharuddin** to **Sheikh Alaudin** for all purposes in future. 0040867198-1

I, Veer Choudhary S/o Rami Singh R/o 171, Sector-20, Navada, Greater Noida, Birondi, Chakrasenpur Gautam Buddha Nagar Uttar Pradesh-201310 has changed my name from **VEER CHOUDHARY** to **VEEIR CHOUDHARY** for all future Purposes. 0071048976-1

I,Humeinder Kumar S/O Manohar Lal R/O E-011,DLF Park Place,Gurugram, Haryana-122001, have changed my minor son's name **Ranveer Singh** to **Ranveer Grover Singh.** 0040867343-4

I, Anita Devi W/o Rajender R/O-1823, Block-H, Jahangirpuri, Delhi have changed my name to **Anita.** 0071049058-1

I, Rachna Rajnish Singh Chauhan W/o Rajnish Singh Chauhan R/o 386 Block B Sigma Apartments Beta 1 Greater Noida G.B Nagar. I have changed my name from **Rachna Rajnish Singh Chauhan** to **Rachana Chauhan** for all future purposes. 0071049007-1

I,Suraj S/o Dinesh Morya,R/O H.No.362/1,Pol No.-128,Kapashera Village,South West Delhi-110037, have changed my name to **Suraj Mourya** for all,Purposes. 0040867357-11

I,BHUWAN SINGH SHAHI,S/O-NANDAN SINGH SHAHI,HOUSE.No.417/53, STREET.No.6,B-BLOCK,LAXMI-NAGAR,BURARI,DELHI 110084,changed my name to **BHUWAN SHAHI** 0040867319-5

I,NASREEN BANO MANSOORI,W/O-MOHD RAIS KHAN,R/o F-58,2nd-Floor, Vishwakarma-Colony,Near Faridi Masjid,Pul Pehladpur, New-Delhi-110044, have changed my name to **NASREEN BANO,** for all purposes. 0040867336-9

I,MD IRFAN ALI ALIAS MD IRFAN,S/O-ABDUL AZIZ,R/O-H.NO.C-40,GALI.NO.5,NEAR-BIHARI MASJID CHANDU-NAGAR,KARAWAL NAGAR,DELHI-110094,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO **MOHD IRFAN,** FOR FUTURE. 0040867357-4

I, Ankesh Agrawal S/o Ratan Lal Agrawal R/o Flat No-302, Third Floor Rishabh Residency Plot No-14, Silver Park, Village Balyakhedda, VTC Balya Kheda, Mangliya, Indore, Madhya Pradesh-453771, have changed my minor daughter's name from **Anyia Khan** aged 10 years to **Anyia** forever 0071049047-1

I, Kishan Sethi, S/o Late. Sh.Gyan Chand, R/o-20B/76B,Tilak Nagar, New Delhi-110018, have changed my name **krishan Lal** to **Kishan Sethi,** for all future purposes, both are the same person. 0040867190-1

I,Vinod Kumar Singh,S/o Shri.Tribhuvan Singh,R/o-House.No.E-360,Street.No.03,Budh Nagar, Loni District-Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201102, inform that in my daughter (Sakshi Singh) 10th class marksheet my name **Vinod Singh** instead of **Vinod Kumar Singh,** both names are same person. 0040867336-2

I, Seema Mundepi C/o Navin Chandra Dhyanri R/o P-26, Senior Citizen Home Complex, Pocket-P4, Kasna Road, Greater Noida Gautam Buddha Nagar Uttar Pradesh-201310, has changed my name from **SEEMA MUNDEPI** to **SEEMA DHYANI** for all future Purposes. 0071048984-1

I,Shabab Raza Zaidi,S/o-Late Anwar Raza,R/o-Second-Floor, C-20A,Okhla-Vihar, Jamia-Nagar,New-Delhi-110025, have changed my name, from **Shabab Raza** to **Shabab Raza Zaidi,** for all purposes 0040867343-6

I Ngangom Ningthemjao Singh S/o Ngangom Ibochou Singh R/o Waheng Khuman Mayai Leikai, Nambol Sub Division, Bishnupur, Nambol, Manipur, 795134 have changed my name from **Ngangom Ningthemjao Singh** to **Ng Ningthemjao.** Henceforth I would be known by the name of **Ng Ningthemjao** for all future purposes. 0071049022-1

I,GUDIYA KHAN,W/O SITAB KHAN,R/O B-94,Gali no 2,Pappu Colony, Sahibabad,Ghaziabad,Uttar Pradesh-201005, has changed my name to **GUDIYA** permanently, for all, future purpose. 0040867357-13

I, Babalu Marakam S/o Dillu Marakam R/o VTC-Sehara, PO-Kesha, Distt-Betul, Madhya Pradesh - 460330, have changed my minor daughter's name from **Geeta Alias Meena** Markam aged 15 years to **Geeta Markam** forever 0071049069-1

I, Babalu Marakam S/o Dillu Marakam R/o VTC-Sehara, PO-Kesha, Distt-Betul, Madhya Pradesh - 460330, have changed my name to **Shehrebanu** 0071049063-1

I, Babalu Marakam S/o Dillu Marakam R/o VTC-Sehara, PO-Kesha, Distt-Betul, Madhya Pradesh - 460330, have changed my name to **Shehrebanu** 0071049063-1

I, Babalu Marakam S/o Dillu Marakam R/o VTC-Sehara, PO-Kesha, Distt-Betul, Madhya Pradesh - 460330, have changed my name to **Shehrebanu** 0071049063-1

I, Babalu Marakam S/o Dillu Marakam R/o VTC-Sehara, PO-Kesha, Distt-Betul, Madhya Pradesh - 460330, have changed my name to **Shehrebanu** 0071049063-1

I, Babalu Marakam S/o Dillu Marakam R/o VTC-Sehara, PO-Kesha, Distt-Betul, Madhya Pradesh - 460330, have changed my name to **Shehrebanu** 0071049063-1

I, Babalu Marakam S/o Dillu Marakam R/o VTC-Sehara, PO-Kesha, Distt-Betul, Madhya Pradesh - 460330, have changed my name to **Shehrebanu** 0071049063-1

I, VARUN YADAV S/O UDAIVEER SINGH, do hereby declare that my name is mentioned as **TARUN YADAV** in some of my documents. Both **TARUN YADAV** and **VARUN YADAV** refer to the same person (myself). My correct name is **VARUN YADAV** and it should be used for all purposes. 0040867208-1

I,AINUL HAQUE ANSARI,S/O-NAIMTULLAH ANSARI,R/O-274/49B,Sangam-Vihar, Tigr,South-Delhi,Delhi-110062, have changed my name to **AINUL HAQ,** for all purposes. 0040867336-11

I Aasharam Budatiya S/o Jagannath Budatiya R/o House No.- L.I.G.-7, Sky City, Super Corridor, Bangarda Bada, Indore, Madhya Pradesh - 453112, have changed my name to **Aashu Budatiya** 0071049049-1

I,SUMIT SHUKLA,S/O SH.PHOOL CHANDRA SHUKLA,R/O-H.No.39 B/1,B-Block,Dichaon Enclave, Najafgarh,South West Delhi-110043, declare that my,father's name appearing as "FOOL CHANDRA SHUKLA" in my educational records shall be read as "PHOOL CHANDRA SHUKLA". Both names refer to one and the same person. 0040867336-4

I, Shahid Mohmad S/o Shakil Ahmad R/o-75, Vill Post Gagal, Meerut, UP have changed my name to **Mohmad Shahid.** 0071048994-1

I,Sadha Kumari Mai W/o-Madhav Kumar Maharaj, R/o-A-800, Gali No-13, Jaitpur Extn. Part-2, Badapur, Delhi-44 have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as **Sadhana Kumari.** 0040867252-2

I,IRAFAN s/o-MOHD ISRAIL r/o A-203,Old Seema Puri,East Delhi,Delhi-110095, has changed my name to **IRFAN,** for all future purpose 0040867375-1

I Hardev Singh S/o Jater Singh Negi R/o C-106, Near Mother Dairy Booth No-819 Block-C, Sector-22 Noida Uttar. Pradesh Have Changed My Name To **Hardev Singh Negi** For All Future Purposes. 0071048958-1

I,MOHAMMAD YAQOOB,S/O-ALLAH DIYA,2106, NAIWALA, GALI.NO-37,KAROL BAGH,NEW DELHI-110005,I HAVE CHANGED MY NAME MOHD.YAQUB, MOHMMAD YAQOOB, MOHD YAKOOB, MOHAMMAD YAQUB, MOHAMMED YAGOOD, MD YAKOOB TO MOHAMMAD YAQOOB, FOR ALL PURPOSE. 0040867319-9

I,SHAKILA ALIAS SHAKILA BEGUM,W/O-MOHD IRFAN,R/O-H.NO.C-40,GALI.NO.5,NEAR-BIHARI MASJID CHANDU-NAGAR KARAWAL NAGAR DELHI-110094,I HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SHAKILA KHATOON, FOR FUTURE. 0040867357-6

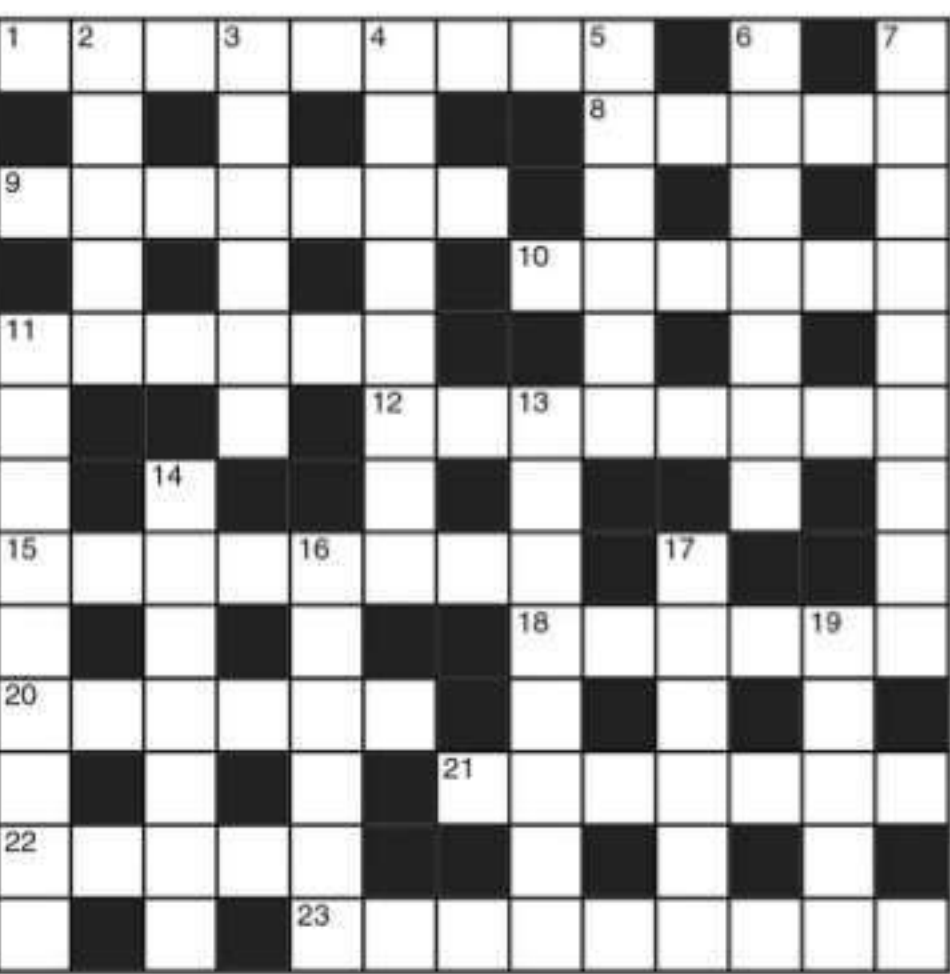
I, DEEPAK KUMAR MALHOTRA S/O HARI CHAND MALHOTRA R/O 22B, POCKET A-13, FORT VIEW APPTS, KALKAJI EXT., KALKAJI, SOUTH EAST DELHI, DELHI-110019, have changed my name **DEEPAK MALHOTRA** for all future purpose 0071048966-1

I,Muni w/o Shilay Raj R/o B-4/2,4th Floor, ST.No.1,East Vinod Nagar,Delhi-110091, have changed my name to **Mani** for all future purposes. 0040867343-1

I, Akansha Garg, W/o Sh. Rohan Gupta, R/o-House. No.430, Near-Vidya Mandir School, Sector-15A, Faridabad, Haryana, hereby declare that in the Birth-Certificates of my minor son **Kiyansh Gupta,** my name has been wrongly mentioned as "Akansha Gupta" and "Akansha" My correct name is "Akansha Garg", which may kindly be read and treated as correct, for all purposes. 0040867337-1

I,Siyona,D/O-Mohit Kumar Gupta,R/O-72 Patti Hulasrai, Near Bugarasi chauraha, Siyana,Bulandshahar,UP-245412, Have changed my name to **Siyona Agarwal,** for all

CROSSWORD



ACROSS
1 Poet involved with fruit cake (5,4)
8 Common stock (5)
9 Claimed to be a test of fitness (7)
10 Not a precious stone but possibly worn (6)
11 He's responsible for issues on a daily basis (6)
12 What gunrunners take part in? (4,4)
15 He likes to know the facts about drink (8)
18 Some direct orders for the clergyman (6)
20 It needs considerable resources to change the law (6)
21 They take pictures a hundred — a thousand — times (7)
22 Added recommendation for a jockey (5)
23 Cranks may be motivated by such an odd character (9)

DOWN
2 Correct some work the men did wrongly (5)
3 Di is to reform fools (6)
4 Below standard tirade is scandalous (8)
5 Geometrical instruments — dividers? (6)
6 Insect on animal is a cause of annoyance (7)
7 Sad boy seen when a vessel is about to leave (4,5)
11 Additional effort required in small parts (5,4)
13 Reg and Maria joined in wedlock (8)
14 Going higher — to where to find walking patients? (7)
16 Go back — but not to work (6)
17 Possibly a grave sign of stress (6)
19 A wild animal — but it's all right; a quiet one (5)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6046 **ACROSS:** 1 Palette, 4 Cinch, 7 Salt, 8 Earnings, 10 Editorship, 12 Broody, 13 Agency, 15 Drew one out, 18 Ding-dong, 19 Scow, 20 Prize, 21 Yielded **DOWN:** 1 Paste, 2 Lollipop, 3 Elapse, 4 Contingent, 5 Nuns, 6 History, 9 Road bridge, 11 Enforced, 12 Build-up, 14 Twenty, 16 Towed, 17 Anti.

JUMBLLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip. The problem with _____ is not knowing when you are finished. - Nelson DeMille (5,7)

LPIOO

EILDNN

FUINT

AELGGH

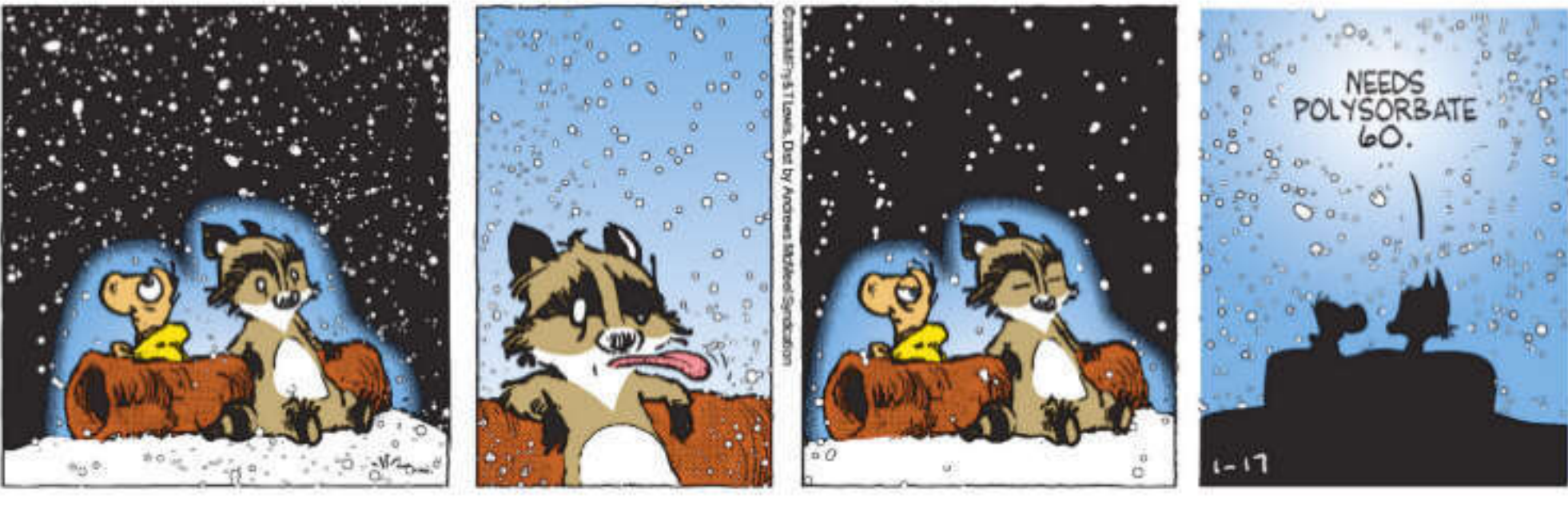
SOLUTIONS:

Polio, Unfit, Linden, Haggle

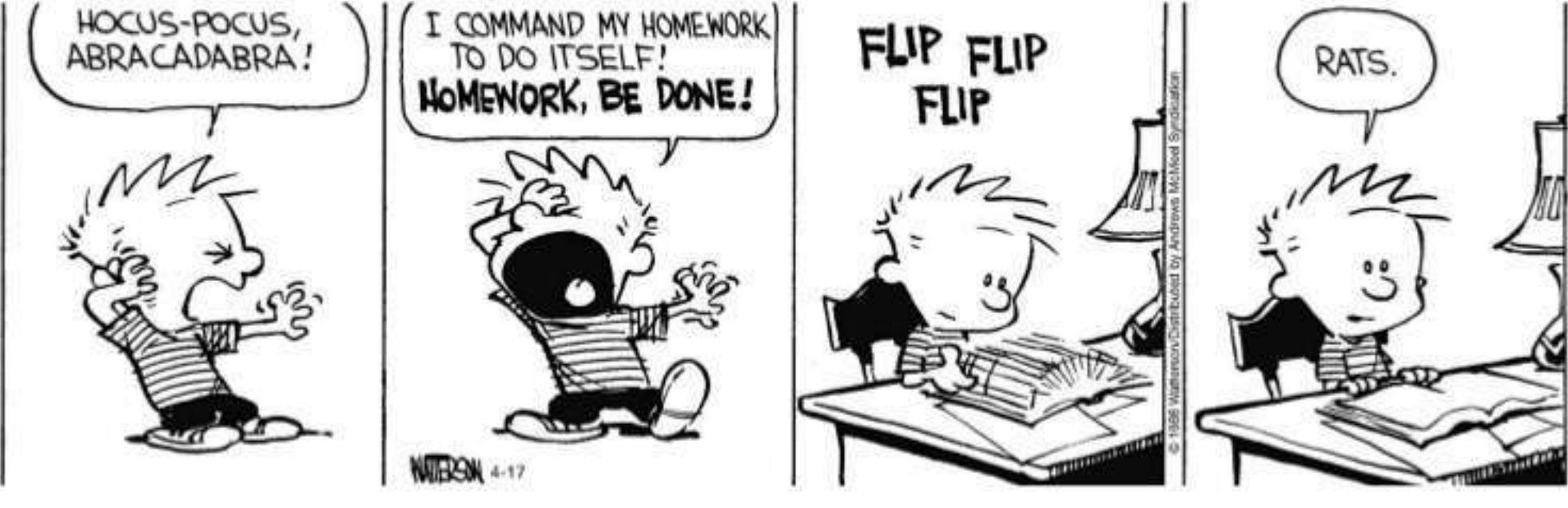
ANSWER:

The problem with **nothing** is not knowing when you are finished. - Nelson DeMille

OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL 2s INSTRUCTIONS
To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6387

		7		9	4			
	1		2	7			6	
8								7
9				8			1	
3	9		6		4			
7			1					5
6								9
8			6	2		5		
	2	7			8			

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6386

8	4	5	3	6	2	9	7	1
9	6	3	4	1	7	8	2	5
1	7	2	8	9	5	3	6	4
3	2	6	5	8	1	4	9	7
7	9	8	6	4	3	5	1	2
5	1	4	7	2	9	6	8	3
2	3	7	9	5	6	1	4	8
4	5	9	1	7	8	2	3	6
6	8	1	2	3	4	7	5	9

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C. / 84 BNSS
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Suleman, S/o Salauddin, R/o E-252, J.J. Colony, Sector-24, Rohini, Budh Vihar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 376/2023, U/s 324/34/506 IPC, P.S. Budh Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Suleman** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Suleman** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Suleman** accused of **FIR No. 376/2023, U/s 324/34/506 IPC, P.S. Budh Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **21.08.2026**.
By Order - Sh. Sanyam Jain
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04, North West
DP/10018/RD/2026 Room No. 112, Rohini Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. PC. /84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Shairan Khan, S/o Qumer Javed Khan R/o D-92/2, Old Seemapuri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.62/2026 dated 14.02.2026 u/s 333/115(2)/126(2)/352 Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, P.S. Jagatpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Shairan Khan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Shairan Khan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Shairan Khan** of **FIR No.62/2026 dated 14.02.2026 u/s 333/115(2)/126(2)/352 Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, P.S. Jagatpuri, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.08.2026**.
By Order
Ms. Anushtha Srivastava
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05, Room No. 07
Ground Floor, Shahdara District
DP/9872/SHD/2026 Karkardooma Court, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Arun, S/o: Raj Kumar, R/o: B-104, Sec-20, Rohini, Delhi** also at **Village Silana, Distt. Jhajjar, Haryana** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 65/20, U/s: 457/380/411/34 IPC, P.S. Vijay Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Arun** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Arun** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Arun** of **P.S. Vijay Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.09.2026**.
By Order
Ms. Shagun
JMFC-06, North West, Room No. 109,
1st Floor, Rohini Courts, Delhi
DP/10008/RD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Himanshu Gupta, S/o Ranveer Gupta, R/o H.No. 761, Main Gurugram Road, Dindar Pur Najafgarh, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 25/2023, U/s 188 IPC, P.S. Chhawla, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Himanshu Gupta** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Himanshu Gupta** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Himanshu Gupta** accused of **FIR No. 25/2023, U/s 188 IPC, P.S. Chhawla, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.08.2026**.
By Order - Ms. Aditi Rao
Judicial Magistrate First Class-13
South-West District, Room No. 505
Dwarka Courts, New Delhi
DP/9920/DW/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Gurpreet Singh @ Bobby S/o Kuldeep Singh R/o H.No.13/70, Geeta Colony, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence case **FIR No. 57/2015 U/S 356/379/411/34 IPC** at **P.S. Jagatpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Gurpreet Singh @ Bobby** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Gurpreet Singh @ Bobby** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s **82 Cr. P.C.** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Gurpreet Singh @ Bobby** accused of **FIR No. 57/2015 U/S 356/379/411/34 IPC** at **P.S. Jagatpuri, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **29.08.2026**.
By Order: Ms. Anushtha Srivastava,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05,
Room No. 07, Second Floor, Shahdara Distt.,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi.
DP/9820/SHD/2026

ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): Plan on more socialising and participating in sports events in the next several weeks. Romance, the creative arts and fun activities with children will flourish. In fact, the next four weeks are a great time for a vacation. Tonight: Things are intense.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): Today it's best to go along to get along when dealing with partners and close friends. In the next four weeks, your involvement with home, family and a parent will increase. Tonight: Be cooperative.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): The pace of your days will accelerate in the next four weeks. You will have places to go, things to do and people to see. Enjoy interacting with siblings, neighbours and relatives. Tonight: Work hard.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): You will find that your focus on your earnings and cash flow will increase in the next four weeks. Boost your income, because this is your year to get richer! Tonight: Enjoy yourself.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Today the Sun enters your sign to stay for the next four weeks. This is favourable for you! It will energise you and give you a chance to recharge your batteries for the rest of year. Expect good fortune. Tonight: Relax at home.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Your personal year is coming to an end, which is why the next four weeks will be a quiet time for you. It's an excellent window for you to define future goals. Goals also give you a sense of purpose. Tonight: Clarify things.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Your popularity will increase in the next four weeks. You'll welcome this. You might join groups as well as see friends. This is also an excellent time to define future goals. Tonight: Check your money.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): You'll look great to authority figures in the next four weeks. This happens once a year and symbolises that you're in a flattering spotlight. You impress everyone. This is the time to go after what you want. Tonight: You're strong.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Grab every opportunity to travel and expand your world in the next four weeks. If you can't travel, then be a tourist in your own city. You can also expand your world through further education, books, film and talking to people from other backgrounds. Tonight: Enjoy solitude.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): You can get richer or benefit in some way through the wealth and resources of someone else, not only this year, but very strongly in the next four weeks. Bear this in mind and keep your pockets open! Tonight: Be friendly.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): For the next four weeks, you will need more sleep than usual. Accept this. Get more rest. Focus on partners, spouses and close friendships more than usual. Tonight: You're noticed.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): You'll be eager to work hard in the next four weeks simply because you're motivated. This energy and drive will come out of the blue. Use it to your advantage so you can improve your job or get a better job. Tonight: Enjoy privacy.

Rajasthan Medical Services Corporation Ltd.
Gandhi Block, Swasthya Bhawan, Tilak Marg, C Scheme, Jaipur-302005 (Raj.)
Phone No: 0141-2228066, 2228064, Website: <http://rmsc.health.rajasthan.gov.in>
E-mail: edpssrmsc@rajasthan.gov.in

Ref. No. :- F.02 (223)/RMSC/Proc./S&S/NIB-18/2026/1381 Dated :- 16/07/2026

Corrigendum-1 in NIB-18/2026
In Reference to NIB No.Ref. No.: F.02 (223)/RMSC/Proc./S&S/NIB-18/2026/1228 Dated:-30.06.2026 UBN No.MSC2627GLRC00032 Corrigendum-1 is issued for Date extension in bid. All details may be seen on <https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>, <https://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in> & <https://www.rmsc.health.rajasthan.gov.in>. Director (Proc.)
Raj.Samwad/C/26/7299 RMSCL

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER
CIRCLE OFFICE, UP JAL NIGAM (RURAL) MORADABAD

Letter No.: 523/Nivida/19 Date 20-07-2026

SHORT TERM E-TENDER NOTICE
Online percentage rate short term e-tenders in two bid system for the Operation & Maintenance of 58 MLD STP, 09 nos. IPS and 2 nos. MPS in Moradabad city, near Gulababadi, in District Moradabad U.P are hereby invited on behalf of Chairman U.P Jal Nigam (Rural) from the reputed contractors having requisite work experience & financial capabilities. Tender documents shall be available at e-procurement website <http://etender.up.nic.in> latest by **24.07.2026 at 11:00AM**. Interested contractor may view and download Tender Document (i.e. Technical& Financial capacity evaluation cum technical bid and financial bid) and upload there tender, duly filled online latest by **06-08-2026 up to 5:00 PM**. Technical bid shall be opened on **07-08-2026 at 12:30 PM**. The non-refundable cost of e-tender document fee Rs. 10,000.00+18% G.S.T. Pre-Bid meeting will be held on **03-08-2026 at 11:00 AM** in office of the Superintending Engineer, Circle office, U.P. Jal Nigam (Rural), Ashiyana colony, Phase-1, near OHT, Kanth road, Moradabad. Superintending Engineer

केनरा बैंक Canara Bank
A Government of India Undertaking

ASSET RECOVERY MANAGEMENT BRANCH, VIPIN KHAND, GOMTI NAGAR, LUCKNOW-226010

E-Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Immovable/ Movable Properties under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8 (6) & 9 (1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.
Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower (s) and Guarantor (s) that the below described Immovable/ Movable properties mortgaged/ charged to the Secured Creditor, the possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of the Canara Bank, will be sold through e-auction on "As is where is", "As is what is", and "Whatever there is without recourse" basis as per following details.

LAST DATE OF RECEIPT OF EMD : 24.08.2026 UPTO 05:00 PM
DATE & TIME OF E-AUCTION : 25.08.2026, 10:00 AM TO 01:00 PM

SL	NAME & ADDRESS OF BORROWER(S), MORTGAGOR(S) & GUARANTOR(S)	DESCRIPTION OF IMMOVABLE/ MOVABLE PROPERTIES	RESERVE PRICE EMD DEPOSIT	Type of Possession	TOTAL LIABILITIES
1	M/s Aqasa (Borrower) a partnership concern, served through any of its partners Bhagat Singh Market, Moradabad Road, (Old Meerut Road, Village Tivdhi), Bijnor, Uttar Pradesh- 246701 M/s Aqasa (Borrower) Second Address: 1179, Aqasa, Jalapur Road, Near Puranpur Sadupua, Kasba Bijnor, District Bijnor, Uttar Pradesh- 246701.	All that part and parcel of open land situated at Mauza Taimoorpur, Gali No. 02, Bharat Vihar Colony, Near Mandawar Road, Bijnor. Area 101.11 sqmt. Boundaries:- East: Residential Property of Mr. Shyam Singh, West: Rasta 10ft. wide, North: Property of Mr. Rakesh, South: Property of Jain Fam	₹ 11,98,000/- ₹ 1,19,800/-		₹ 46,95,012.38 plus Int. w.e.f. 01.05.2026
2	Gorav Kumar (Partner/ Guarantor) S/o Shri Jitendra Singh R/o Village and Post- Nangal Jat, Haldaur, District- Bijnor, Uttar Pradesh- 246701				
3	Aman Kumar (Partner/ Guarantor) S/o Shri Jitendra Singh R/o House No. 199, Totipura, Nangal Jat, Haldaur, District- Bijnor, Uttar Pradesh- 246701				
4	Smt. Anjali Rani (Mortagagor & Guarrantor) W/o Shri Aman Kumar R/o House No. 199, Totipura, Nangal Jat, Haldaur District- Bijnor, Uttar Pradesh- 246701				
5	Komal Singh (Partner/ Guarantor & Mortagagor) S/o Shri Param Singh R/o Post Bakarpur Gadi, Muzaffarnagar Kesho, District- Bijnor, Uttar Pradesh- 246701				

For detailed terms and conditions of the sale please refer the link "E-Auction" provided in Canara Bank's website (<https://www.canarabank.bank.in/>) or may contact Canara Bank, ARM Branch, Ph. No. 0522 2307898/8173004792/ 9454879869/8218881233/ 6387225284/ 7972690456/ 9634016436, Email ID: cb5248@canarabank.com or the service provider M/s PSB Alliance (BAANKNET) Contact No. 7046612345/ 6354910172/ 8291220220/ 9892219848/ 8160205051, for more information visit(<https://baanknet.com/>), Email ID: support.BAANKNET@psballiance.com, support.ebkray@procure247.com
Place : Lucknow, Date : 15.07.2026 Authorized Officer, Canara Bank

UTTARAKHAND POWER CORPORATION LIMITED
(A Govt. of Uttarakhand Undertaking)
Victoria Cross Vijayla Gabar Singh Urja Bhawan, Kanwali Road, Dehradun
Telephone-(0135)2763672-76, Fax-(0135)2760289, Corporate Identity No. U40109UR2001SGC025867/2358

Letter No. 534 / EE(cm)/UPCL /A-2 Date: 21-07-2026

E-TENDER DATE EXTENSION NOTICE
Following e-tenders invited by this office are hereby extended due to unavoidable reasons as under:

S. No.	Name of Item	Tender Specification No.	Last Date & time of online request for Tender and Submission of tender in online & Offline mode	Date of opening of bid Part-I in online and offline mode
1.	11KV XLPE Cable 3x50Sq.mm	CCP-I/17/ 2026-2027	30.7.2026 upto 17:00hrs	31.7.2026 at 15:30Hrs.
2.	11KV XLPE Cable 3x120Sq.mm	CCP-I/18/ 2026-2027	30.7.2026 upto 17:00hrs	31.7.2026 at 15:45Hrs.
3.	11KV XLPE Cable 3x400Sq.mm	CCP-I/19/ 2026-2027	30.7.2026 upto 17:00hrs	31.7.2026 at 16:00Hrs.
4.	33KV XLPE Cable 3x400Sq.mm	CCP-I/20/ 2026-2027	30.7.2026 upto 17:00hrs	31.7.2026 at 16:15Hrs.

Other terms & conditions will remain same as per original tender notice. For further details, please visit our website www.uktenders.gov.in

SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER CORPORATE (C&P-I)

SAVE ELECTRICITY IN THE INTEREST OF THE NATION
Use LED Bulb, Save Electricity (Toll Free No. 1912) " Pay Electricity bill online 24x7 from www.upcl.org". (For information on Electricity theft, informer may report to Toll free No 18001804185/ Fax No 0135-2760911

COMMONWEALTH GAMES: JULY 23-AUGUST 2

A visit to a talent nursery, the winningness of India's successful stomping sports, wistfulness for the disciplines not included, and a widget into what to expect from the compact Games at Glasgow. The Indian Express looks at the sporting footprint

Arnolds of Andhra

Tanishq Vaddi travels through the north of the state, joining the dots that have produced India's finest weightlifting talent over the years

USTAD IS the title bestowed on the winner of Sangidi Rallu, a traditional strength contest held during Pongal in village festivals of northern Andhra Pradesh.

Exported worldwide, black granite is a popular stone of the region. It has been used for years to carve the Sangidi Rallu, a torus weighing 80-220 Kg.

Over time, that folk contest evolved into organised weightlifting in Kondavelagada (pr: kon-duh-wella-gadaa), a village in Vizianagaram district. The village has produced 20 national and 13 international weightlifters, with successive generations securing government jobs through sport, and lifting their families out of poverty.

Among the latest are sisters Bellana Bhargavi (17) and Bellana Harika (19), who won gold medals at the Commonwealth Youth and Junior Weightlifting Championships in Samoa in April 2026. Next week, the tiny village will be in the spotlight once again when Ajay Babu – the son of Valluri Srinivasa Rao, a weightlifting pioneer in these parts – steps on the platform at the Commonwealth Games in Glasgow later this month.

Ajay, who is in Glasgow currently, spoke to The Indian Express about continuing a tradition. "In 2010, my father won a bronze medal, and in 2014 Santoshi Matsa claimed silver at the Commonwealth Games. I want to better that and win gold, and participate in the Olympics."

The story of Kondavelagada's remarkable production line began more than three decades ago. In 1991, a young Valluri Srinivasa Rao, Annapurna Challa and her elder brother Ramu were among the many children captivated by the annual Sangidi Rallu competition. Winning it was a matter of immense pride, and the contest drew almost the entire village.

Around the same time, weightlifting was gaining popularity across northern Andhra. Inspired by what they had seen elsewhere, a few elderly villagers decided to bring proper weightlifting equipment to Kondavelagada. That decision changed the village's future.

Ramu, whose movement had been restricted by polio, never had the opportunity to become a competitive weightlifter. But he had developed a fascination for physical strength after watching bodybuilders on Doordarshan. Rao, meanwhile, inherited his father's love for Sangidi Rallu and tried his hand at the village contest, though without much success.

Both friends would quietly slip in after the regular Sangidi



(Top) Tilaka Dhananjaya Kumar's Gym in Godalam. (From bottom left) Valluri Srinivas Rao with his medals; Commonwealth Games medal hopeful Valluri Ajay Babu in action; Challa Ramu's gym in Kondavelagada. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Rallu participants finished training around seven or eight o'clock, to experiment with the new equipment.

Flower cultivation - marigold, roses, crossandra, was the village's primary occupation, and Rao's family depended on it for a living. Morning training was followed by long hours in the fields. Rao (47) recalls with a smile, "School was optional."

While training, Rao observed older lifters closely, copied their techniques and picked up whatever advice they were willing to offer. Winning a district-level competition changed everything.

When M.S. Sharma, the district weightlifting coach, asked his parents to send him to his academy, they were thrilled. "I used to cycle from the village to Vizianagaram every day to sell flowers. After that, I would go for training," he recalls. At the 1996, Vizianagaram Nationals, Rao, Ramu and Annapurna travelled to watch India's best lifters compete. "Our jaws dropped," Ramu recalled. "It wasn't just men competing. Women were lifting weights, too."

For Annapurna, that moment proved life-changing. "Within a couple of years of starting, she became a national champion in the rural championships, while Rao became state champion."

When Sharma was transferred to the SAI centre in Eluru,

he invited both to continue training under him. They accepted immediately.

Then, tragedy struck. Just days before they were due to leave for Eluru in 1999, Annapurna died after falling into an open well on the family's farm.

Her death devastated the entire village. Rao no longer wanted to leave. "The whole village had to convince him," Ramu recalled. "There were times when his family didn't even have enough food. We told him that if he went to Eluru, he would at least get three meals a day, become stronger and continue weightlifting."

The argument eventually persuaded him. Eluru transformed Rao's career. Under Sharma, the farmer's son developed into one of Andhra Pradesh's leading weightlifters, winning silver medals at the National Games in Visakhapatnam (2002) and the inaugural Afro-Asian Championships (2003) in Hyderabad. Back home, his success sparked a ripple effect. Children who had watched Rao grow up now wanted to follow the same path.

For Ramu, though, the years after Annapurna's death were far more difficult. "For three or four years, I didn't know what I was doing," he said. Then one day, village elders approached him with a proposal. "We'll help you set up a gym," they told me. "Will you teach our children?"

The faith from his village turned his grief into strength.

By 2005, Kondavelagada had its own coaching centre. And soon, Ramu's trainees were winning national medals. After Rao took voluntary retirement from the Army and returned they built another gym. "Our village has around 3,000 people," Rao said. "Many take loans just to provide proper nutrition for their children. A weightlifter needs Rs 50,000 to 60,000 every month for food and training. Where will these farmers find that kind of money?"

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Before Kondavelagada became a weightlifting nursery, there was Amadalavalasa in the neighbouring Srikakulam district. Its Maruthi Yuvajana Vyayama Mandal, produced eight international and 46 national weightlifters, making it the region's original weightlifting powerhouse. Founded in 1969 by tailor K. Amminaidu, the gym laid the foundation for northern Andhra's weightlifting culture. Amminaidu is now 86, partially deaf, and lives a quiet life. He is looked after by his five children, three of whom are weightlifters. "Our inspiration was Kodu Rammurthy Naidu," Amminaidu said.

His son Madhusudan adds that Rammurthy's name is invoked as a blessing for a success-

“Our village has around 3,000 people. Many take loans just to provide proper nutrition for their children. A weightlifter needs Rs 50,000 to 60,000 every month for food and training.”

VALLURI SRINIVASA RAO, LIFTER AJAY BABU'S FATHER

ful career. Folklore says Rammurthy from Veeragattam near the Odisha border, discovered an idol of Lord Hanuman while bathing in a pond in the late 1800s. Inspired by the deity, he resolved to become the strongest man in the world.

"He had a special breathing technique that allowed an elephant to walk across wooden planks placed on his chest," former weightlifter Mugithi Appalanaidu recalled the folk tale. "The Vizianagaram king was so impressed that he rewarded him with gold and jewels, and sent him to England and China to display his feats of strength and challenge wrestlers there."

Rammurthy's exploits inspired as he also established a gym in Vizianagaram.

One of those inspired was Amminaidu, a former kusthi

•BREAKING DOWN INDIA'S CWG MEDAL PROSPECTS

A smaller CWG without India's core sports like shooting, badminton and wrestling means fewer medal opportunities, but they still have a chances across five disciplines.

INDIA WON 61 medals at the 2022 Commonwealth Games edition, but the tally will come down this time due to fewer sports featuring in the quadrennial event. Among the ten events, India is expected to do well in disciplines like Athletics, Weightlifting, Boxing, Lawn Bowls, and Judo.

ATHLETICS: 6 MEDALS
INDIA IS sending a strong 32-member squad for the Athletics events, across 22 disciplines. While the medals in track events look tough, India is expected to win in field events. Neeraj Chopra remains the biggest medal hope in men's Javelin throw, but he will be up against a

world-class field with reigning Olympic champion Arshad Nadeem, reigning world champion Keshorn Walcott, two-time world champion Anderson Peters, Julius Yego, and world lead Rumesh Pathirage.

India's biggest medal will be the jumps with Sarvesh Kushare, Tejaswin Shankar in high jump, Sreeshankar Murali, Lokesh Satyanathan in long jump, and Selva Prabhu, Praveen Chithravel in triple jump.

If Parul Chaudhary and Gulveer Singh can deliver a performance of a lifetime as Avinash Sable did in 2022, India can expect 5-6 medals.

BOXING: 8 MEDALS
A STRONG Indian contingent, headlined by reigning World Champion Jaismine Lamboria and Tokyo Olympic medallist Lovlina Borgohain, will take to the ring at Glasgow 2026.

The field at the CWG is moderately easy, and India can expect to win close to 8 medals. If there are upsets, the tally can touch 10 medals. In five of the seven weight categories in women's boxing, India will start as the favourites, being the highest-ranked Commonwealth Nation in the World Boxing Rankings. Sakshi Chaudhary (51kg), Preeti Pawar (54kg), and Jaismine

Lamboria (57kg) will start as the outright favourites for gold.

WEIGHTLIFTING: 7 MEDALS
TOKYO OLYMPIC medallist Mirabai Chanu will lead India's 12-member weightlifting squad. While Chanu is the best lifter in her category, other Indians also have a good chance to win a medal given the strength of the field. India won 10 medals last time, and one can very well expect 6 or 7 medals this time as well, with Gyaneshwari Devi, Ajaya Babu and Raja Muthupandi the other prospects.

JUDO: 4 MEDALS
Tulika Maan and Asmita Dey will be India's biggest hope, with Inunganbi Takhellambam (women's 70kg) and Ishroop Narang (Women's 78kg) being other contenders. India won three medals last time and will look to better the haul this time around.

LAWN BOWLS: 1 MEDAL
INDIA WON two medals in Lawn Bowls in Birmingham 2022, both in the team event. This time, there are only singles and doubles events, but given the experience in the squad, which features medalists from the previous edition, India is expected to win one medal at least. In Para Sports, India can win medals in Para Athletics (3 medals) and Para Powerlifting (2 medals).

EXPRESS NEWS SERVICE



Jaismine Lamboriya (in blue)

Narsamma. The younger was nine-year-old Karnam Malleswari. After training under Appanna for a couple of years, Malleswari joined the Maruthi Gym.

The little girl would go on to become India's first woman Olympic medallist, winning bronze at the 2000 Sydney Olympics. Her success, along with that of several others from the region, appeared to herald a golden era. It didn't last as numbers dwindled.

"We did everything we could. But none of those who got government jobs came back to build gyms or help the next generation. We never received recognition, and neither did our village," said Vishwanatham.

The Maruthi Gym now faces another challenge. "Weightlifters need modern equipment, but we don't have the money," Madhu said. "But spreading the culture of weightlifting is my father's legacy. As long as we can, we'll continue."

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Tilaka Dhananjaya Kumar, who won bronze at 1992 Nationals, secured a government job as a teacher, posted at his hometown of Godalam, a remote hamlet of around 1,200 people in Srikakulam district, barely four kilometres from the Bay of Bengal.

Like Kondavelagada and Amadalavalasa before it, Goda-

lam became another weightlifting village.

There was no road connecting his village to Maruthi Gym, forcing him to hitch rides to Kotabommali, around 13 kilometres away, to the nearest railway station "I travelled there in the morning to train, stayed overnight and returned home the next evening," he recalled.

He established a gym in Godalam, determined to give local children the opportunities he never had. "If these children reach the national level and get government jobs, their lives, and this region, will improve."

Every year, the community across Srikakulam gather for Sangati Rallu and local weightlifting competitions with 60-65 registrations. "It's almost like an annual reunion," Madhusudhan said. "That's where we first noticed Dhananjaya arriving with children from his region."

But sustaining momentum got difficult since being promoted to a high-school teacher. "Earlier, I trained around 15 or 16 children. Now I'm down to three or four. Equipment has become rusty and needs replacing."

He paused, unsure of what the future held. "The gyms may be ageing, and the coaches may no longer have the means they once did. But every year, when the Sangidi Rallu competition returns, so does the hope that another child will discover a different future."

Gukesh's road to revival may pass through Chess Olympiad

Amit Kamath
Chennai, July 21

JUST A couple of hours before Gukesh D slumped to another defeat, this time to compatriot Pranesh M, Srinath Narayanan was deconstructing the 20-year-old's recent issues over the board. Since becoming world champion in December 2024, Gukesh has yet to win a tournament, a streak unlikely to end at the ongoing Chennai Grand Masters, where he has lost five games in six rounds to be anchored to the bottom in the eight-player tournament.

Srinath's assessment was simple: confidence is Gukesh's superpower, and when he's low on that, it affects his results.

"Gukesh is very good at calculation. But there's an element of confidence in his game, which is probably one of the reasons why there are a lot of ups and downs in his play. When he's

really confident, he plays the same way, but he pulls off things. But when his confidence is impacted a bit, there are also big drops in his play," Srinath said.

Srinath holds a unique vantage point in Indian chess. For the past two Olympiads, he has been the Indian men's team's captain, a position he will also hold at the upcoming edition at Samarkand in Uzbekistan in two months' time. He has had a ring-side view to the rise and plateau of India's current golden generation. He points out how the famed confidence that vaulted Gukesh to the world champion's throne hindered him against Arjun Erigaisi on Monday, where he held a winning edge before allowing the game to equalise and then going on to lose.

"When you're down in confidence, you're constantly re-checking your moves and taking a lot longer to make decisions that you'd normally make much



D Gukesh dropped to 31st in the live rankings after this latest loss in Chennai. EXPRESS

faster. This contributed to him (Gukesh) being low on time and as a consequence, when he needed that time (in the end-game) to make some critical decisions, he just didn't have it," said Srinath.

After his defeat to Pranesh on Tuesday, Gukesh slumped to world no.31 in live ratings that

are updated in real time. He has lost 75 rating points in 19 months since becoming the 18th world champion in chess history.

Srinath believes that the upcoming Olympiad might be the event that helps Gukesh turn around his form. He was the Indian team's captain at the 2023 Asian Games when Gukesh had a horrid tournament, losing rating points by heaps in Hangzhou. But he bounced back by winning the Chennai Grand Masters in its inaugural edition, clinching the Candidates, sweeping through the Olympiad in 2024 and then becoming world champion, all in the span of 14 months.

"Confidence is something which can change in a game or two. Everyone has gone through such slumps in their career. If that bad phase changes, Gukesh will suddenly be a completely different player," Srinath said. "Gukesh's confidence could

have grown in yesterday's game against Arjun if things had just gone a little more his way. I feel there is a chance of a turnaround in the Olympiad because unlike closed invitational tournaments which Gukesh has been playing where every player is rated about 2650 or 2700, the Olympiad is more like an open tournament, something which Gukesh hasn't played in a long time."

Different approach

Srinath, who is part of the organising committee of the Chennai Grand Masters, says he is currently in wait-and-watch mode. On Wednesday, when the tournament ends, he'll start reaching out to the five members of his provisional Olympiad team – Gukesh, R Praggnanandhaa, Arjun, Nihal Sarin and Vidit Gujrathi – about preparation for the tournament.

The way the national camp before the Olympiad is held has

also changed considerably over the years. In 2022, Srinath organised multiple two-week camps with the young squad over two months leading up to the Olympiad in Chennai. He said the camps were as intense as those for Candidates tournaments. But for 2024, there was just a Zoom call because the players were jet-setting to tournaments around the world.

"In 2022, we had some very intense training camps. All of us were working long hours on openings. That didn't quite work because it felt like overtraining," Srinath said. "But since the last Olympiad, the idea is to have a good time together. That's all you need for a team like ours."

For the 20-year-old who wears the burden of the world champion's crown and does not seem to be having fun on the board, the Olympiad might just be the tonic he needs to rejuvenate his game.

Now, Pranesh beats chess world champion

Amit Kamath
Chennai, July 21

PRANESH M does not know what the Chigorin Club in chess is. Nevertheless, he barged into it on Tuesday with one of the biggest wins of his fledgling career. He defeated world champion Gukesh D in 39 moves in the penultimate round of the Chennai Grand Masters tournament, thus entering an unofficial club he had no idea existed. For the uninitiated, the Chigorin Club consists of grandmasters who have defeated the reigning world champion in a classical game.

Having qualified for the Chennai Grand Masters by winning last year's Challengers tournament, Pranesh is climbing rapidly towards another club: that of 2700-rated GMs.

After losing his opening game to Alireza Firouzja, he has had a stable tournament, holding players from the 2700-club like Nodirbek Abdusattorov, Arjun Erigaisi and Hans Moke Niemann to draws before this significant victory.

Pranesh got a helping hand from Gukesh. There was a point when the world champion had a significant edge before Gukesh's familiar woes of courting time trouble surfaced. The battle between Gukesh and Pranesh saw eval bar fluctuations, but it was a bunch of moves from Gukesh while he was racing against the clock that changed the outlook of the game. "I had beaten him once before, in a tournament in Mumbai in the U13 category, where he had gone on to win the title," Pranesh recalled.



Despite no goal and no assist in the World Cup, Rodri (left) dictated terms in most of Spain's games. AP

The paradox of Rodri

The Spanish captain cannot be captured by a metric. Ask Messi, who spent the final avoiding him like a thief avoids a cop



Sandip G
New Jersey, July 21

RODRI AND AMERICA. It was always meant to be; a unique relationship forged by chance and moulded by destiny. Sixteen years before he kissed the World Cup trophy, confetti showering on him and fireworks wiggling into East Rutherford skies, he was in Connecticut, almost 100 miles from the scene of his conquest, as part of an exchange programme.

His father wanted him to pursue academics in the United States, but he was firm on his ultimate desire to be a footballer. But his father had other plans, and imagining that the American life would alter his son's ambitions, he packed him off to a student programme in Connecticut. Rodri. Suddenly, the quiet teenager from the Madrid suburb of Villanueva de la Cañada found himself in the middle of a forest in Conn-et-ee-cut, as they call it. "It was like I was stepping into a Hollywood movie," he wrote in Player's Tribune. "You know the movies where the kids go to the camp on a big lake and you're climbing trees and sleeping in tents and starting fires with sticks?" Everything felt strange for the true blue Madrid boy. One day, he called his friends

to play football. They thought it was American football. "No, no that's not what I meant, soccer," he told them. "Oh, saw-ker. No buddy, no way," they said. He had a football with him and played all alone. Days, nights, in the peak of summer, in the dead of winter. He didn't mind football's improvised version, but he remained, at heart, a dissident loyal to the footie. "Genuine fun! I kind of liked it," he wrote.

He didn't miss home, swiftly learned English, with a Connecticut accent that endeared him to his friends. It would be the same quick grasping skills that made him indispensable in the teams of two antithetical managers, Diego Simeone and Pep Guardiola, the angel and the archangel. But he began to miss home when the World Cup began. "I couldn't even check the internet, so I was in pain," he said.

But the main office had a clunky computer. Every day, he asked the counselors for the score. One of them told him that Spain lost to Switzerland in the first round. His heart sank. "I thought they were pulling a prank." By the knockouts, the counsellors would tell him without asking whether Spain won or not. He was on a canoeing trip when Spain beat Germany in the semifinal. "I never felt so far from home, but also close to home, if you understand what I mean," he would say. He pleaded with the counsellor to let him watch the final on the computer. He did, but the internet was wobbly and he had to

MEASURE OF CONTROL

910

Total number of touches by Rodri, the most by any player in 2026 World Cup

204

Passes completed in the final third, the most for any player

26

Tackles, most by any player

95.3%

Rodri's pass accuracy in the final, his highest in the tournament

“When I was at Villarreal, I was very good with the ball at my feet, but I was still a bit soft. With Diego Simeone, I learned what it means to be the bad guy – to be a bit of a b***** on the pitch.”

RODRI, SPAIN'S GOLDEN BALL-WINNING MIDFIELDER.

find an illegal stream. "When Iniesta scored, I literally started screaming and I ran outside and sprinted around the lake. The guys thought I was crazy."

Sixteen years later, his friends would have realised the essence of this scream. He was holding the most precious trophy in the world aloft. A dream beyond for a Madrid boy.

...

The route from Connecticut to New Jersey took years in the making. A year later, he returned home, and to his father's anguish his son was still in love with the game. He let him be. "It was almost like a drug," he once said. He journeyed from Atletico Madrid's academy to Villarreal's, before returning to Atletico as a senior player. The first big influence in his career was waiting for him, the manager Simeone. The Argentine sensed he has marvelous technical finesse but not the nastiness his teams embodied.

"When I was at Villarreal, I was very good with the ball at my feet, but I was still a bit soft. With Diego Simeone, I learned what it means to be the bad guy – to be a bit of a b***** on the pitch."

Rodri's positional sense is so supreme that he is never out of his place to commit a nasty foul.

A defensive fielder has the image of a tackle-happy, tough mean guy. But the finest of them are not, from the irrepressible Claude Makelele and Sergio Busquets to N'Golo Kante and Rodri. They have more time and space than all, a preternatural sense of the ball, the paths it would travel. This World Cup, he was ranked 97th in the list of offenders. That's the paradox of Rodri, he won the golden ball without a single goal or assist, without topping any of the defensive or attacking metrics. Even in pass completion rate, he sits 44th on the table. So what made him the tournament's most valuable player?

His second, and perhaps most influential, figure in life was Guardiola, who would say: "The way he sees the game, no one else sees, to its finest details, his vision is panoramic." When he arrived in City, he was far from the midfield figurehead he is now. Guardiola advised: "Don't move too much, a holding midfielder does not, move just enough and only when it is required." Guardiola was surprised how fast he learned, and adapted. He enhanced his passing range, polished his positional awareness, and began his ascent to greatness.

In a year, he became irreplaceable for City. Their fortunes have hinged directly on his availability and optimal fitness. "People always look at the players who score goals, but football is much more than that. Rodri controlled every match he played. He dictated the tempo, protected

the defence, recovered possession, started attacks and gave every player around him the confidence to play their football," Guardiola praised him.

In the final, he tied up Messi in knots, so much so that he began avoiding him like a thief would a policeman. Rodri made him play increasingly with the right foot, lethal but not as much as his left peg. Messi would have found traces of his old friend Sergio Busquets. Like the Barcelona cornerstone, he can't be judged with stats, cannot be defined with his nomenclatural role. To label him as a defensive midfielder would be turning a blind eye to his attacking output, to call him a tempo-setter is an inaccurate compartmentalisation. He is, as Luis de la Fuente calls him, the traffic controller, whose role is not as glamorous as the secret agents or the sleuths, but controls the immediate world around him. He is the axis of the compass that lets Spain draw a perfect circle, a man whose occupancy of vital spaces sucks half the belief of his opponents. Argentina would readily vouch for the invisible man that made them anonymous.

He perhaps exists in a state of paradox, a tempo-setter who is a holding midfielder, a disciple of both Simeone and Guardiola, a conductor who is also the lead vocals, and a true blue Madrid boy speaking "Conn-et-ee-cut" English. Also, the best midfielder in the world, a player whose numbers can't capture him, and whose role defies definition.

SIDELINES



Argentina's Leandro Paredes (5) scuffles with Spain's Gavi. AP

Paredes' red card for brawl 'deleted' by FIFA: Report

WHILE FIFA has opened disciplinary proceedings against Argentina for their players' various altercations against their Spanish counterparts, Leandro Paredes, who was seen in a scuffle with Spain's Eric Garcia and Gavi, was given a red card which has since been 'deleted' by the sport's governing body, according to the BBC. "It was incorrectly reported on FIFA's commentator information system that Paredes had been sent off by referee Slavko Vincic for pushing Spain's Eric Garcia by the throat. Paredes' red card was deleted shortly afterwards and FIFA has confirmed to BBC Sport that no disciplinary action was taken at the time," the report stated. But the

FIFA probe is still on over the ugly incidents that ensued after the final whistle where Spain defeated Argentina 1-0 to win the World Cup. In videos floating on social media, Garcia can be seen falling on the ground in the seconds after the referee blew the final whistle. He then gets up and has heated words with Paredes who then proceeds to push Garcia away with a hand on the latter's neck. Argentina defender Nahuel Molina also reportedly attempted to knock over Rodri. Further, assistant coach Roberto Ayala was seen trying to punch Dani Olmo in the face. Head coach Lionel Scaloni and other players rushed in to deescalate the situation. ENS

Viral photo of Messi, Yamal to get trading card

TOPPS IS creating a trading card of what became a famous photo during the World Cup of Argentina's Lionel Messi holding Spain's Lamine Yamal, the company said Monday. Messi, whom many consider football's greatest player, was photographed holding Yamal, then an infant and now a 19-year-old rising star. The two met in Sunday's final, with Yamal and Spain defeating Messi and Argentina 1-0. That game was a potential changing of the guard with the 39-year-old Messi perhaps playing in his final World Cup. Playing for Barcelona at the time of the initial meeting with Yamal, Messi took part in a fundraising drive for UNICEF and wound up holding the player who could be the future face of the sport. Yamal has followed in Messi's footsteps by becoming Barcelona's standout player. AP

Garcia to leave Belgium coaching job

RUDI GARCIA is not continuing as Belgium coach after failing to reach agreement with the country's football federation on a contract extension. The Royal Belgian Football Association said that it will not renew Garcia's deal beyond the end of this month, and that it is looking for a successor to the French coach who led the Belgian team to the World Cup quarterfinals, where it was beaten by eventual champion Spain. Garcia was appointed Belgium coach in January 2025 as the successor to the fired Domenico Tedesco. Garcia, who coached several big clubs including Napoli, Marseille and Roma in his much traveled career, had never managed a national side. He touted his achievements in his 18 months as Belgium coach, pointing to the team's World Cup campaign and improved standing since he took over. AP

Batting as per team's need: Tilak on strike-rate criticism

Express News Service
Mumbai, July 21

TILAK VARMA was earmarked as India's long-term No.3 after the team's T20 World Cup triumph in 2024, but over the last two years, his role has steadily evolved. Team combinations and match situations have often pushed him into the middle and lower order, forcing him to adapt from anchoring an innings to finishing one.

The changing responsibilities have reflected in his strike rate, drawing criticism whenever his scoring rate has gone down. Ahead of India's T20I series against Zimbabwe, the vice-captain said he pays little attention to criticism, saying his batting approach changes as per the match situation and the role assigned by the team.

"In this game, you have to bat in different places, and especially in such conditions, it's not easy. At the same point, I always say that I do whatever is required for the team. If I have to stop and play for the team, I stop and play. If I have to hit, I hit and play," Tilak said at a

Being the deputy to new T20I skipper Shreyas Iyer has added another layer of responsibility for the left-hander

press conference on Tuesday. "From Ireland to England, we lost 4-5 wickets in the Powerplay. So going there and hitting and getting out doesn't make sense."

The left-handers said he often has to play against his natural instinct in the interest of the team. "That's what I always have in mind, that I can go and hit the first ball. But at the same point, I'm playing for the country, so there are a lot of responsibilities. So what is the situation for the team? If I have to play for the team till the end, our team planning keeps changing."

Being the deputy to new T20I skipper Shreyas Iyer has added another layer of responsibility. "If you have the vice-captaincy, the team gives you something after thinking about

it. So I want to take the same responsibilities that the management gives me. I'm playing according to that," Tilak added.

India head into the Zimbabwe series after back-to-back disappointments, having lost 2-0 in Ireland before a 4-0 defeat in England. Tilak said the focus was on getting the basics right rather than dwelling on the results. "It has been a big learning since the last series. And we are just looking forward, and want to follow our basics and do well in the coming series. Everyone has played enough domestic cricket and A-series just before this, so they are ready; it's the same thing, just a bigger stage." "They have played enough matches in the IPL and know how to execute on a bigger stage," he added.

Despite the losses, Tilak insisted there was no sense of panic in the dressing room. He said the priority was to create a positive environment, back every player and use the lessons from the Ireland and England tours to build momentum in the Zimbabwe series.

• WAY AHEAD IN FAST LANE

‘Siraj a wonderful example for young pacers’

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, July 21

FORMER INDIA bowling coach Bharat Arun, who assembled a pace attack that West Indies great Andy Roberts said in 2019 he envied, is set to launch a nation-wide camp to unearth young fast bowlers. Arun's plan is to identify and nurture another Mohammed Siraj, whom he had spotted in 2017 during a net session in Hyderabad and paved his path to the Indian team in 2020.

Since stepping down as India's bowling coach in 2021, Arun runs an academy (Coaching Beyond) in association with Ravi Shastri and R Sridhar in Chennai and Hyderabad. Since leaving the India role, he has been a part of an IPL-winning team - Kolkata Knight Riders - in 2024 and is currently part of the Lucknow Super Giants setup.

"Siraj is a wonderful story for other young upcoming fast bowlers to emulate. And in our own way, we want to do something from Coaching Beyond. It's not only a challenge to us, but it's also, I think, one way of doing something for Indian cricket.



Bharat Arun runs academies in association with Ravi Shastri and R Sridhar in Chennai and Hyderabad. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

And more than anything else, to pick a talented boy and to give him the right kind of inputs at the right time. Inputs, I mean not only technical inputs, it's going to be tactical, it's going to be physical, it's also mental," Arun told *The Indian Express*.

"This country has a lot of fast

During Arun's stint, India had the likes of Bumrah, Siraj, Bhuvneshwar, Ishant and Umesh; since then, resources have been thin

bowlers. And most of these fast bowlers around the country do not have the facilities".

"First is the affordability factor. Sometimes there are bowlers who come from different backgrounds, and they are not able to afford it. Or they do not have access to any good inputs to hone their skills." "Looking at the recent past, there are exceptionally good bowlers hiding in different nooks and corners of our country. It would be an interesting challenge to tap that potential," he added, pointing to the likes of Auqib Nabi who has emerged from Jammu and Kashmir and won the Ranji Trophy last season.

Laying out his plans is Arun's way of responding to a question on whether he prefers to take

another shot as the bowling coach of the Indian team. After coaching a few seasons in IPL, he is about to embark on his first season of working in the SA20 and The Hundred.

Despite his busy calendar, he still spends a majority of his time at the academy. On a hot summer afternoon in Chennai, where temperatures are touching 38 degrees, he is out coaching a handful of pacers who are bowling to St Kitts & Nevis Patriots, the CPL team that is holding a camp here.

"Continuing as a coach for India, yes, I've had my stint with the team. It was a very enjoyable stint. I think there is room to do a lot of work around all this to contribute more towards the development of cricket in the country. It's not just the Indian team. I think everybody needs a specific time with the Indian team to do that. But there is a different kind of challenge. We are thinking of getting a sponsor to pick a dozen fast bowlers and look to give them scholarships, where we take care of their education, boarding and lodging, and give them full-time coaching," Arun said of his plans.

The need for such a camp is because of what Arun has observed in recent times. The IPL has given him a chance to witness talents like Harshit Rana, Prince Yadav and Mayank Yadav, to name a few, emerge, but he admitted the fast bowling resources had diminished. "I would say yes, it is a phase that keeps going on and off. So that's why, to make sure that the fast bowlers and the supply chain remain consistent, we want to do something in our power to make sure that we contribute a little towards that," the 63-year-old said, with the aim to target fast bowlers in the 18-22 age group for the scholarship programme. During Arun's stint, India had the likes of Jasprit Bumrah, Siraj, Bhuvneshwar Kumar, Ishant Sharma and Umesh Yadav; since then, the resources have been thin. While the likes of Arshdeep Singh and Prasidh Krishna have emerged and stayed in India's setup, none are close to cementing their places in any of the formats. And Arun says he would like to give India another pacer like Siraj, who came out of nowhere and became a force to reckon with.